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Boston police using Flock competitors

Deployment of license-plate-reading cameras sparks similar privacy concerns

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Among the law enforcement agencies in Massachusetts that have so far managed to dodge the backlash over the use of traffic surveillance cameras from Flock Safety is the Boston Police Department, which dropped the vendor last year

after a short trial. But this year, Boston instead started pilot programs for automatic license-plate-reading cameras with Flock's main competitors: Motorola Solutions in January, and Axon in June, according to city records obtained by the Globe. The records don't say how many cameras are in

the city or when the programs will end. Flock cameras in particular have triggered a raging controversy across the country, in part because officers don't need a warrant or subpoena to access the data. Also the long reach of Flock's shared network, with more than 100,000 such cameras around the United States, allows law enforcement to reconstruct a detailed itinerary of drivers. Disclosures that some police offi-

cers inappropriately used them to track ex-wives or former partners prompted a slew of towns to cut ties with Flock and raised questions about whether departments have enough oversight over the technology. Axon and Motorola carry seemingly identical features to Flock — and for critics, identical concerns. And in Boston, disclosure of the pilot programs triggered a separate

SURVEILLANCE, Page A7

A lottery triumph, with big recoil

Critics blast online rollout for use of cartoon images, say games attract children

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts' online lottery has charged out of the gate, attracting 187,000 registered users and \$119 million in wagers in just a month. More than \$1.6 million was wagered on opening day alone, leading state lottery officials to tout it as the most successful online lottery launch in US history. But that early triumph has come with a healthy dose of controversy. Public health advocates and several state lawmakers are blasting the Massachusetts State Lottery Commission over the mobile app's arcade style, child-friendly graphics, and porous age-verification safeguards. They warn that the platform will accelerate a troubling rise in underage gambling — a surge fueled in recent years by the omnipresence of mobile sports betting apps such as DraftKings and FanDuel. At least three of the iLottery's 20-plus new games — “The Claw,” “Prize Chickens,” and “The Lamp” — feature cartoon animals and prizes

SHARE OF HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS WHO REPORTED PLAYING THE LOTTERY

2021 28% **↑** **2025 37%**

straight out of a children's arcade. “The Claw” mirrors the classic game found in many grocery stores where players maneuver a crane to snag toys. “Prize Chickens” showcases animated birds alongside flying eggs and feathers, while “The Lamp” incorporates genie imagery reminiscent of Disney's animated film “Aladdin.” Public health advocates and antigambling activists have likened the cartoonish imagery to “Joe Camel” — the infamous mascot used by R.J. Reynolds Co. to market Camel cigarettes that drew fury in the 1980s and '90s for targeting youths and helping to hook a new generation of smokers. For now, anyone can play the new arcade-style “eInstant” games on the Mass Lottery's app for free without verifying their age. That loophole allows children to play without proving they are 21, the legal gambling age for online users in Massachusetts

LOTTERY, Page A10

Possible repeal may not deter cannabis users

Ballot vote an annoyance, not barrier, consumers say

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

Stuart Scipione started smoking weed before it was legal, and, if need be, he will smoke if it no longer is. That being said, it's not a world he's anxious to return to. The 43-year-old recalls “a lot of white-knuckle purchases” back when he started lighting up as a twenty-something in Sharon. Those were the days of clandestine meetups behind a 7-11 or in a Jordan's Furniture parking lot, baggies full of seeds and stems, and evading run-ins with cops — a far cry from the simple dispensary transactions he has since grown used to. “It was a nightmare,” the Foxborough resident said. “I don't honestly miss any part of what it was like back in the day.” A ballot question this November, however, could bring back those hush-hush handoffs. If it passes, Question 8 would make Massachusetts the first state to dismantle its recreational weed market. Not only could consumers no longer buy it, they would not be allowed to grow it at home, either, and the legal limits on possession would be scaled back. The prospect has Scipione considering how he might navigate a rollback on the down-low — without giving up his highs. “I think I'd probably be hanging out behind a 7-11 somewhere, hoping I'd find someone that looks shady enough to sell me a bag,” he said. It's a potential dilemma for many of the state's regular dispensary customers, who have had

CANNABIS, Page A7

In hidden underground realm, history and mysteries lurk



PHOTOS BY CARLOS MUÑOZ/GLOBE STAFF

Sandor Bodo led a group on a tour of Providence's East Side railroad tunnel, which is packed with graffiti (below).

Once, this R.I. tunnel rumbled with trains. Today, it's an eerie lair of artists.



By Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE

Most Rhode Islanders have seen the East Side Transit Tunnel, which buses use to climb College Hill from downtown Providence. But there's another tunnel that's become part of local lore: an abandoned railroad tunnel that runs for a dark, dank mile beneath the East Side of Providence. That tunnel, which hasn't seen a train in at least 45 years, was the scene of a 1993 disturbance involving college students carrying torches, police firing pepper spray, and authorities making claims about Satanic rituals. Now the tunnel has been thrust back into the spotlight as the city leads an effort to save the Crook Point Bascule Bridge, a rusted, state-

TUNNEL, Page A10

A FINAL WAVE GOODBYE



DANIEL SARCH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Former Celtic Jaylen Brown addressed the crowd at his 741 Frequency Fest Sunday on Boston Common. The event featured music, games, food trucks, and lots of mutual love. **B1.**

In the first military strike in a month, US forces attacked Iranian rocket launchers at the Strait of Hormuz, and Iran sent missiles toward Jordan in retaliation. **A6.**

The National Park Service said a deadly flash flood in Grand Canyon has left up to 15 hikers missing. **A2.**

For state Senate candidates Daniel Lander and Latoya Gayle, a hearty endorsement from Boston Mayor Michelle Wu brings opportunity and a potential rise in funds, along with questions on their independence. **B1.**

The Patriots finalized their roster, cutting 37 players in the past two days. **C1.**

Ruoning Yin held on to take golf's FM Championship in Norton. **C1.**

The Sox lost their third game in four against the Yankees, falling 16-1 and farther behind in wild-card race. **C1.**



Sweet 'n' sour

Monday: Sunny but cooler. High 73-78, low 64-69.

Tuesday: Cloudy with showers. High 70-75, low 62-67.

Sunrise: 6:08. Sunset: 7:20.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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The Nation

Deadly flood batters Grand Canyon

Park rangers seek information on missing hikers

By Johnny Diaz, Lauren McGaughy, and Christina Morales
NEW YORK TIMES

One person was confirmed dead and about 15 people were missing or unaccounted for at Grand Canyon National Park in Arizona, park officials said, after a flash flood buried trails under rock slides, washed out footbridges, knocked out water supplies, and cut off access to a remote area Saturday, forcing hikers to be evacuated by helicopter.

The National Park Service said late Sunday it had recovered the body of a 46-year-old man near Crystal Rapids along the Colorado River but provided no additional information.

In addition, rangers were seeking members of the public who knew of hikers or backpackers who were in Bright Angel Canyon and the Phantom Ranch area Saturday.

“These were individuals either on a backcountry itinerary in the inner canyon or believed to be day hiking along the North Kaibab/Phantom Ranch area,” Joelle Baird, a spokesperson for Grand Canyon National Park, said in an email Sunday.

Two helicopters from the park service and the state’s Department of Public Safety searched the North Kaibab Trail corridor as well as the Colorado River from the mouth of Bright Angel Creek to the Deer Creek Narrows on Sunday morning, Baird said.

“No missing individuals were located during these flights,” she said.

One of the missing hikers is John Giusti, a father of three children and chiropractor from Garbunbury, Texas.

Giusti was hiking the Grand Canyon with two of his friends, his sister Valerie Gibbs said.



JAMES THOMPSON/NATIONAL PARK SERVICE VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Only remnants of a footbridge remained after a flash flood Saturday near Phantom Ranch in the Grand Canyon.

It is unclear if those friends remain missing, but in a separate Facebook post that was later deleted on his business page, his wife, Janet Giusti, said that the hiking group he was with “is among those currently reported missing and unaccounted for.”

“We ask our ChiroHabit community to please lift up my husband, his hiking group, and our families in your thoughts and prayers during this time,” the post said.

Gibbs described her brother as a fit and active person who did a lot of hiking and running. She said that relatives were last able to get in contact with him on Saturday around 2 p.m., before the floods began.

Giusti was documenting his trip to the Grand Canyon on his business Facebook page, where he shared photos Friday from

the first day of his trip.

Gibbs said she does not know much else. “I just know they found 100 people, and he wasn’t one of them,” she said.

At least 62 people were evacuated from the tourist spot after the flooding caused significant damage Saturday afternoon, park officials said.

Those who were evacuated were transported to the Maswik Lodge on the South Rim, where the American Red Cross was helping. No injuries have been reported, park officials said.

“Nearly all footbridges spanning Bright Angel Creek were destroyed, eliminating pedestrian access across the creek,” the park service said.

The flood also knocked out the sole water pipeline that serves tourists and residents, officials said late Sunday.

Starting Monday, tourists won’t be able to stay overnight at lodges and hotels within Grand Canyon National Park. The park is also asking residents who live there year-round to conserve water.

At Bright Angel campground, Daniel Evans, 43, was stretched out with a book when he heard the first sounds of trouble at about 11 a.m. Saturday. There was a rumble that sounded like a freight train, and then he noticed that Bright Angel Creek was suddenly a torrent of logs and debris.

At around 1 p.m., he said, black clouds swarmed above the canyon walls and “it just started dumping.” As the downpour continued, the rangers ordered the campground to evacuate.

Evans said he had just enough time to pack up his tent

and bag and flee to a mule corral, where about 30 hikers, park staff, and construction workers stood in piles of mule dung, watching the swollen river rise.

Parth Desai was hiking through a narrow passage in Bright Angel Canyon with a group of fellow physicians and a park ranger when the downpour started.

“We saw the creek flood, waterfalls coming up out of nowhere, boulders, mud, landslides happening everywhere,” he said.

Later, as they made their way toward Phantom Ranch, a colleague shouted “Up, Up, Up, Up!” as a 4-foot debris wall headed toward them and they ran up into a patch of cacti, he said.

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report.

New rule may curb mail-in voting

Millions could face ripple effects

By Reid J. Epstein
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Voting by mail would become much more difficult, if not impossible, for tens of millions of Americans if the US Postal Service is allowed to implement a restrictive rule governing mail voting that President Trump has demanded.

The effects would likely be greater for Democratic voters, who vote by mail in higher numbers than Republicans, and in states where mail voting is universal or nearly so. Mail voting may not happen at all in states that resist the Trump administration’s demands for voter data.

The rule would particularly affect people in rural areas and older voters, who tend to cast ballots by mail in greater numbers. It could also deeply affect states where some of the most competitive races for House, Senate, and governor will determine control of Congress and state governments.

Michigan, where 37 percent of votes were cast by mail in 2022, would be one epicenter, with hard-fought statewide contests and multiple battleground House races. California, which mails ballots to all voters, is expected to be central to Democratic efforts to win a majority in the House.

The rule is being challenged in several lawsuits, and it is on hold temporarily following a federal judge’s ruling on Thursday. The administration is appealing. Even if the Postal Service is permitted to proceed, it is unclear that it would have time to implement the plan before an election that is fewer than 70 days away.

For instance, the rule requires states to upload a list of voters to a federal mail ballot portal that is not yet online. Nearly two dozen Democratic-led states and Washington, D.C., have sued to block the proposed rule and said they will not comply with it.

If the agency were to move ahead, state and local officials would shoulder enormous costs in what would need to be a herculean effort to prepare election offices and educate voters in time for the midterm elections in November.

The most dramatic aspect of the proposed rule is a plan to deny services for election mail entirely in states that do not turn over voter data, which federal officials say they want to use to identify noncitizens on state voter rolls. The policy would upend mail voting in any state that does not comply, but the effects would be measurably greater in the smaller number of states that rely heavily on mail voting.

More than 1 in 3 Democrats voted by mail in 2024, compared with about 1 in 4 Republicans, according to estimates by the States United Democracy Center, which examined voting data in 32 states where it was available.

“It’s not that complicated,” said Marc Elias, the Democratic election lawyer, who said the new policy was a blatant effort to disenfranchise Democrats. “The administration knows that Democrats are more likely to vote by mail than Republicans.”

It is far from certain that the rule could be implemented this year, given outstanding legal and logistical challenges with fewer than 10 weeks before Election Day. North Carolina, where a highly competitive Senate race could help determine control of the chamber, is set to mail ballots to some voters starting next week.

Trump, who voted by mail himself in Florida’s primary this month, created the current uncertainty by signing an executive order in March that called on the Department of Homeland Security to compile state-by-state citizenship lists that could be used to help determine voter eligibility.

DAILY BRIEFING

Officer dead in shooting at S.C. park

A South Carolina police officer died and a second was injured in a gunfight in a park following a call about a domestic dispute, the police chief in Columbia said.

The suspect, a 33-year-old man with a lengthy criminal record, also died, Chief W.H. “Skip” Holbrook said at a news conference in the capital city.

The deceased officer, 29-year-old Christopher DeLong, had been with the police department for two years and leaves behind a wife and two young children, Holbrook said.

“Our hearts are broken this evening,” he said, appearing choked up at times.

DeLong’s wife, in a social media post, praised her husband as the “best dad to our babies” and said she was “living a nightmare.”

After a Saturday night news conference, Holbrook and other law enforcement officials joined in a procession from the hospital. The second officer, David Dymock, was in stable condition, the chief said.

“I hope that our officers know that they’re not alone in this. We will lean on each other in this tragic time,” Holbrook said. “Let’s pray for this department.”

The shooting unfolded after a woman called police around 9:30 a.m. Saturday, saying a man she had a restraining order against was destroying property at her home.

DeLong quickly arrived on scene and learned the suspect had left the residence.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



JOEL KOWSKY/NASA VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

NASA’s Roman telescope leaves Earth to chart the stars

At 7:26 a.m. Eastern time Sunday, the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope blasted off from the Florida coastline and sailed toward the stars. So begins its journey to capture deep, sweeping views of our universe, as far back as when it was only a few hundred million years old.

Named after the agency’s

first chief astronomer, Roman is NASA’s latest and greatest cosmic cartographer. The \$4.3 billion telescope will use its sharp infrared vision to chart billions of galaxies, as well as hundreds of black holes and the dusty disks circling young stars, where new planets form. It promises a panorama so wide and so crisp that it would take

more than half a million high-definition TVs to display in full.

At a news conference Saturday morning, Nicola Fox, the associate administrator of NASA’s science mission directorate, said that Roman’s vast gaze would contribute to solving some of the grandest mysteries about our universe, including how it works, what it is

made of, and whether we are alone out there.

“To put it in perspective, it will be as if Hubble and James Webb kind of peered through a keyhole at the universe,” Fox said, referring to two other telescopes NASA has launched into space. “Well, Nancy Grace Roman will kick the door down.”

NEW YORK TIMES

Petting zoo goats positive for rabies

Four baby goats that traveled to petting zoo appearances in North Carolina this summer tested positive for rabies, prompting state officials on Friday to urge anyone who came into contact with them to alert their local health department.

“Rabies is almost always fatal in mammals, including people, unless medications to prevent infections are given before symptoms develop,” the North Carolina Department of Health and Human Services said in a statement.

The goats belonged to Farm Adventures, a mobile petting zoo in Harmony, N.C., the de-

partment said.

The department said that anyone who visited the zoo in Harmony or any of its other sites between July 28 and Aug. 27 should contact local health officials to see if treatment is needed.

“The petting zoo held off-site events involving children and elderly individuals across multiple counties within that time frame,” state officials said.

It was unclear how many people were potentially exposed to the goats. State health officials did not disclose the locations where Farm Adventures exhibited the goats.

NEW YORK TIMES

Karina becomes Pacific hurricane

MIAMI — Hurricane Karina formed Sunday in the Pacific Ocean and could become a major storm within days, forecasters said. The cyclone’s center was far out to sea and was not threatening land.

Karina had maximum sustained winds of 80 miles per hour, the Miami-based National Hurricane Center said, making it a Category 1 hurricane.

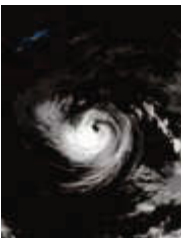
The storm is expected to undergo steady or rapid strengthening as it moves over

open Pacific waters and is forecast to become a major hurricane in another day or so, the center said.

A major hurricane is a Category 3 or greater with maximum sustained winds of at least 111 miles per hour.

On Sunday, Karina was located about 880 miles west-southwest of the southern tip of Mexico’s Baja California Peninsula and was moving west-northwest at 9 miles per hour.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



This satellite image shows Hurricane Karina.

DAILY BRIEFING

Russian strike death toll at 38

KYIV — The death toll from a Russian strike on a warehouse west of Kyiv, the war’s deadliest attack this year, rose to 38 with four people still missing, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said Sunday.

The Friday night strike on the warehouse, which Ukrainian officials said was storing ammunition, sparked massive explosions and fires that swept through dozens of nearby homes and buildings in the village of Myla.

The attack came as Russia has sharply intensified its air campaign recently in the 4 1/2-year-old war, with air raid sirens wailing repeatedly and explosions and the rumble of air defenses resounding across Kyiv.

Emergency workers continued to extinguish fires and identify and neutralize explosives at the site, Zelensky said on social media. At least 52 people were injured, said Tymur Tkachenko, who heads the local regional military administration.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Manhunt after shooting at rave

BERLIN — Swiss police are looking for one or more people who killed one woman and wounded five others at a rave in Switzerland on Sunday.

The shooting happened during a dance party at a horse racing track in Aarau, in the country’s north. A number of shots were fired, the police said, but Sunday afternoon it was still unclear how many perpetrators and how many guns were involved.

A police spokesperson said they were searching the entire country but that the risk for people in the area was believed to be low since they thought the perpetrator or perpetrators had fled.

The shooting happened early Sunday as the rave was winding down, the spokesperson said.

A 22-year-old woman died at the scene, and four men and a woman, ages 24 to 27, were wounded, according to the police. All six victims were Swiss citizens.

NEW YORK TIMES

Hundreds attend funeral in Haiti

PORT-AU-PRINCE — Hundreds of people crowded into a church near Haiti’s capital on Sunday for the funeral of four of the 47 people killed in a recent gang attack so brutal that it shook a country that has long struggled with violence.

Mourners wiped away tears, raised their hands, and cried as coffins arrived at a church in the farming community of Kenscoff.

Armed men attacked Kenscoff on Aug. 23, killing at least 47 people and kidnapping more than 50 others in the middle of the night. It was one of the biggest mass kidnappings in Haiti in recent years, and survivors have organized protests and blamed police for not preventing the attack.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Ferry capsizes off coast of Cyprus

A passenger ferry carrying 267 people capsized off the northern coast of Cyprus on Sunday, leaving at least eight people dead and prompting a search to rescue the remaining passengers.

Most passengers had been rescued, but 18 people were still missing, said Tufan Erhurman, the president of the part of northern Cyprus that has declared itself an independent Turkish republic, in a briefing late Sunday reported by Anadolu, Turkey’s state-run news agency.

Four of the victims had been identified, Erhurman added, and the search for survivors was continuing by local and Turkish search-and-rescue teams.

NEW YORK TIMES



RAJESH KUMAR SINGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A view of the aftermath of flash flooding along the Trishuli River in the Nuwakot district of Nepal on Sunday.

Nepal warns of possible new flooding

Communities struggle amid wide devastation

By Victoria Milko and Niranjan Shrestha
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DHADING, Nepal — Authorities warned of possible fresh flooding on Sunday and urged residents in flood-affected districts to remain on high alert after water levels rose in the Bhotekoshi River.

Flood warning notices were sent to people’s phones early Sunday as rescue crews worked to clear a major highway connecting Kathmandu to one of the areas worst hit by Wednesday’s catastrophic floods, which killed at least 800 people and left more than 3,000 missing in Nepal and Tibet.

The latest warnings came after Chinese authorities informed their Nepalese counterparts of increased water flow upstream, according to Dharam Raj Uprety, chief executive of Nepal’s National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority.

The Chinese state news agency Xinhua, citing the country’s water resources ministry, said a new lake formed after Wednesday’s floods high in the mountains had largely drained.

But Xinhua said the ministry warned that a crater located 3.5 miles upstream, which held an estimated 370 million gallons of water, still posed some risk and required close monitoring.

Nepal’s disaster agency said



DAR YASIN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Relatives comforted a woman as she looked at photographs of flood victims and people missing outside a hospital in Kathmandu Sunday. Below: A boy added a photo to the wall.

Sunday the death toll had climbed to 788 with 2,502 missing, while Chinese authorities reported 16 deaths and 546 missing on the Chinese side of the border.

The missing include hundreds of people from over a dozen countries who were in the region to work, visit the mountains, or make a pilgrimage to a sacred peak. On Sunday, Chinese state media said 261 foreigners were missing in Tibet, including more than 100 Nepalis and others from around the world.

In Dhading, one of the worst-hit regions in Nepal, some residents began returning to ruined homes to see what can be salvaged.



DAR YASIN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Residents sat in homes with walls washed away by the floods, shoveling sludge-like mud and rubble off balconies or

window frames. Others scanned the ground for items they could pick out of the mud and rinse off. One man had re-

Iceland votes against move to join European Union

Turnout high as sovereignty issue weighs on nation

By Amelia Nierenberg and Egill Bjarnason
NEW YORK TIMES

REYKJAVIK, Iceland — Icelanders voted against resuming negotiations on joining the European Union, officials said Sunday, after an unusually divisive debate ripped through the Nordic nation of 400,000.

The “no” side received 52.8 percent of the vote in a national referendum held on the issue, according to results announced Sunday by the national election authorities. Some 82.6 percent of eligible voters cast ballots in the referendum Saturday, they said.

RUV, the national broadcast-

er, said it had been the highest voter turnout in any Icelandic election since 2009.

The decision was a setback for the 27-member European Union, which has been pitching itself as a progressive and pragmatic alliance in an increasingly uncertain world. With Iceland, the bloc would have expanded its presence in the Arctic with a wealthy nation.

“Iceland remains one of the EU’s closest and most trusted partners,” a spokesperson for António Costa, the president of the European Council, said in a statement, adding that the bloc respected the result.

Even politicians who had pushed to reopen EU talks celebrated the referendum as a sign of Iceland’s healthy democracy.

“The fact that we got people to the table on a matter like this is extremely important,” Prime

Minister Kristrun Frostadottir said Sunday, speaking to reporters in Reykjavik, the capital. She favored resuming the talks.

Complex issues were at play in the referendum.

In interviews before Saturday, voters said their main concern was how to keep Iceland prosperous, stable, and safe in an increasingly unsettled world. Many people who said they planned to vote “no” said they were worried that joining the bloc could threaten the country’s control of its valuable fishing industry, as well as its sovereignty on other issues.

“Iceland fought for independence,” said Andrea Gunnarsdottir, 36, a food blogger in Reykjavik. “And we should keep it.”

Some people who planned to vote “yes” said they were worried about Iceland’s economy in

general and wanted to see what the negotiations would bring. Inflation is high. So are interest rates. Some said joining one of the world’s largest economies — and potentially adopting its currency, the euro — could be a savvy move for long-term stability.

Eirikur Bergmann, a politics professor at Bifrost University in Iceland, said the “yes” side had made a measured, tactical argument about seeing what could come of the talks without articulating a national vision behind why Iceland might want to try to join the EU.

“What was the higher goal?” he said. “That was never explained.”

The “no” side, though, he said, was much better able to leverage the country’s national identity, because fishing has long had an important place in the country’s self-image.

In recent years, Icelanders have watched with alarm as Ireland, an EU member, has endured cuts to fishing quotas that have devastated its coastal communities. In Iceland, fishing is a much bigger part of the economy.

“Fisheries became a symbol of Iceland’s sovereignty,” Bergmann said.

The results showed a sharp geographic divide. Voters in and around Reykjavik favored restarting talks. In the rural rest of the country, most Icelanders voted against it.

Other potential “yes” voters saw the bloc as a stabilizing protector as they face a changing geopolitical reality in the Arctic, where superpowers are vying for dominance.

Icelanders were rattled this year by President Trump’s threats against Greenland.

N. Texas judges sought out

President finds friendly court in Lone Star State

By Zach Montague and Matthathias Schwartz
NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump’s Justice Department had a problem. Judge after judge was rejecting its demands that hospitals across the country turn over internal records of transgender care provided to children.

By the end of April, federal judges in Boston, Philadelphia, Pittsburgh, Los Angeles, and Seattle had either quashed or substantially pared back the administration’s demands that hospitals send patient records to the federal government.

But the administration did not give up. Instead, in April, it went to the Northern District of Texas’ Fort Worth courthouse, where nearly all cases go directly to the district’s chief judge, Reed O’Connor, or a second judge, Mark T. Pittman, who was appointed by Trump.

There were no hospitals in Texas that offered the transgender care at issue — state law-

makers banned gender-affirming care for minors in Texas in 2023. But the Justice Department asked the Texas court to enforce a subpoena to the Rhode Island Hospital, arguing that its nationwide investigation of such medical care was “being carried out in the Northern District of Texas.”

That was enough for O’Connor, an appointee of President George W. Bush who has built a reputation as a conservative stalwart and became the district’s chief judge last August.

He granted the motion, clearing the way for the hospital to turn over a variety of personal data, including the names and Social Security numbers of minors who had received treatment.

“The subpoena’s demands are reasonable,” he wrote.

Most of the country’s 94 district courts assign cases randomly across all of their judges.

Northern Texas, where O’Connor sits, does things its own way. It assigns cases to judges based on the courthouse within the district where the lawsuit is initially filed. Some courthouses are staffed by just one or two judges, meaning litigants can easily engage in “judge shopping” — filing their case in a particular courthouse and knowing to a certainty or near-certainty which judge will decide it.

In four of Northern Texas’ seven courthouses, one judge appointed by Trump hears all of the cases. In a fifth courthouse, all the cases go to O’Connor. In a sixth — Fort Worth — 90 percent of the caseload is split between O’Connor and Pittman.

Of the district’s nine active-status judges, eight were appointed by Republican presidents — six of them by Trump. There are other districts in the country where more of the judges are Trump appointees, but very few assign cases the way Northern Texas does. And most fall outside the jurisdiction of the 5th US Circuit Court of Appeals, widely considered

to be the country’s most conservative appellate court, which hears appeals from Texas, Louisiana, and Mississippi.

For years, conservative interest groups and the Texas attorney general’s office have filed lawsuits in Northern Texas, taking advantage of the district’s unusual case-assignment rules. Now, with Trump back in office, O’Connor’s district has emerged as a destination for the Justice Department, as well.

A spokesperson for the Justice Department declined to comment about the practice. O’Connor did not respond to requests for comment.

In quick succession this year, O’Connor has struck down Biden-era rules regarding ghost guns and immigration courts. He has also issued several rapid-fire orders allowing the Trump administration to reach sweeping legal settlements with opponents who appeared to actually share the federal government’s ideological goals.

Legal scholars have stressed for years that Democratic administrations and states have also availed themselves of districts with a high concentration of judges seen as more liberal. But many draw a distinction between the more prevalent practice of “forum shopping” — that is, filing in a region where groups of judges have been generally considered friendly — and that of effectively filing directly to an individual judge.

Kevin Wagner, a political science professor at Florida Atlantic University, said the precision of venue shopping in Texas was unusual, having reached the point where litigants could achieve not just a “favorable” venue but even a “predictable” one.

Assigning major cases by geography as opposed to a random draw “undermines the appearance of impartiality,” said Nancy Gertner, a retired federal judge and a lecturer at Harvard Law School, who has been critical of the Trump administration.”



CHRIS PIZZELLO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

On Saturday, audience members watched Olivia Rodrigo perform with special guest Sarah McLachlan at the Daisy Chain Fields Music Festival at Great Park in Irvine, Calif.

Pop star’s festival raises \$20m

Champions women’s health and legal rights

By James Pollard
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Evoking the same do-it-yourself pop-rock feminism of her ’90s musical influences, Olivia Rodrigo raised \$20 million for women’s well-being with a benefit show that activated her young audience.

Daisy Chain Fields united a women-led lineup featuring queer pop star Chappell Roan, breakout rapper Doechii, and riot grrrl pioneers Bikini Kill to champion women’s health, workplace protections, and legal rights. Ahead of Saturday’s festival in Irvine, Calif., Rodrigo announced the show had already raised enough to make a \$10 million donation to 10 nonprofit partners including Planned Parenthood, National Women’s Law Center, and Black Mamas Matter Alliance.

Philanthropist Melinda French Gates pledged another \$10 million through her Pivotal Ventures in a surprise appearance at the start of Rodrigo’s set,

praising her for “showing a new generation how much their voices matter.”

Rodrigo said the festival’s artists and activists give her hope despite the “regression of women’s rights” today.

“That’s actually why I fell in love with the name ‘Daisy Chain,’” she said Friday. “It served as a reminder of how individual parts can come together to create something strong and unbreakable.”

Rodrigo, 23, has made a name channeling the rage and dissatisfaction of modern romance into chart-topping songs that are equal parts Taylor Swift and Alanis Morissette. Now, she looks to bridge the gap between Gen Z and nonprofits, which have struggled to build relationships with younger donors who tend to prefer informal ways of giving.

The connection is not lost on Daisy Chain Fields attendees.

“People don’t join together and mobilize unless they feel connected to the group that is mobilizing,” said Grace Slevin, 24. “What’s better than music?”

All-star benefit concerts have proven popular for driving millions of dollars toward every-

thing from refugee relief to pandemic response. But it’s been decades since a young artist with Rodrigo’s following brought her peers together for gender justice.

That focus comes as President Trump attempts to overhaul family planning grants that reproductive health clinics use to provide birth control and treat sexually transmitted infections. His administration paused \$27.5 million last year for such organizations, including some Planned Parenthood affiliates, before officials agreed to restore the money.

For Slevin, an Orange County, Calif., resident who does anti-sex-trafficking advocacy, Daisy Chain Fields embodies the sentiment of “be who you needed when you were younger.” She loves that attendees are welcome to learn about the beneficiaries’ work in addition to donating.

Nonprofit partners engaged with fans in Daisy Chain Fields’ “philanthropy village.” Festivalgoers collected pins from booths as they learned about health services from Planned Parenthood or pay tribute to caregivers through the National Domestic Workers Alliance.

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FLOWER POWER — Visitors were immersed in the projections Saturday at an interactive digital art installation called “Flowers and People, Cannot be Controlled but Live Together,” created by the international art collective known as teamLab, at the Nita Mukesh Ambani Cultural Centre in Mumbai.

Churches that shaped Parton fade away

Unpretentious, folksy faith was hallmark of icon

By Ruth Graham and Emily Cochrane

NEW YORK TIMES

For years, Mary Berry attended a small Baptist church in the rural Kentucky community where her family has lived and farmed for generations.

She taught Sunday school. She brought food to hundreds of potlucks. At one point, she served as a deacon alongside a janitor, a tenant farmer, and the community’s doctor. Everyone knew everyone, and if differences of opinion were sensed, they were not discussed.

As the local economy suffered in the early 2000s, however, so did the congregation. Disputes arose over cultural and political topics that had never been at issue before. A pastor was ousted over his stance on same-sex marriage. Berry left, too.

“As I got older and began to see the loss of the cohesive agrarian culture I grew up in, I began to see what we were really losing was that sort of gathering where all kinds of people gathered as equals,” Berry, the daughter of poet and farmer Wendell Berry, recalled this week. “It wasn’t perfect, but it was pretty darn good.”

She was speaking days after the death of Dolly Parton, a woman who was also shaped by a small rural church in Appalachia.

Since her death in Nashville, Tennessee, last week at the age of 80, tributes have poured in from conservative Southern Baptists and progressive Unitarians, from twice-on-Sunday churchgoers to people who avoid institutions altogether.

What many of them seemed to be mourning was not just Parton as a performer, but as a



WILL CROOKS/NEW YORK TIMES

The Robert F. Thomas Chapel at Dollywood in Pigeon Forge, Tenn., is a reminder of the late star’s rural Christian roots.

Christian who represented for many an idealized style of faith, and in particular, Southern or Appalachian faith: folksy and unpretentious, oriented around Jesus and rollicking old-time music, and centered in small rural congregations that prize community over ideology.

Those small churches “are very place-based, deeply rooted institutions” said Jessie Wilkerson, a professor at the University of Tennessee in Knoxville and a historian of Appalachia.

Parton’s lifetime saw the rise of megachurches, which have replaced many more intimate congregations like the one she was born into. About 1 in 3 Protestant churchgoers now attends a

church that attracts at least 1,000 people on a weekend, according to the Hartford Institute for Religion Research.

Those large churches, including those anchored by a central congregation that plants multiple campuses throughout a region, have damaged many independent congregations with fewer resources.

Parton’s grandfather was the pastor of the House of Prayer, a small Pentecostal church in Sevier County, Tennessee. She was singing in the choir by age 6, and was baptized in the Little Pigeon River at 12. Her faith has infused countless songs, even as she wrestled with the occasional contradictions between what

she called her “three passions”: God, music, and sex.

“Rural southern Christianity, especially at that time, seemed much warmer than what we see in American life now,” said Russell Moore, an editor-at-large and columnist at Christianity Today magazine, who was raised in a Baptist church in rural Mississippi and now lives in Nashville. “You actually did have people in community, meaning people knew when someone was sick, and could bear with other people’s failings.”

But he cautioned against idealizing the era. “The shadow side of that was often propping up horrific sin, such as what we see in Jim Crow racial oppression,” he said. “We can’t talk about one without seeing the other.”

More scholarship is needed about the role of small churches in the racial conflicts of the 20th century, said Anthea Butler, an emerita professor at the University of Pennsylvania who studies race and American religion. In her view, the widespread nostalgia for a Dolly-style Christianity is primarily about the experience of belonging to any kind of close-knit church that offers deep relationships and sets the rhythms of the week.

For Silas House, a novelist who grew up in a congregation in eastern Kentucky, the small rural church of his childhood was a paradoxical institution. Its members taught him the “radical empathy” of Jesus, he said. But he also knew that if they knew he was gay, that empathy could be withdrawn.

But Parton consistently embraced gay people and was also “quite Jesus-y.”

“For a lot of people including myself, Dolly became what we wanted out of Christianity,” House said. “She was one of the people who allowed me to come out, and one of the people who allowed me to retain my faith.”

US attacks Iranian rocket launchers

Tehran retaliates with missiles aimed at Jordan

By Eric Schmitt

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — US forces attacked two Iranian rocket launchers attempting to disperse sea mines into the Strait of Hormuz on Sunday, according to US Central Command.

Hours later, Iran retaliated by firing a few missiles toward Jordan, all of which were intercepted, according to a person familiar with the Iranian attack who was not authorized to discuss the attack publicly. Several thousand US military personnel are stationed at bases in Jordan.

The attack was the first by the United States against Iran in a month and appeared to be limited rather than a resumption of large-scale American bombing. But the back-and-forth raises the risk of a new round of military strikes by both sides.

Captain Tim Hawkins, a spokesperson for Central Command, said that Iran’s Revolutionary Guard had been observed preparing to launch rockets armed with mines from Larak Island into the waters of the surrounding strait, a vital shipping waterway for oil and gas.

As of last week, US forces had cleared the mines that Iran had planted in the strait, according to Admiral Brad Cooper, the head of Central Command.

Immediately after the US strikes, the Revolutionary Guard said the attack “will be responded to with punishment on the aggressor,” according to Iran’s state broadcaster. Iranian news agency Tasnim said that two people had been killed in the strikes, a claim that could not be immediately confirmed. The Pentagon did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

The Trump administration has urged commercial vessels to make the passage, with the US Navy guiding them through the southern part of the strait in Omani waters.

US military officials have said that Navy ships as well as Air Force jets and Army helicopters are monitoring the strait closely and are prepared to attack Iranian forces that threaten commercial ships transiting the waterway.

Passing through the strait remains perilous. Two seafarers have been killed in the past two weeks, and another is missing. In total, there have been at least 71 attacks on ships since the start of the war, and 19 sailors have been killed.

In June, Iran and the United States signed a deal to reopen the strait, and for three days more than 60 ships passed through daily. But the agree-

ment fell apart, and US forces reimposed a blockade on Iranian ports. Iran has sought to assert its control by creating a new system in which it charges ships for passage through the strait, which was previously free.

The turmoil has forced many shipping companies to bypass the strait. Saudi Arabia, the region’s biggest oil producer, has shifted to export more crude via the Red Sea.

The strike Sunday was the first the Pentagon has acknowledged against Iran since Central Command struck dozens of targets inside Iran on July 29, including command centers, missile and drone facilities, and coastal surveillance sites.

Larger-scale bombings by both countries have transitioned into a pause of military operations, and the Trump administration has focused instead on a series of new economic sanctions against the government in Iran.

The turn to using sanctions came as the administration weighs diminished munitions stockpiles after months of war, sparking concerns that the prolonged conflict could undermine military readiness in other parts of the globe.

As the conflict grinds on, President Trump’s talk of finding a quick end to the war also appears to be fading. He stressed last week that he’s “not in a hurry” to get Iran back to the negotiating table, and he continues making the case that the Islamic Republic’s leadership is on the ropes.

Appointments to Iran’s senior security leadership in the past month, however, have signaled Tehran’s defiance after weathering decades of sanctions as well as a lack of tolerance for dissent at home.

Trump has consistently emphasized that the US and Israeli campaign has been devastating for Iran’s navy and air force. Iranian officials have said the country has suffered \$270 billion in direct and indirect damage. Israeli military strikes in the first weeks of the war wiped out much of the theocratic government’s leadership structure.

But Iran has found leverage through its strikes against vessels on the Strait of Hormuz, where relatively few ships carrying oil and liquefied natural gas are risking passage. Iran still has enough drones and missiles to fire at vessels transiting the waterway through which 20 percent of the world’s oil normally flows.

Crude oil prices rose Sunday in response to the US attack. The price for a barrel of US oil went up 1.8 percent to \$84.94, while the price for a barrel of Brent crude, the international standard, rose 1.9 percent to \$89.79.

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report.

Far right leading in a German state, but that won’t end power struggle

Officials warn AfD ties to Putin endanger secrets

By Christopher F. Schuetz and Jim Tankersley

NEW YORK TIMES

BERLIN — Government leaders across Germany are publicly and privately exploring ways to curb the power of the far-right Alternative for Germany party, or AfD, if it wins control of a state government in elections on Sept. 6.

The officials’ efforts, detailed in interviews and in statements by top officials, include attempts to throttle the routine sharing of certain classified information with state-level intelligence services should the AfD win control of them. They also involve less onerous measures aimed at policy matters. The planning is driven partly out of fear that AfD officials could pass national secrets to Russia, to which the party maintains close ties.

The AfD is poised to win the

most votes in Sept. 6 elections in the state of Saxony-Anhalt in Germany’s east. If it secures enough seats to form a governing coalition by itself, it will become the first far-right party since World War II to hold power in Germany.

Governing a state would typically grant a party access to national secrets, including about intelligence and security.

Many officials seeking to curb the AfD’s power see it as a threat to German democracy and national security, and say their plans are necessary to safeguard the country. Protection of democracy is a particularly sensitive issue in Germany, which after World War II designed its institutions to prevent extreme parties like the Nazis from ever returning to power.

The AfD’s rival parties consider it extreme. No other major party in Germany will work with it to form a government at the state or national level, a collusion known in Germany as “the firewall” and that the AfD has long assailed.



JENS SCHLÜTER/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Ulrich Siegmund is the far-right Alternative for Germany’s main candidate in the Saxony-Anhalt state election.

Boris Pistorius, Germany’s defense minister, told the tabloid news outlet Bild this summer that he would not pass classified information to an AfD government. He cited the AfD’s closeness to Russian President Vladimir Putin, whom party leaders have praised.

“Their affinity for Putin is impossible to overlook,” Pistorius said. “To seriously believe that

we should carelessly let this information fall into the wrong hands, I think it’s obvious that must not happen.”

In the eyes of the AfD and its supporters, those efforts are an attempt to trample the will of voters and thwart its policy agenda, which includes deporting migrants and banning gay Pride flags in schools.

“It’s not democratic, not po-

litical, and not proper — it’s just kind of dirty,” Ulrich Siegmund, the AfD’s candidate for governor in Saxony-Anhalt, said in an interview on the Austrian populist channel ServusTV.

AfD officials in Saxony-Anhalt did not respond to repeated emailed requests for comment on the efforts to curb the party’s power should it win.

In many cases, planning to curb the AfD is happening in secret, for fear that discussions will be leaked to the press and feed the party’s narrative that the German federal government is obstructing voters’ will.

Federal intelligence services have labeled the AfD as suspected of being right-wing extremist. It also maintains connections to Russia, an increasingly hostile adversary. Elected officials from the AfD have set off a political furor by seeking to reveal national security secrets, some of which relate to Germany’s support for Ukraine, that could benefit Russian military planning. German officials have accused Russia of sabotage, cyberattacks, and oth-

er efforts to undermine German social cohesion.

The AfD is leading the polls in two states, Saxony-Anhalt and Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania, that will vote next month. Both lie in the former East Germany, an AfD stronghold, where party leaders have harnessed social media and local organizing to appeal to voters frustrated by economic stagnation, immigration, and cultural change.

The AfD appears close to an outright majority of seats in Saxony-Anhalt. That would allow it to form a government without the help of any other party, bypassing the firewall. Federal intelligence classifies the AfD in Saxony-Anhalt as confirmed extremist. Its potential ascent has some officials contemplating extreme steps under German law.

The country’s constitution was written by survivors of the Nazi era after the war. To prevent extremist forces from taking power again, it allows the federal government to take over state police forces if the country’s “free democratic order” is in danger.

Police use of traffic cameras raises eyebrows

►SURVEILLANCE
Continued from Page A1

dispute: whether Mayor Michelle Wu’s administration should have sought permission from the City Council first under an ordinance governing deployment of surveillance technology that took effect in 2022.

Two councilors said that they were unaware of the pilots and that Wu’s administration should have publicly come to them first.

“Bostonians have been clear about the issues of surveillance expanding without public input, transparency, and accountability,” Councilor Julia Mejia said in a statement. “Our communities deserve answers regarding the procurement, implementation, use, and access to data of all technologies used to monitor individuals.”

Added Councilor Benjamin Weber, who serves as the council representative on the city’s Surveillance Oversight Advisory Board: “If the city does employ [the technology], it was supposed to seek the approval of the council first.”

Wu’s office said city councilors approved the use of automatic license-plate readers in 2022. The ordinance outlines data protection and retention policies, but doesn’t specify vendors, models, or devices. Wu’s office declined to comment further.

Axon and Motorola Solutions did not respond to a request for comment.

The special orders, signed by Police Commissioner Michael Cox, include conditions that ban officers from using the cameras for personal uses and limiting searches to “legitimate law enforcement purposes.” The records also order periodic audits.

The documents say the data the department collects is confidential, but, similar to Flock Safety, may be shared with out-

side law enforcement officers. Those requests, however, may be denied if “overly intrusive or otherwise inconsistent” with laws, department policies, or city ordinances, including the Boston Trust Act, which restricts police from cooperating with federal immigration authorities.

Boston is required under the ordinance to report its use of surveillance technology annually. The next report, which is expected to disclose the pilots, is slated for release in upcoming weeks.

Police have hailed the technology as instrumental in solving some crimes and locating stolen vehicles or missing people.

“The technology itself has been around for many years,” Mariellen Burns, a Boston police spokesperson, said. “More recently, various vendors have offered branded versions. The city does pilot programs to evaluate new or upgraded technology and the vendor. Information related to these trials is included in the annual surveillance report.”

Boston had a 90-day pilot with Flock last year, in which it deployed 45 cameras but ultimately decided not to extend it. Officials did not say why at the time.

Still, critics have the same concerns for Motorola and Axon that they do for Flock.

Flock’s “competitors aren’t so great either,” the American Civil Liberties Union said in a blog post Tuesday. “. . . [S]imply replacing Flock surveillance with another company’s surveillance won’t necessarily solve any of the privacy and other civil liberties problems posed by this mass surveillance technology.”

All three vendors use artificial intelligence to identify and log unique, searchable features of every vehicle that drives past



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Traffic flowed past an Axon automatic license-plate reader camera this month in Silver Spring, Md. Boston police have been using Axon cameras in a pilot program.

them. Motorola even places cameras on tow trucks and other fleet vehicles so that as they drive around they log even more license-plate data, which it sells to police for an extra charge, according to the ACLU post.

“Transform license plates into leads with patented, powerful vehicle location analytics and access to billions of detections beyond your own,” the Motorola Solutions website says.

Axon, formerly known as Taser, is a key vendor to law enforcement with its well-known electroshock weapons as well as body cameras, dashboard cameras, and a cloud data storage service. Its dash cams have license-plate-reading technology built in. The company markets its tools to police through bundling multiple services in long-term contracts, according to the ACLU post, raising concerns

about communities becoming locked in the ecosystem.

A Flock spokesperson said the company welcomes agencies evaluating different vendors.

“We’re confident in Flock’s technology and believe we are leading the industry when it comes to privacy safeguards, transparency, and accountability,” the spokesperson said.

In recent months, dozens of police departments and municipalities across the country — including at least 19 in Massachusetts — have opted out of contracts with Flock, the most popular automatic license-plate-reader manufacturer.

At least four officers in Massachusetts were placed on leave this month over accusations of improper personal or suspicious searches.

Gideon Epstein, policy counsel at the ACLU of Massachu-

setts, said police should need warrants to search the data. The ACLU is also pushing for state legislation to limit data retention, restrict data sharing, and prohibit abuse of the technology.

The Boston pilot policies list appropriate uses of the technology, and address some privacy concerns. Use of the system, the documents read, “should be conducted in the least intrusive manner as necessary.” Searches must include a reason, a case number (unless there are “exigent circumstances”), and align with the “geographic and temporal needs of the incident or investigation.”

The Motorola pilot policy also states the data collected by Boston cannot be easily shared with departments in other cities or states.

External law enforcement agencies seeking license-plate

data would have to submit individual requests for specific searches through the Boston Regional Intelligence Center, a federally funded center that blends data and surveillance tools for law enforcement purposes. The Axon pilot includes similar language, but adds that BPD officers will not have access to data captured by the company’s cameras in other municipalities.

During a May 2025 budget hearing, Cox said Boston launched the Flock pilot to evaluate updated technology before deciding how to replace an aging system. Boston police have used variations of license-plate readers in more than a decade.

But Mejia, the Boston councilor, raised broader concerns about a “growing surveillance state” and worried that despite restrictions and guardrails, the data could still find its way to federal immigration authorities.

Flock has said it does not have a contract with ICE, although some police departments have used the technology to assist the federal agency. Axon holds multimillion dollar contracts with the Department of Homeland Security for Tasers and body cameras.

Audit logs from last year show ICE officials were able to directly query Motorola’s database, according to the ACLU.

The controversy around Flock has been a boon for its competitors.

Axon CEO Rick Smith said on a recent earnings call that “a significant number of agencies want to come over to Axon and convert from existing license-plate readers.”

The reason, he said, was “the controls and privacy work that we’ve done around this space.”

Yogev Toby can be reached at yogev.toby@globe.com.

Cannabis repeal would be nuisance but not barrier, users say

►CANNABIS
Continued from Page A1

eight years being able to buy weed as easily as a bottle of wine or a lottery ticket. The Globe interviewed more than two dozen consumers, and many said they would turn to a patchwork of workarounds — legal or otherwise — if Question 8 were to pass.

Some, like Scipione, said they would revert to the illicit market. Others said they would trek to recreational dispensaries in states such as Maine or Rhode Island, seek a medical card, or flout the rules and grow their own.

Many said legal cannabis helped them live fuller and happier lives. Among nearly all of them, one thing was certain: They weren’t going to let a referendum keep them from their reefer.

“One thing I love saying is, ‘If there’s weed, there’s a way,’” said Joshua DeLillo, an employee at a dispensary in Boston who said he would likely cultivate his own marijuana plants, as he’s done in the past.

Recent polling indicates the ballot measure could be a long-shot. But if it passes, the changes would likely force plenty of tough decisions. A recent report by the Cannabis Control Commission found that, between 2019 and 2023, about 14 percent of Massachusetts residents surveyed reported using cannabis daily or nearly every day.

“It’s really a valuable part of my life,” said Arlington resident Maddy Webster, 79. She said she smokes weed or takes gummies at least every two weeks, when she gets together with friends to play “bad guitar and bad ukulele.”

Walking away from weed for good, she added, would “be like never going to a movie again.”

For some, the ballot question evokes images of the speakeasies and bathtub-brewed gin of a century ago, when the sale of alcohol was banned in the US during Prohibition.

“I have great-grandparents who were bootleggers in the South,” said Willie Burnley Jr., a former Somerville city councilor and a weed advocate. “So I have no doubt that if this were to pass, it would do very little to stop the consumption of cannabis.”

Of course, some of those Pro-



PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Joshua DeLillo had a joint of Jamaican Lambs Bread at a park near his home in Boston after rolling it (below).

hibition-era outlaws got arrested, and the same fate could befall those who refuse to stop consuming cannabis if Question 8 goes through.

The underground market has historically embroiled its participants in legal trouble, with people of color being disproportionately targeted. The law that protected higher limits for home possession would disappear. And crossing state lines with cannabis runs afoul of federal law, though some are skeptical that would mean much.

“That would be very difficult to enforce,” said Alanna Moss, 41, of Malden, who said she would likely go to Maine for her cannabis.

Wendy Wakeman, spokesperson for the Coalition for a Healthy Massachusetts, the group behind the ballot question, said the measure was intended to improve public health amid concerns of impaired driving and potential mental health impacts. If it passes, consumers must decide whether or not they want to follow the new law of the land, she said.

“Their business is complying or not complying, and facing the consequences,” Wakeman said.



The underground market has other risks as well, including marijuana of questionable quality, or even laced with other dangerous substances.

Even so, the report by the state cannabis commission found 24 percent of people who had used cannabis in the past 12 months reported sourcing their

weed from an underground dealer between 2019 and 2023, despite the availability of dispensaries.

Kelly Moriarty, a 27-year-old who works at a dispensary in Webster, said she thinks she would be able to navigate the illicit market safely, but worries about people less familiar with

the underground terrain.

“That’s when it’s going to start getting kind of scary, especially with the influx of other drugs,” said Moriarty, adding that she would likely seek a medical card for chronic back pain. “It feels silly to take steps back in that way.”

For those who qualify, the

tax-free medical market is one legal route the ballot question would not touch. In that respect, Henry Mayer, 30, is ahead of the curve.

The ballot measure, Mayper said, “was finally the kick in the butt” he needed to get a medical card to help him manage his anxiety, depression, and fibromyalgia. He was referred to Leafwell, a health-tech platform that advertises its ability to help patients be “approved for your medical card online in minutes.” The effort cost less than \$100.

The only problem? There are no medical dispensaries nearby him in Lynn, and Mayper doesn’t drive. So for now, he’s sticking with recreational. The medical card offers him “a level of security,” he said, though if Question 8 passes, “it will still screw me up.”

All the potential hassles raise a somewhat obvious option: If the ballot measure prevails, why don’t people just quit? It’s a complicated question, particularly as a recent national study showed problem use of cannabis is on the rise.

A number of people told the Globe their use of the drug is woven into everyday routines — a port in the storm they’re not willing to give up.

Jackie Sawicky, 46, has ADHD and says she takes edibles daily to help her focus. Dan Reynolds, 64, finds smoking roughly every other day has helped him drink less alcohol.

“I don’t see it being the type of thing that I would just be like, ‘Well, OK, well, so much for that,’” said David Parillo, 45, adding that he would likely get another medical card for back pain. Taking gummies or vaping once a week or so, Parillo said, has become “part of my routine.”

Noah Risley, 24, takes edibles three to four times a week. “Sometimes my mind is racing, and it helps me get into a more relaxed state,” said Risley, who uses they/them pronouns. Risley said they have considered whether a repeal would, in fact, compel them to just stop.

“Maybe, but I think out of spite, probably not,” Risley said. “I think like any consumer, you take something away, I’ll get it somewhere else.”

Dana Gerber can be reached at dana.gerber@globe.com. Follow her @danagerber6.

EDITORIAL

Guardians speak for incapacitated adults who can’t

The heartbreaking scenario occurs daily: A patient is ready to leave the hospital for a nursing home or rehabilitation facility, but they have dementia or another ailment that renders them incapable of decision-making. No family member is authorized to sign them into another facility, so the patient remains hospitalized.

When someone lacks a guardian, it stops the patient from getting care they need. It also creates a bottleneck in hospital discharges, tying up a bed that could be used for someone else.

According to the Massachusetts Health and Hospital Association, in May, Massachusetts hospitals reported having 70 patients awaiting a guardian before they could be discharged. A report on guardianship released by the Massachusetts Department of Public Health on Aug. 4 estimates that there are more than 3,000 patients a year who require appointment of a guardian and whose hospital discharge is delayed.

To say Massachusetts has a system for appointing guardians for incapacitated adults would be an exaggeration. Rather, Massachusetts has a patchwork of solutions that’s resulted in a guardian shortage with no guarantee guardians are providing appropriate services.

Lawmakers should make it easier to designate a family member as a temporary decision-maker. More importantly, Massachusetts should establish a public guardian program through which qualified people are paid to be guardians for indigent clients.

Maintaining the status quo means the problem will only worsen as baby boomers age and medical advances keep more people alive. Mass General Brigham associate general counsel Joshua Abrams said already, compared to several years ago, there are fewer available guardians, a greater need, and more overwork among guardians.

“We have an aging population, many of whom don’t have family,” said Boston attorney Brandon

Saunders, who handles guardianship cases. “We’re going to have to face the reality that we have to protect our elders, and it will cost money.”

In the best-case scenario, a person designates a health care proxy before they become incapacitated. Without that, a relative, friend, clergy, or acquaintance can petition the court to be declared a guardian.

The system breaks down, however, when a patient doesn’t have someone to be their guardian.

There are three state agencies that help people find and pay for guardians, but eligibility and space are limited. There are separate court-ordered programs for people in nursing homes with MassHealth coverage or in psychiatric facilities, with guardians reimbursed up to \$100 a month. If a patient has money, a professional guardian can petition the court for reimbursement for the guardian’s work.

But if the patient is indigent and ineligible for state programs, the system relies on unpaid volunteers — often lawyers or social workers working pro bono or retirees. This is unsustainable.

The Department of Public Health report says hospitals’ attorneys typically approach four to 13 people to find one guardian. Saunders said his firm files about 50 petitions a month on behalf of hospitals and families, and a dearth of professional guardians causes “huge delays.” “It’s not uncommon to continue a hearing week after week because we haven’t found someone,” Saunders said. The system doesn’t ensure guardians are properly trained or have a caseload that lets them attend to each client.

The best solution would be to create a system that imposes qualification and training requirements on guardians, with funding that ensures guardians are paid for their time, even if a patient has no money.

The Massachusetts Guardianship Policy Institute has spent six years piloting a demonstration program. Wynn Gerhard, the institute’s Elder Justice Fellow, said the institute uses \$1 million in private funding to

pay people to serve as a “guardian of last resort” for 80 clients in Suffolk, Plymouth, and Norfolk counties. Each guardian is limited to 20 clients, and the institute spends around \$11,000 annually per client. Gerhard said nursing homes are happy to have guardians who return their calls, and guardians have helped patients leave nursing homes for community-based living. “We try to make the point that this is what good guardianship is, this is how it can be done, and it saves money and is better for the health care system and patients,” Gerhard said.

The Department of Public Health report estimates that creating a public guardianship program for 3,100 to 4,950 people a year would cost between \$31 million and \$54.5 million. But if fewer people need services, the cost would be less. At least three states — Colorado, Washington, and Oregon — have state-funded guardianship programs, which cost between \$686,000 and \$8 million to serve between 81 and 420 people, according to the DPH report.

The report also recommends passing a “default surrogate” law, creating an expedited way for family members to become medical decision-makers when someone has no health care proxy. Massachusetts is one of just four states without this type of law. A bill reported out of the Judiciary Committee in 2025 would let a physician appoint a surrogate decision-maker, with priority going to the patient’s spouse, then adult children, then other family members, with guidelines the physician and surrogate must follow. There are legitimate concerns about whether default surrogate laws adequately protect patients’ rights. But there are ways to craft a law narrowly, so a surrogate is given limited powers for a limited time.

Hospitals want change because stuck patients impact their bottom line, but the more important reason to change policy is common human decency: If an elderly woman alone in the hospital needs someone to speak for her, she should have a qualified person to do so.

Here’s how to get your son to vote

By John Della Volpe

John Della Volpe is the director of polling at the Harvard Kennedy School Institute of Politics and the author of “Fight: How Gen Z Is Channeling Their Fear and Passion to Save America.”

As a pollster focused on young people, I am often asked: What can I do to get my son, or my grandson, to vote? Men are less likely than women to register and to cast a ballot, and have had lower turnout in every presidential election for decades.

And while that gap is not new, it now sits

I have spent more than two decades listening to young Americans through polling, focus groups, town halls, and now AI-enabled conversations. And when I listen to young men who have checked out of politics, what I hear most is not indifference. For many, the decision not to vote is a conclusion they’ve reached. They have decided that politics — and the system around it — simply is not worth their time. They have reasons for believing that, and they will tell you what they are.

“Voting sucks. It’s not real. They already choose who’s gonna win and who’s gonna lose. We’re wasting our time,” a 24-year-old man in Georgia told me in February.

Others question whether one vote carries

like versions of the same complaint. They aren’t. Each reflects a different argument, and each requires a different kind of conversation.

So how do you reach a young man who has already checked out? Here are five things I have learned from listening to them.

Lead with the one thing he still trusts: you

When these young men are asked who they trust to help them make sense of the world, they do not name an influencer, the media, or a political party. Again and again, they name their families.

“I think the person that I would trust the most would probably be my parents. I mean, they’ve been here longer than I have. It’s part of their job,” a 24-year-old man in Missouri said in an interview in March. “So if I ever need any sort of life advice, they’re the people I would first go to.”

That is why a parent or grandparent can sometimes get through where a campaign ad or social media post cannot. You already have something that those messengers don’t: a relationship with the prospective voter. The moment he feels managed, lectured, or recruited, he will likely tune out.

Don’t open with “you need to vote.” Open with your experiences, what you care about, what you’re worried about, and what you plan to do. Let it be a conversation.

Don’t argue with the cynicism, reframe it

The instinct is to argue him out of “my vote doesn’t matter.” Don’t. When young men get pushback, they dig in.

“I tend to stay away from politics because I think it’s a waste of time,” a 28-year-old man said in April. “We don’t have any say in anything that happens. It’s not like our vote is going to matter.”

When young men talk about the presidency or federal government, what comes through is powerlessness. So don’t argue that one vote will decide a national race. Shrink the frame: discuss the school board, the district attorney, the ballot measure, the local race decided by a few hundred votes.

Acknowledge how he feels about Washington, and then show him where his vote has more visible weight. You are not talking him out of his cynicism. You are showing him where it stops being true.

Tie the vote to what he already cares about

Ask young men what they value, and politics is rarely the first thing they mention. Their people are. Their future is.

“Realizing that I have loved ones — my mom, my grandparents, my friends, people that care for me,” a 19-year-old man in Ohio said in April when asked what matters to him.

“The job market’s kind of rough. It’s hard to get a job that pays well to be able to support a family,” a 26-year-old man in Arizona said in April.

Neither starts with politics. They start with family, work, and the future they hope to build.

So don’t begin a lecture on voting with democracy in the abstract. Begin with what already matters to him — a good job, a home, a family, a life he wants to build — and help him see where voting connects to these real issues.

Make the next step small, concrete, and shared

Even the young men most checked out on the presidency will still do something for people they care about. So don’t make voting a belief he has to adopt. Make it a thing you do together on a Tuesday: “Help me figure out my ballot”; “Come with me”; “Can you look this measure up for me?”

The goal is to lower the stakes. Participation can come before conviction.

Leave the door open

This may be the hardest part. Sometimes what you hear is a settled decision. Sometimes it is just frustration, anxiety, or exhaustion; emotions that can change with time.

These young men have written off the system, the media, and the politicians, but they have not written off their families. This guide can be condensed into a few sentences: Don’t argue, anchor. Don’t sell voting as a duty to a country your loved one thinks has failed him. Make it one small, shared act, connected to the people he loves and the future he wants.

You may not change his mind in one conversation. The goal is to keep the door open long enough for the next one. That is where the opportunity lies.



HEATHER HOPP-BRUCE/GLOBE STAFF; ACCORIN/ADOBE

inside a much larger national conversation about young men — whether they are falling behind educationally, economically, socially, and increasingly, civically.

Our research at the Harvard Kennedy School Institute of Politics has been documenting this disengagement for years. Among young Americans, trust in government has fallen to new lows, half now say people like them have no say in what the government does, and only about one-third say they definitely plan to vote this fall. For young men, that loss of faith compounds an already persistent turnout gap.

any weight at all. “At the end of the day, one person’s vote doesn’t matter on a scale of millions,” a 20-year-old man in California said in June.

And then there is resignation. “I guess there’s really not much that we can do with the government,” a 19-year-old man in North Dakota said in March. “The government will end up doing what they want. And you know what? It is what it is.”

Listen carefully and you hear three different ideas: rigged — “they already choose”; pointless — “on a scale of millions”; and resigned — “it is what it is.” They can sound

INBOX

For trafficked women, group closes a key gap in frayed safety net

South End neighbors urge community to support this work

We are encouraged to see the compassionate light shone on the victims of sex trafficking in our city and on the work that Dr. Abigail Judge and Sandra Andrade of the Boston Human Exploitation Advocacy Team do on their behalf (“A lifeline for trafficked women at Mass. and Cass,” Metro, Aug. 23). Claire Thornton’s article uncovered the challenging layers of trafficking and addiction. Her reporting provided an illuminating portrait of the invaluable work Judge and Andrade do and demonstrated in keen detail how HEAT fills a critical unmet need for some of Boston’s most marginalized women.

As residents in the community and active supporters of HEAT, we encourage our fellow neighbors to take a closer look at how they can become more educated and further their understanding of these women’s plight. South Enders can take heart that their neighbors are listening and acting to restore dignity and agency to a vulnerable group of women.

Compassionate, trauma-informed services are essential to creating pathways to safety, healing, and recovery. We are grateful to those doing this difficult work and urge our community to stand with them.

DIANE SMITH
Boston

WENDY PRICE
Boston

This letter was cosigned by four other residents of the South End.

Boston HEAT has created a lifeline — now let’s fund it

Nine women dead since 2024, according to the Boston Human Exploitation Advocacy Team. That number should stop this city cold.

I live in the South End, a few blocks from Mass. and Cass, and I have volunteered with HEAT for the past year. Before that, I did not understand how many women in the area were being sexually exploited or how few organizations can help someone facing trafficking, addiction, homelessness, and trauma all at once. Our systems treat these as separate problems, and women fall through the gaps between them.

What makes HEAT work is consistency: the same corner every Tuesday and Friday; a phone answered at 3 a.m.; care that does not withdraw when recovery gets complicated. For women whose lives have been shaped by trauma and abandonment, this relationship is not incidental. It is the intervention. Since 2024, as Claire Thornton reports, the Boston Police Department Human Trafficking Unit has referred more than 120 victims to HEAT, which hired a third staff member in June.

Boston does not need to invent another solution. The city, the state, and our hospitals and foundations should fund this one. The lifeline exists. Strengthen it.

CAROLYN NASH
Boston

The writer serves on HEAT’s board of advisers.

Milton’s schools want to know where you’re from

School leaders lack a feel for what marginalized communities go through

Re “Milton alters residency test amid criticism: Role of police in checking students still contentious” (Page A1, Aug. 21): I am a Milton resident with two children in the schools. After tuning in to the first hour of the School Committee meeting Wednesday night, I had to stop watching because it was too stressful.

At some point, the interim superintendent of schools and some members of the School Committee did indicate that policies surrounding the town’s enforcement of student residency requirements will be looked into. However, I was disappointed that both parties seemed to miss the opportunity to truly empathize with and acknowledge what marginalized communities go through each and every day. Instead they appeared to deflect, digging their heels in and excusing their methods, including using police to investigate where families live, in the interest of following policy.

I asked my husband: Would a person be considered racist if they can’t acknowledge racist behaviors? I feel that key people on Wednesday evening were trying to hide behind unacceptable actions because it was the policy. Some policies should not exist, but Milton should also look at how the policy is interpreted and applied.

CAMILLE SANABRIA-COOPER
Milton

ZIP code, family wealth should not be deciding factors for quality education

The Globe’s reporting on Milton’s residency investigations raises legitimate concerns. Black students make up less than 12 percent of Milton Public Schools enrollment yet accounted for nearly half of students investigated for residency. That disparity deserves examination.

But John Hilliard’s article also raises a larger question: Why might Boston families living just across the Milton line be so determined to send their children to Milton schools that some would risk a residency investigation?

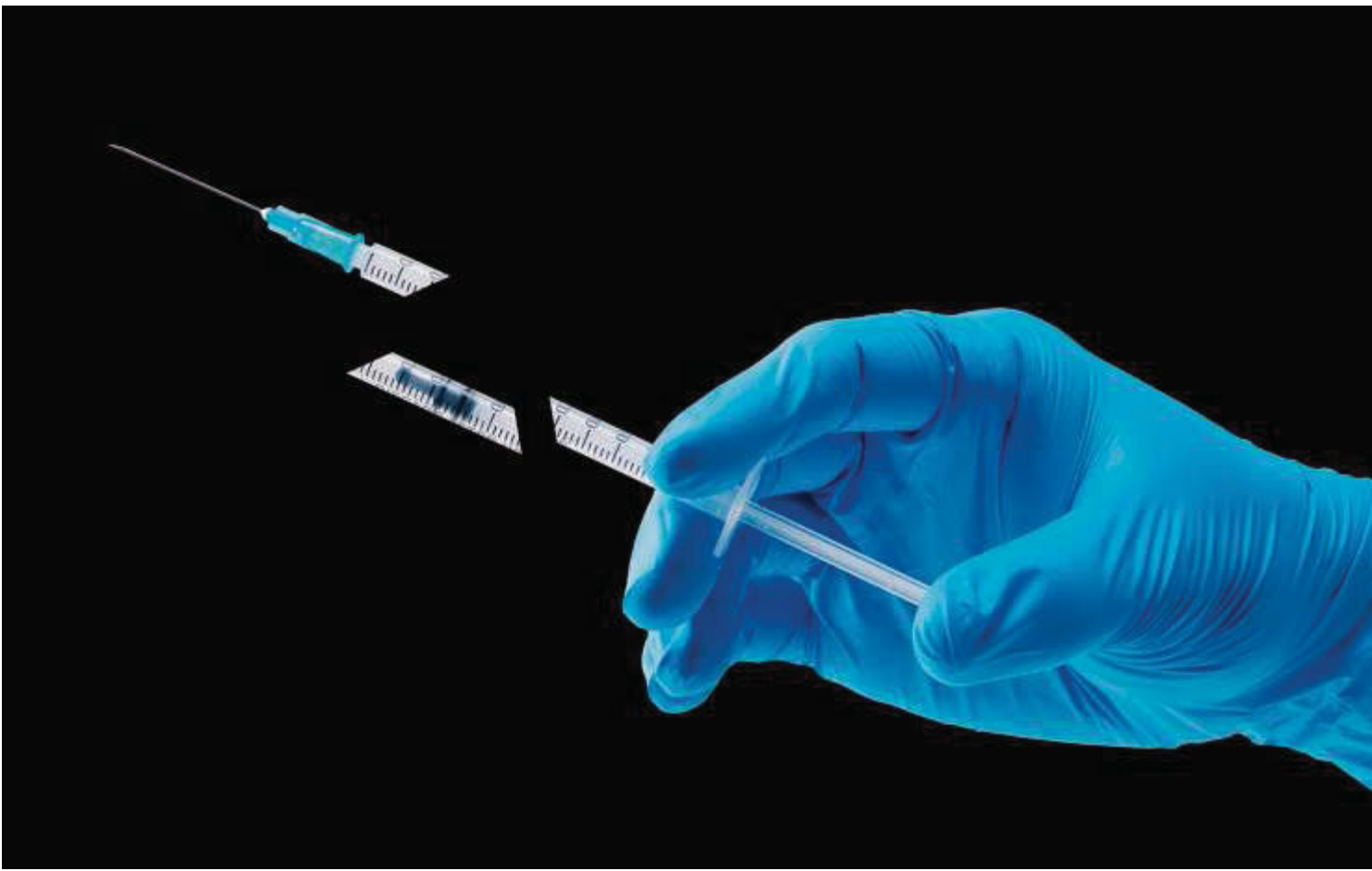
Two children can live a mile apart, possess the same potential, and have equally committed parents. Yet crossing a municipal boundary can provide access to a vastly different educational environment.

We should ask whether Black families are being disproportionately investigated. We should also ask why a family’s address — and its ability to afford housing in a particular community — can so strongly influence the public education available to its children.

Residency rules should be enforced fairly, and families should not falsify where they live. But residency fraud may be a symptom of a larger inequity.

The Globe has examined who is being investigated. Perhaps the larger question is why what lies behind schoolhouse doors differs so greatly depending upon a child’s ZIP code and family wealth.

ED MCDONOUGH
Norwood



HEATHER HOPP-BRUCE/GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE

Don’t make it harder to vaccinate kids

By Ashish K. Jha

Dr. Ashish K. Jha is a senior fellow at the Belfer Center at Harvard Kennedy School and a contributing Globe Opinion writer.

Turn on your kitchen tap and water comes out. You don’t test it. You don’t decide each morning whether it is safe to drink. Someone has already made those decisions, upstream, at a treatment plant you will probably never see, so that you wouldn’t have to.

That is one of the things a good public health system does. It takes interventions we know work and builds them into everyday life: treated drinking water, pasteurized milk, fortified flour, routine childhood vaccination. People can always opt out, but getting the health benefit requires little effort.

Other health decisions appropriately remain more individual. A mammogram and a colonoscopy, for example, still require a patient to decide whether and

The practical burden would fall overwhelmingly on parents who already intend to vaccinate.

when to have the test. Public policy can remove obstacles surrounding that choice. That is the logic behind the Affordable Care Act’s requirement that many preventive services be covered without copays or deductibles. There is no default choice (patients aren’t automatically scheduled for a mammogram) and the decision to test remains with the patient, but cost is less likely to be a factor in their decision.

Some people might find this paternalistic. Who gets to decide which care should become routine and which should remain proactive choices? That is an important question. But no one designs these systems from a blank state. Someone decides how many medical visits are required, which vaccines are combined, what insurance covers, and what clinicians routinely recommend. Every system therefore creates defaults and obstacles. The question is whether those choices reflect strong evidence and make it easier for people to act on the measures that keep them and their families healthy.

The stronger the evidence, and the more the benefit extends beyond the person deciding, the stronger the case for a simple, protective default. When the evidence is uncertain or values genuinely differ, individual choice should play a larger role.

Which brings us to childhood vaccination.

A White House executive order signed this month calls for moving toward administering measles, mumps, and rubella, currently delivered in a single combined vaccination, as three separate vaccines. It also mandates that, “to the maximum extent feasible,” childhood immunizations should be given at separate medical visits.

Stand-alone measles, mumps, and rubella vaccines

are not currently available in the United States, and developing and licensing them would probably take years. But the direction of the policy matters now because it reverses one of the basic principles that has made childhood vaccination successful: make it easy for families to complete the recommended schedule.

The practical burden would fall overwhelmingly on parents who already intend to vaccinate. A parent determined to refuse vaccination will refuse whether or not the schedule requires one visit or three. For everyone else, additional visits create additional barriers regarding work, child care, and ease of scheduling appointments.

Confusion creates its own obstacles. The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention’s website states plainly that no published scientific evidence shows a benefit from separating the combined MMR vaccine. Yet administration officials have publicly encouraged manufacturers to produce separate vaccines, while a Health and Human Services spokesperson suggested that stand-alone shots might reduce side effects, a wholly evidence-free claim. Parents trying to do the right thing are now left sorting through conflicting signals from their own government. Some will postpone vaccinations while they figure out whom to believe. Some may never return to the question.

Critics of the childhood vaccine schedule have spent years arguing that children get too many shots. Yet splitting MMR would turn two injections into six.

Japan offers a useful lesson. It withdrew its MMR vaccine in 1993 after a safety problem involving the mumps strain used there. Even after Japan switched to a safer strain, coverage remained low, and the country experienced recurrent mumps outbreaks. The splitting was a major cause of the decline in vaccination. This May, Japanese regulators approved a new combined MMR vaccine.

None of this means combination vaccines should be immune from scientific scrutiny. They should be continuously evaluated, just like every other medical intervention.

But here’s the key point: Strong evidence can persuade people to do the right thing. But good intentions compete with a missed bus, a sick sibling, an emergency shift at work. A parent can fully intend to vaccinate and still miss an appointment.

That principle reaches far beyond vaccines. Pharmacies default to child-resistant caps on prescription bottles so children are protected. It is possible for a customer to request a non-safety cap if they choose to but almost no one does, making children safer because the protection is already built in. We fortify foods rather than requiring people to purchase vitamins separately. We eliminate copays for preventive care because even small barriers keep people from getting care they already want.

Good public health becomes invisible. The healthier choice is built into the world around us.

We don’t ask parents to test their tap water each morning. A parent who has already decided to protect their child against measles, mumps, and rubella shouldn’t have to make many visits just to see it through.

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A hidden realm holds mysteries and history

►TUNNEL
Continued from Page A1

owned drawbridge that used to carry trains to the tunnel but has been stuck in the upright position for years. If the effort succeeds, the area near the tunnel could be controlled by the city and accessible to the public once again.

The tunnel closed in 1981 and was sealed with large doors in 1993, but intrepid explorers can manage to find a way in through an alternate entrance that has since broken down.

Sandor Bodo, a former Providence Journal photographer who is shooting a documentary about the tunnel, took a handful of people on a tour of the tunnel this summer, revealing a hidden realm filled with vivid graffiti, discarded scooters, dripping stalactites, and unexpected discoveries.

“There are basically three kinds of people that go in there,” Bodo said before plodding through puddles in the dark tunnel, as headlamps illuminated the space. “There’s explorers, wondering what it’s like. There are partygoers, people who have campfires. And then there are artists.” Some visitors who sneak into the tunnel fit all three categories.

The tunnel opened in 1908, bringing trains that crossed the Seekonk River over the Crook Point Bascule Bridge and under the East Side to the former Union Station in downtown Providence. The last train went through the tunnel in 1981.

The tunnel runs west from Gano Street to North Main Street, where it comes out just north of the bus tunnel, still in use. At one point, the flat surface of the train tunnel passes under the bus portion, which is on an incline.

Sam Kimball wrote his senior thesis, “Breaking Laws and Burning Bridges,” about the tunnel and the drawbridge before graduating from Brown University in 2022.

Kimball said that while the drawbridge serves as a visible monument, the tunnel is the more fascinating place — a hidden world that has formed its own community of frequent visitors.

“It’s interesting aesthetically and historically, but there is a lot more going on than first meets the eye,” he said.

For example, he said that a few years ago members of the neo-Nazi group NSC-131 scrawled graffiti on the walls of the tunnel, which prompted some of the tunnel’s frequent



PHOTOS BY CARLOS MUNOZ/GLOBE STAFF

The East Side railroad tunnel is shut off from the outside neighborhood in Providence. Below ground, it offers a soggy journey through the imaginations of artists.

visitors to cover up the hateful messages.

“In these spaces at the periphery, outside the law in some ways, people are creating their own community and in some ways societies,” Kimball said.

Kimball, who lives in Providence and works in apartment maintenance and renovation, devoted a section of his thesis to the rowdy disturbance that occurred at the tunnel on May 1, 1993.

An estimated 200 to 300 students from Rhode Island School of Design and Brown University gathered in the tunnel to celebrate Beltane, an ancient Celtic fire festival. “The party was a way to celebrate the coming of spring, and incorporated masks, drums, and fire,” Kimball wrote.

As the party grew, RISD security officers arrived. The students told them to leave, saying that they lacked jurisdiction. The Providence police then arrived, with jurisdiction — and pepper gas spray.

“Although many of the partygoers were ready to leave, the arrival of police officers escalated the situation,” Kimball wrote.

The Providence Journal reported that seven police officers were injured in the fracas and three police cruisers were dam-



aged. Eight students were arrested and others were injured.

“Following this incident, the police claimed that they encountered satanic rituals at the party, a perhaps unsurprising misrepresentation of the event,” Kimball wrote. “The general chaos surrounding the event led the city to seal off the tunnel at both ends with large steel barriers.”

Since then, knee-deep water has collected at either end of the tunnel, so the tour with Bodo began with a splash, with participants using walking sticks to balance on submerged railroad ties.

Graffiti artists have treated the tunnel walls as a canvas, painting images ranging from a Smurf holding a can of spray paint to the phrase “The world

has changed.”

One explorer has suggested turning the 5,080-foot-long tunnel into a bar, which would give the smallest state the world’s longest bar.

But stalactites and stalagmites have formed in parts of the tunnel, and calcium deposits have leached out of the cement beneath Brook Street. “It is really the earth taking claim

of it again,” Bodo said.

About halfway through the tunnel there was evidence of other explorers: a green tent, fully assembled on a tarp, but empty, and a homemade dolly, with wheels hugging the railroad tracks, labeled “East Side Underground.”

At the North Main Street end, brilliant rays of sunlight sliced through the edges of sealed doors made of corrugated metal, casting an eerie outline around the door.

The tunnel’s future is in flux, possibly tied to the fate of the Crook Point Bascule Bridge.

The bridge caught fire in 2021, and the state Department of Transportation had planned to demolish it, citing safety concerns. But Providence Mayor Brett Smiley asked lawmakers to allow the city to create a bridge authority. Earlier this year, the General Assembly approved legislation to create an independent authority to acquire, develop, and maintain the bridge.

This past week, a spokesperson for Smiley said the city is working to take ownership of the drawbridge from the state.

“In the months ahead, the city will ... work with the [local] community to create a vision for the public reuse of this historic presence on Providence’s skyline,” the spokesperson said.

The winner of an earlier design contest for the bridge included plans for a trail and park near the tunnel’s eastern entrance. But it’s not clear that will happen now.

As the tour group emerged from the tunnel into the daylight, cars passed close by.

But Bodo said many Providence residents probably don’t know the tunnel is under their feet.

“It’s a strange place, the last place in Providence that’s like a secret thing left over — an industrial remnant left to explore,” he said.

Kimball said a Massachusetts artist wanted to renovate the tunnel in the mold of New York City’s wildly popular High Line converted elevated railway.

“But if I put my 2 cents in, I’d say the most effective use would be some sort of transit,” Kimball said. “It would be a very expensive project. But everything is expensive nowadays, and the more we invest in transit the better.”

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Public health advocates blast Lottery for cartoonish games

►LOTTERY
Continued from Page A1

setts and most other states. While real-money betting requires age verification, advocates argue, these free versions appear designed to hook a new generation of younger gamblers.

“It’s like giving Purdue Pharma permission to distribute opioids inside a day care,” said Les Bernal, national director of Stop Predatory Gambling, a Lawrence nonprofit. “It’s deliberately hooking young people on an extremely addictive product.”

The controversial games are now a focal point in the state treasurer race.

Republican candidate Elizabeth Dionne has recently gone on the offensive against the five-member state Lottery Commission — which is chaired by the state treasurer — accusing it of using “predatory marketing practices” to hook younger players. Dionne, a mother of four from Belmont, is demanding that the state immediately remove the arcade-style games, require age verification for free versions, and order an independent review of how the Lottery designs and markets its products.

“It’s irresponsible for the state to participate in something that an adolescent can get a hold of and be susceptible to lifelong addiction,” Dionne said. “Games built around cartoon animals, arcade-style prizes, or fairy-tale stories create an impression that this is just another colorful app. That impression is dangerous.”

Neither the Lottery Commission nor Treasurer Deborah Goldberg, a Democrat who has

chaired it for 11 years, directly responded to questions from the Globe about how iLottery games are selected and reviewed for age appropriateness.

But a Lottery spokesperson said Massachusetts enforces its 21-and-over requirement using what she called the “most stringent standard” of any US online lottery. Players must verify their identities by providing their full Social Security number, legal name, date of birth, address, and other information. Their accounts are also protected by daily multifactor authentication, verification of new devices, and a one-device login limit. Although unverified users can try the games in “demonstration mode” to learn the mechanics, she stressed that no one can wager money without completing identity verification.

Andrew Napolitano, a spokesperson for the treasurer, said preventing underage gambling is “taken very seriously” and the Lottery continually reviews safeguards to ensure only eligible players can participate. He noted that “The Claw,” “The Lamp,” and “Prize Chickens” are offered by other state lotteries and nearly all allow users to view eInstant games without age verification so prospective players can understand them before betting. The month-old platform is still being evaluated, he said, and modifications are under consideration.

The games are supplied by NeoGames Studio, a studio within Aristocrat Interactive, an Australian company that has developed online lottery platforms for a half-dozen states, including

“The lamp, the claw, the prize chickens, the cartoon figures, the bright colors... are all relatable to elementary school children. It’s Joe Camel all over again.”

JENNIFER KNIGHT-LEVINE, *cofounder of the SAFE Coalition*

New Hampshire. The company did not respond to inquiries from the Globe about how it evaluates whether games appeal to minors. As part of its five-year contract with the state, awarded last August, Aristocrat receives a percentage of the amounts wagered on the games.

State lawmakers authorized the iLottery two years ago in part to keep pace with online sports betting, which has exploded in popularity since its 2022 legalization here. Buying scratch tickets had been woven into local lives long before the introduction of mobile betting. In 2022, for instance, Bay Staters spent an average of \$839 per person on traditional lottery tickets — topping the nation and nearly tripling the national average of \$293, according to a Federal Reserve Bank of Boston analysis.

Last fiscal year, the lottery generated \$5.9 billion in revenue, delivering over \$1 billion in local funding to all 351 Massachusetts cities and towns. It has long been the state’s biggest source of unrestricted local aid.

Though municipal governments have become addicted to that money, several legislators said they were caught off guard

when the state unveiled games that resemble slot machines. Health researchers warn that such fast-paced designs are significantly more addictive than conventional lottery play.

State Representative Adam Scanlon, a North Attleborough Democrat, said he plans to call for stricter oversight of how the Lottery Commission selects its games. Scanlon, vice chair of the House Post Audit and Oversight Committee, criticized the commission for concealing the app’s design and game selection from lawmakers and the public until launch. He also called the lack of age verification for free-play versions a “glaring oversight.”

“A 10-year-old can’t just walk into a bar and sample a bunch of shots for fun,” Scanlon said. “We have to remember that this lottery is being run by the state and should be held to the highest standard.”

Scanlon and others have noted that the iLottery rollout coincides with a troubling surge in underage gambling across Massachusetts.

The state Department of Public Health’s biennial youth health surveys consistently identify lottery and scratch tickets as the most popular form of gambling

among middle and high school students. From 2021 to 2025, the share of high school students who reported playing the lottery rose from 28 percent to 37 percent — an increase of nearly a third. Among middle school students, it climbed from 29.4 percent to 32 percent, according to the state surveys of more than 5,000 students.

From Boston to Springfield, treatment clinics and addiction counseling programs have reported an influx of young people — some as young as 12 — seeking help for gambling problems. Last year alone, Massachusetts regulators reported 171 instances of underage users accessing sports betting sites, which public health advocates call a drastic undercount.

A study released in the past week by the Massachusetts Gaming Commission found that sports betting has become deeply embedded in young adults’ daily lives, dulling perceptions of its risks. Legalization, relentless advertising, and “free money” promotions have made wagering feel as casual as buying a morning coffee, researchers found.

“The state is essentially giving kids free samples of products that are most likely to cause problems of addiction in users, which is a disappointing choice,” said Mark Gottlieb, executive director of the Public Health Advocacy Institute at Northeastern University. “It sets up a situation where a lot of these kids are going to become habitual or problematic gamblers, starting with the Lottery and graduating to other platforms.”

Jennifer Knight-Levine, co-

founder of the SAFE Coalition, a social services agency in Franklin that provides mental health support for youths, said her 5-year-old mistook a genie character in “The Lamp” for Aladdin and asked if he could “make a wish.” Her 7-year-old said “Prize Chickens” reminded him of rides at his favorite amusement park.

She said both children were reluctant to relinquish her phone.

“This is exactly the same marketing ploy that Big Tobacco used to hook kids,” she said. “The lamp, the claw, the prize chickens, the cartoon figures, the bright colors... are all relatable to elementary school children. It’s Joe Camel all over again.”

State Representative Tackey Chan, a Quincy Democrat and co-chair of a joint House and Senate committee on consumer protection and professional licensure, warned the cartoonish designs “clearly blur the line” between youth entertainment and gambling. He said lawmakers and the Lottery Commission need to set clear rules defining child-targeted marketing in gambling.

“Are they just picking these games at random? Have they given any thought to how they might appeal to children?” Chan asked. “I think the Lottery should be able to explain the process by which they chose which types of games [to offer] and what target audience they are trying to reach.”

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For Lander and Gayle, Wu’s backing is key

Mayor’s endorsements give campaigns boost but bring questions about independence

By Niki Griswold
and Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Mayor Michelle Wu’s name is not on the September ballot, but she may be the most high-profile legislative surrogate in recent Boston history. The second-term Democrat has canvassed around the city for Daniel Lander and Latoya Gayle, amplifying their state Senate campaigns on her social media accounts and helping rally volunteers to their cause against incumbents William Brownsberger and Nick Collins. A super PAC backed by Wu-aligned groups has poured tens of thousands of dollars into their bids.

Lander, a former Wu aide, has put his former boss at the center of his elevator pitch. Her presence, however, has also forced the first-time candidates to answer thorny questions. At forums or debates, Lander and Gayle have had to vouch for their independence, and even motivations for simply running. Collins, a South Boston Democrat, has used Wu’s endorsements as something like fodder, arguing voters don’t want a “blind loyalist” to City Hall. Business leaders have questioned whether Wu’s influence in Brownsberger’s district outside Boston is a help or perhaps a hindrance.

“I’m not a puppet for anybody,” Gayle, a Dorchester Democrat, said at a recent candidate forum. “I stand here on my own, and I welcome the endorsement of anybody who thinks that I’m a great candidate and that I’m going to represent this community. ... I am not a proxy for the mayor.” The dynamic is an unusual one, particularly for legislative races that tend to rise and fall on candidates’ résumés and experience, and the needs of a specific district. The races, though, are unusual in themselves. Wu made waves in the Boston political universe when she endorsed Lander, her former policy adviser, and Gayle, an education advocate, against two fellow Democrats representing her city who have also been among her top political adversaries on Beacon Hill. Brownsberger, the Senate’s No. 3 Democrat, and Collins repeatedly helped block her bid to shift more of the city’s property tax burden onto commercial real estate to ease property tax spikes for homeowners. Wu has argued that Lander and Gayle would better represent Boston residents’ interests in a Legislature where other measures she’s pushed, such as bills to limit rent increases in Boston or impose a tax on high-dollar

ELECTION, Page B4



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Fans scrawled messages to former Boston Celtic Jaylen Brown on a board at his 741 Frequency Fest on Boston Common Sunday. Brown, a five-time NBA All-Star, was traded to the Philadelphia 76ers in July.

Fans come together to celebrate a Boston favorite

By Sam Shipman
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Hundreds of No. 7 jerseys filled the Common on Sunday to honor the departure of Celtics superstar Jaylen Brown. Fans gathered to say goodbye to Brown, a five-time NBA All-Star who was traded to the Philadelphia 76ers in July, at 741 Frequency Fest, an event hosted by Brown’s apparel company, the city of Boston, and other groups. Food trucks, backpack giveaways, and stations where young Celtics fans could get their hair cut took over the Common. Children played in bouncy castles, and a school

BROWN, Page B3



DANIEL SARCH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Former Celtic Jaylen Brown pushed a trophy into the crowd during his 741 Frequency Fest on Sunday. The afternoon was filled with music, games, food trucks, and backpack giveaways.

David Hogg sets his sights on Lynch

Aims to oust Eighth District incumbent

Funneling resources to Patrick Roath

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

David Hogg ruffled feathers among Democrats when he pledged to put millions of dollars toward taking on longtime politicians within his own party in a bid to push younger, liberal candidates into office. His biggest test case may come Tuesday. The 26-year-old gun control advocate’s organization, Leaders We Deserve, has put half a million dollars toward unseating US Representative Stephen Lynch, the Eighth District’s 71-year-old unapologetically moderate incumbent who’s become one of Hogg’s top House targets this cycle. Hogg is funneling time and resources behind Patrick Roath, the 39-year-old lawyer and former Deval Patrick aide challenging the congressman. Hogg earlier this year headlined a fundraiser for Roath in Dorchester, walked with Roath and college students along the Freedom Trail, and has papered the district with mailers. On Sunday, Hogg knocked doors in Roslindale with Roath, personally pitching that Roath would bring more fight against the Trump administration to Washington. “This race is not about Stephen Lynch’s age — it’s about his track record,” Hogg told roughly 40 Roath supporters in Roslindale, including state Representative Sam Montaña, Boston City Councilors Enrique Pepén and Ben Weber, and members of the Boston Teachers Union. “I would not be here right now if this race was not very close,” Hogg said. That dynamic has pushed the primary into a stratosphere of races nationwide testing voters’ appetite for replacing longtime Democratic incumbents with younger, often more progressive voices. Roath, who has pledged to bring a “future-oriented, optimistic vision” to Congress, is one of 47 candidates Leaders We Deserve has endorsed this cycle in congressional and state legislative

HOGG, Page B4

Hampshire College loan came from a local LLC

\$29m funds semester, planning for future

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

Hampshire College leadership finally broke its silence on who is behind the \$29.5 million loan that will allow students to not only finish the fall semester, but also give the board more time to figure out the future of the school’s land and legacy, instead of rushing to make decisions under immediate financial pressure. The loan will allow the college “to approach the future of the campus land more deliberately,” Jennifer Chrisler, the school’s president, wrote in an email to the Hampshire community. She named Five College alum Jesse Johnson as the partner behind the newly established Boston-based LLC Arto-carpus Partners and the “extraordinary loan,” which will allow the Amherst-based college to pay off its debts to commercial banks and finish the teach-out as originally planned. The “less pressured timeline” for addressing financial concerns buys time for the board to consider how Hampshire, as a nonprofit, could serve “a meaningful charitable purpose” once academic operations conclude, she added. The mortgage was filed with Hampshire County’s Registry of Deeds Aug. 3

DONOR, Page B4

Fitchburg’s first Latino fire chief sues city for racial bias

By Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

Fitchburg Fire Chief Dante Suarez, the first person of color to lead the fire department, has sued the city and its mayor, alleging whistleblower retaliation and racial discrimination. The complaint filed in Worcester Superior Court accuses Mayor Samantha Squallia of trying to force out Suarez, who was placed on paid leave in February, in a dispute over the city’s emergency notification system. He also accuses Squallia of undermining efforts by nonwhite candidates to get promoted in city government. Suarez filed his complaint on Aug. 21 and announced the legal action on

In his complaint, alleges retaliation by mayor over an emergency system dispute

Friday in a news release. In an email Saturday, Squallia, who is in her second term as mayor, said Suarez’s allegations are “false.” She declined to comment further, citing an “active investigation.” Suarez seeks damages and court orders reinstating him as fire chief and instructing Squallia not to retaliate against him. Suarez, 55, is a Hispanic man who became a Fitchburg firefighter in 1995 and was named fire chief in 2021. “My obligation has always been,

and always will be, to public safety for the residents of Fitchburg, which was, unfortunately, jeopardized,” Suarez said Saturday in a phone interview. “I presented solutions to fix the public safety issue, but rather than being supported to work to a solution ... I was retaliated against.” Suarez alleges Squallia suspended him on false pretenses involving his inquiries to human resources about absences by some subordinates. An investigation into those allegations made findings based on a “dis-

crepancy of facts,” and Squallia told Suarez he could either be demoted or fired, his complaint said. Suarez told the Globe he declined to accept a demotion and hasn’t received a termination notice. Suarez alleges his disputes with Squallia began over the city’s use of an emergency notification system known as CodeRED. The system provides timely public safety notices to Fitchburg residents and businesses through text, phone, social media, and email. The notices include alerts about missing persons, weather emergencies, lockdowns, and evacuations, Suarez’s lawsuit said. FITCHBURG, Page B5

‘You know that saying, right? Let’s not leave any stone unturned.’

MANMEET SINGH MEET, *on efforts to find his best friend Jiwan Jyoti (right) and others*



Lexington mother among thousands missing after devastating Nepal floods

By Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

Jiwan Jyoti, a Lexington mother who traveled to Nepal to celebrate her 50th birthday, is among the more than 2,000 missing after flash floods devastated the region.

Jyoti was in Rasuwagadhi, near Nepal’s border with Tibet, when family last heard from her on Wednesday. Her husband and best friend have since traveled to Nepal, hoping to find her.

“You know that saying, right? Let’s not leave any stone unturned,” Manmeet Singh Meet, Jyoti’s best friend, said in a phone interview Sunday as he was traveling to Kathmandu.

Meet first met her while they were both living in India. They have been friends for 15 years and both later moved to the Boston area. Their spouses and kids have become “like extended family.”

Meet was among the friends and family that gathered in July to celebrate Jyoti’s birthday. She has two children, a 22-year-old daughter and 15-year-old son.

Jyoti wanted to celebrate her milestone birthday by taking her first solo trip, a pilgrimage to Mount Kailash, said Meet.

Kailash, a peak in the Himalayas, is considered sacred by several religions and draws thousands of pilgrims each year. Jyoti’s trip was organized by Himalayan Glacier, a travel agency. Her group was staying at a hotel waiting to cross into China when the flooding began.

Meet said Hotel Kailash, where Jyoti was staying, was destroyed in the floods. None of the 47 people in her group have been accounted for, he said.



MANAN VATSYAYANA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Vehicles drove past houses covered in mud after flooding in Nepal’s Dhading district Sunday.

In a social media post Saturday, Himalayan Glacier said the company did not have any verified updates about guests or team members.

As of Sunday, roughly 2,500 people remain missing, according to Amrit Bahadur Rai, the foreign secretary of Nepal. Just over 8,100 people have been rescued, including 261 foreign nationals.

Tommy Pigott, a State Department spokesperson, told ABC News Sunday that approximately 85 Americans remain unaccounted for and nine had been evacuated. He was not aware of any reported American deaths.

The search operation, coordinated between Nepal, India, China, and South Korea, con-

sists of more than 19,000 people and 16 helicopters searching the area.

Meet said he and Sanjeev Rai, Jyoti’s husband, hope to search the area around the hotel where she was staying. He acknowledged the possibility that Jyoti did not survive but said recovering her body would at least allow her family to find closure.

“I still leave 0.1 percent for a miracle,” Meet said. “We are praying for that.”

On Saturday evening, members of the Greater Boston Nepali Community gathered at Rivergreen Park in Everett for a candlelight vigil to pray for those reported dead or missing in the floods.

Attendees also raised money

for Nepal’s Prime Minister’s Disaster Relief Fund.

Jyoti worked as an engineer for Intel Corp. for nearly 12 years, according to her LinkedIn page.

If Jyoti did not survive, Meet said, he wants the opportunity to perform last rites in hopes that doing so “brings peace to everyone.”

“If I look back, I have tons and tons of good memories,” Meet said. “I was hoping to make more.”

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report. Michaela Towfighi can be reached at michaela.towfighi@globe.com. Follow her on X @michaelatowfighi.

Community gathers to pray for homeland

By Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF
and Adam Sennott
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

EVERETT — The Greater Boston Nepali Community held a candlelight vigil here at Rivergreen Park over the weekend to pray for thousands reported dead or missing in catastrophic flooding in their homeland.

They are also raising money for Nepal’s Prime Minister’s Disaster Relief Fund, said Sushma Adhikari, a member of the community.

“No amount is small,” Adhikari said, addressing the crowd that slowly grew to over 100 people Saturday evening. “Our goal is to turn tonight’s solidarity into meaningful action for the people of Nepal.”

Attendees lit tiny candles on the ground, spelling out Nepal. They stood for a moment of silence and joined in prayer led by Samanta Bajracharya, a Buddhist guru.

“We believe in prayers, so we’re praying tonight for the people who are still missing,”

Adhikari said.

As of Sunday, roughly 2,500 people remain missing, according to Amrit Bahadur Rai, the foreign secretary of Nepal.

Many of the missing were on a pilgrimage to Mount Kailash in Tibet, a sacred site for Hindus, Buddhists, and others, including Jiwan Jyoti, a 50-year-old mother from Lexington.

Adhikari also knows a handful of childhood acquaintances who are among the missing. She said she wasn’t giving up hope that they would be found.

“They’re still doing rescue operations, so I’m hoping that I hear back from that [and that they’re] coming home safe,” Adhikari said.

Dipendra Dahal, 45 of Westford, attended the vigil with his wife and 7-year-old son. Dahal said he is from Trishuli Bazar, where the flash flood occurred. His high school, where he also taught for five years, was swept away in the flood, and many of his childhood friends and relatives are still missing. “There is very little hope to be able to find

‘They’re still doing rescue operations, so I’m hoping that I hear back from that [and that they’re] coming home safe.’

SUSHMA ADHIKARI, *on missing acquaintances*

them alive,” Dahal said.

More than 1,600 students at the school were saved by a quick-thinking teacher who told the school buses full of kids to turn back before they reached the flooded campus, according to the Sunday Times of London.

“That was the good thing among that bad incident,” Dahal said.

Aloonnee Adhikari, 28 of Norwood, took comfort in people gathering for the vigil, at a moment of grief and tragedy.

“We can’t go through this alone,” Adhikari said. “I think a

lot of us feel like we can’t do much, so when we get to get together like this it gives us a sense of empowerment that at least we can sit there and pray for them, even if we’re not there.”

Deepak Sharma, 36, of Chelsea, said he hoped the vigil would inspire people outside the Nepali community to help fund-raising.

“Right now every dollar counts, every water bottle counts, every diaper counts, every food grain counts, everything counts,” Sharma said.

Adhikari said that no matter where people were from, their age or background, the vigil showed they will stand together for one Nepal.

“One candle, one community, one Nepal,” Adhikari said. “For those we lost, for those who are suffering, for those who are still hoping, and for the Nepal, we will help rebuild.”

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Student treated, MIT building shut after possible chemical exposure

By Camilo Fonseca and Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

A graduate student at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology who went to a local hospital claiming exposure to a rare form of mercury remained under medical care Saturday, the university said.

But results of a blood test on Saturday show “no sign of exposure to mercury,” MIT said in a statement.

The student checked into an emergency room Wednesday night saying they had synthesized dimethylmercury at a campus lab, the statement said.

On Saturday, MIT said it was not clear if the student had synthesized the chemical and “that is not authorized as part of their research program.”

“Emerging information calls into question whether this compound was in fact synthesized,” the statement said.

As of Sunday, the university had no updates on the incident or the student’s condition.

Dimethylmercury is particularly dangerous. It can be fatal if swallowed, inhaled, or absorbed through the skin, according to the American Chemical Society.

In 1997, a Dartmouth College chemistry professor, Karen Wetterhahn, died 10 months after a small amount spilled and permeated the latex gloves she was wearing, the Globe reported at the time.

The MIT student who was possibly exposed was not identified. They did allow the university to release results of their blood test, the statement said.

Their possible exposure triggered a hazardous materials response and cleanup of the Dreyfus Building, where the lab is located. The building will remain closed at least through Sunday, MIT said.

Cambridge firefighters responded to the building at 21 Ames St. Wednesday at approximately 9:40 p.m., according to transmissions recorded by Broadcastify.

“Right now we have an unknown clear liquid on the floor of the lab, the lab is isolated, all people are out of the surrounding area,” one firefighter said in a transmission.

Jeremy Warnick, a spokesperson for the City of Cambridge, said in an email Saturday

day that the chemical spill involved an “unknown liquid” inside an MIT negative pressure lab.

“The surrounding area was surveyed by various [Cambridge Fire Department] meters and appeared to be clear,” Warnick continued. “Information provided by MIT indicated a small amount of dimethylmercury spilled inside a hood.”

Officials did not say what hospital the student went to.

But a spokesperson for Massachusetts General Hospital on Wednesday night told the Globe that a hazmat team of the Boston Fire Department had responded to the hospital.

The team was treating a person for exposure to a “chemical substance” that did not occur at the hospital, the spokesperson said.

Separately, a Boston police spokesperson said in an email to the Globe that officers were called at 8:49 p.m. Wednesday “for assistance at 55 Fruit Street for a mercury spill.”

It could not be confirmed if the incident reported by MIT is the same as the one at MGH.

“It remains the case that, based on the information available, this was a localized issue with only one student directly exposed, and this student was the individual working with the compound,” MIT said.

The Dreyfus Building will be closed through “at least” Sunday for decontamination efforts “out of an abundance of caution.” MIT said that the student’s dorm unit is also being decontaminated, and high-touch surfaces in the common areas of their residence hall have been cleaned.

School officials said there is “very low risk” of second-hand or third-hand exposure for community members who did not enter the lab space on Wednesday.

Individuals who were in proximity to the student and their work environment have been tested for exposure, MIT said.

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Lottery

SUNDAY MIDDAY 7657
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)
EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	\$5,009
First or last 3	\$701
Any 2 digits	\$60
Any 1 digit	\$6

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	\$417
First 3	\$117
Last 3	\$117

SUNDAY NIGHT 5863
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)
EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	\$4,609
First or last 3	\$645
Any 2 digits	\$55
Any 1 digit	\$6

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	\$192
First 3	\$107
Last 3	\$107

Jackpot: \$1 million a year for life ; winners
MASS CASH
August 30 **02-19-23-28-31**
Jackpot: \$100,000; no winners
MEGABUCKS
August 29 **06-10-15-31-33-39**
Jackpot: \$28.85 million; winners
PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

	Midday	Night
Saturday	5506	2352
Friday	9008	1099
Thursday	0457	9070
Wednesday	3419	1195
Tuesday	6384	6159

WEEKEND NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND
Sun. Maine, N.H., Vermont
Day: 3-digit **126** 4-digit **1806**
Eve: 3-digit **698** 4-digit **0332**
Rhode Island
Sunday **0534**
Saturday’s Powerball
18-56-62-65-67-18
Powerball
Jackpot: \$131 million;

This day in history

Today is Monday, Aug. 31, the 243rd day of 2026. There are 122 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Golf Hall of Famer Isao Aoki is 84. Violinist Itzhak Perlman is 81. Singer Van Morrison is 81. Rock musician Rudolf Schenker of the Scorpions is 78. Actor Richard Gere is 77. Actor Stephen McKinley Henderson is 77. Attorney and author Marcia Clark is 73. Olympic gold medal hurdler Edwin Moses is 71. Rock singer Glenn Tilbrook of Squeeze is 69. Rock musician Gina Schock of the Go-Go’s is 69. Singer Deborah Gibson is 56. Queen Rania of Jordan is 56. Golfer Padraig Harrington is 55. Actor Chris Tucker is 55. Actor Sara Ramirez is 51. Former NFL wide receiver Larry Fitzgerald is 43. NBA All-Star Jalen Brunson is 30. Actor Jaylen Barron is 29.

►In 1881, the first US tennis championships (for men only)

began in Newport, R.I.

►In 1886, an earthquake with an estimated magnitude of up to 7.3 devastated Charleston, S.C., killing at least 60 people.

►In 1899, in a vehicle created in his Watertown shop, Newton inventor F.O. Stanley drove his wife, Flora, to New Hampshire and up Mt. Washington — the first time an auto reached the summit of New England’s highest peak. The Midwest would soon become the center of the American auto industry, but according to Mass Humanities, it was in Massachusetts that the nation’s first gasoline-powered automobiles were produced.

►In 1972, the charismatic Soviet gymnast Olga Korbut, 17, won individual gold medals on the balance beam and floor exercise at the Olympics in Munich; she also won gold for the team all-around competition and a sil-

ver in the uneven parallel bars.

►In 1980, Poland’s Solidarity labor movement was born with an agreement signed in Gdansk that ended a 17-day-old strike.

►In 1992, white separatist Randy Weaver surrendered in Idaho, ending an 11-day siege by federal agents that had claimed the lives of Weaver’s wife, son, and a deputy US marshal, William Degan of Quincy.

►In 1994, Russia officially ended its military presence in the former East Germany and the Baltics after half a century.

►In 1997, Diana, Princess of Wales, was killed after the car she was riding in crashed in Paris; her partner Dodi Fayed and driver Henri Paul (who was found to have been intoxicated at the time of the accident) also died.

►In 2006, Edvard Munch’s painting “The Scream” was re-

covered by Norwegian authorities after being stolen nine days earlier.

►In 2010, President Barack Obama announced the end of the US combat mission in Iraq, declaring no victory after seven years of bloodshed and telling those divided over the war in his country and around the world: “It’s time to turn the page.”

►In 2019, a gunman carried out a shooting rampage that stretched 10 miles between the Texas communities of Midland and Odessa, leaving seven people dead before police killed the shooter outside a movie theater in Odessa.

►In 2025, a landslide wiped out an entire village in Sudan’s western region of Darfur, killing an estimated 1,000 people in one of the deadliest natural disasters in the African country’s recent history.

Fans descend upon Common for 741 Frequency Fest

►BROWN
Continued from Page B1

bus was decorated with basket-ball hoops.

Fans lined up across the Common to buy shoes from Brown's company 741 Performance. One fan in line, Yasmine Bonei, of Chelsea, was excited to get the shoes and celebrate Brown.

"As a Boston person for the last nine years, it's kind of sad seeing him leave Boston," Bonei said. "I know in Philadelphia he's gonna do great things."

"Razor" Ramon Jamal, a barber cutting hair at Marvelous Barber Lounge for the event, said the lounge was participating to give back to the community.

"It's just a great event to give back to Boston, especially with somebody that was so renowned to the city," Jamal said.

A stage was erected in the center of the celebration where artists including the Boston Public Schools marching band, local R&B artist Yanna G, and Grammy Award-winning artist Lil Jon performed for the crowd of fans.

"Jaylen Brown was the heart of the city, the heart of the team, obviously, very appreciative of the times that we had," said Tariq Longworth, of Dorchester.

Longworth was sad to see Brown leave, but seeing the number of people who came out to support Brown meant a lot.

"I can't wait to see when seven goes up in the rafters," Longworth said.

Chris Breen traveled from Toronto for the event. He was donning Celtics gear from head to toe and had even dyed his beard dark green.

"When he came in, he and the rest of the team, they changed everything," Breen said. "We had gone through some changes since the 2008 championship, some ups and downs, then they won a championship."

Johannes Becker became a Celtics fan once she and her



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF



DANIEL SARCH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Above, Rodney Almkhlef, 11, of Boston, leaped into the air after making a basket that won him \$500 at former Boston Celtic Jaylen Brown's 741 Frequency Fest on Sunday. At left, fans snapped pictures of the former Celtic star at Boston Common, phones in hand.

husband moved from Munich, Germany. She named her child, Liam Jalen, after Brown, for what he represents.

"He's one of the smart players; he has brains, and he stands up for the community. He does a lot for the community," Becker said. "He speaks his mind, and that really resonated with us."

Before Brown stepped onto the stage, he walked around the event signing items for fans. People moved closer, hoping for a chance to meet their hero.

When Brown walked onto the stage, he was met with a roar from the crowd. Fans waved flags and jerseys.

"I'm at a loss for words. When I got to this city, I said I'm gonna go to war for this city," Brown said. "I met so many great people here, people that helped me in the community, that motivated me on my journey, people that have supported me even when I didn't support myself at times. So, I just want to say thank you to Boston."

Toward the end of the event, Brown performed a song he had created with A\$AP Ferg called "Just Do It." After Brown thanked the crowd, he invited out rap superstar Lil Baby.

The event ended with Boston Mayor Michelle Wu coming on stage to share how much she and the city appreciate Brown.

"I have seen him not just in the Garden, but I have gotten to see him in our schools, in our parks, and in our classrooms, Wu said, "Every minute, he's poured into this city. He has changed lives throughout Boston; that's why so many people are here."

Olajide Ogundipe Jr., of Lower Mills, said it was very surprising Brown brought out Lil Baby and that it was "cool" to see Mayor Wu show support.

"I feel like we did a good job showing up today," Ogundipe Jr. said.

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The Boston Globe

POWER PLAY



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Wu’s Senate race endorsements have ups and downs

►**ELECTION**
Continued from Page B1

real estate sales, have stalled.

“This is about an agenda that our residents need to see relief and action on, and the pace that the Senate seems to find acceptable is not connected to real life in Boston,” Wu told the Globe.

It’s meant Wu has hung over the race, both figuratively and oftentimes, literally. Last week-end, she rallied with volunteers for Gayle and Lander in separate events, saying the Senate needs “new leaders who are eager to run towards problems with big ideas and with huge vision.” As the two candidates took questions at various forums in the days before, Wu often wasn’t far from people’s lips.

If Brownsberger had voted the way the mayor wanted, Lander was asked during a debate hosted by the Charles River Regional Chamber, would he still be running for office? And should the business community be worried that Wu will instruct Lander how to vote?

“I started thinking about running for this office at the end of the legislative session two years ago,” Lander, who lives in Fenway, said, calling it a “five-car pileup.”

In a Globe interview, Lander said people in the district — who currently are represented by someone in the top rungs of Senate leadership — are “hungry for a Legislature that isn’t just going to listen to leadership.”

“Those are the people I’m going to listen to every single day who are, like, really frustrated with how hard it is to live here,” he said.

Some are still skeptical. Greg Reibman, chief executive at the Charles River Regional Chamber, said it’s unclear whether Lander’s embrace of Wu helps him in the district’s other corners of Watertown, Cambridge, and Belmont.

“Or,” Reibman said, “if his ties hurt him.”

At a candidate forum in Dorchester, moderators and attendees alike also pressed Gayle for reassurance that she would prioritize her constituents’ interests



State Senate candidate Latoya Gayle (left) received support from Boston Mayor Michelle Wu at a recent rally.



State Senator Nick Collins recently met with supporters at the Local 7 Ironworkers Union Hall.

over those of her powerful political backer.

Gayle insisted that the mayor endorsed her because of Gayle’s reputation in the community and record of education advocacy work. The next night, at an event hosted by a local Democratic ward, when asked about what relationship the First Suffolk District senator should have with City Hill, Gayle preached collaboration. Juwan Skeens, another challenger, said it should be a connection with a “backbone.” Collins emphasized “independence.”

“It’s important to be an advocate for the people, not for an individual. Not for a politician, not to be a ‘yes’ person, or to carry the water of an individual,” Col-

lins said, without mentioning Wu directly. “I don’t think this district deserves a blind loyalist.”

Collins, in turn, has leaned on his labor support, emphasized his work to build coalitions and secure state funding for Boston in his 15 years in elected office, and touted endorsements from Governor Maura Healey, state auditor Diana DiZoglio, and several Boston-area state representatives. He told the Globe he doesn’t take Wu’s criticisms of him personally — their fight over tax legislation has often bled fully into public view — but argued that it “speaks to an inability to compromise.”

“I have working relationships with people who I don’t agree with 100 percent; I think what



Daniel Lander is seen through a window at Peka Restaurant in Brighton.



Senator William Brownsberger and supporters held signs for his reelection campaign in Belmont and Cambridge.

you see differently is [the] mayor wants you to agree with her 100 percent,” Collins said.

Gayle has disputed the characterization that voters are concerned about Wu’s influence. Wu is also coming off her dominant reelection effort, clearing out her competition after last year’s preliminary before coasting to a second term in November.

“The scrutiny is from a loud minority of people,” Gayle said. “It is not from everyday voters.”

Instead, residents are concerned about the rising costs of housing, utilities, groceries, and child care, Gayle said, arguing Collins had not done enough to address those issues or protect residents against Trump administration policies. She also said it

was she who reached out to Wu to ask for her endorsement after she launched her campaign because she felt they were aligned on those values.

“If and when there comes a time that me and the mayor disagree, we’ll cross that bridge when we come to it,” Gayle said. “We are both strong, independent women, mothers raising our families in this city, and I think we’re excited to have the chance to work together on those things. There’s not an expectation that either one of us owes the other one for something.”

The talk also shouldn’t distract from what candidates say are the wider issues their voters care about, or what they, themselves, can bring. For Browns-

berger and Lander, creating more affordable housing in the Senate district has become a key issue, and created stark differences; Lander, for example, supports lifting a ban on rent control while Brownsberger opposes it.

Brownsberger, of Belmont, said his campaign has “never been about a quarrel with the mayor.” As he sat on a stoop in Watertown last week making the case to one local resident, Brownsberger said his years at the State House have put him “in a great position to get a lot down and to continue to get a lot done.”

“I’m past climbing the ladder,” he said. “I’m growing like a tree, just putting down the roots, spreading out the branches, and taking care of what’s around.”

He later told the Globe he will work with Wu “when she’s ready.”

“I’m honestly baffled as to why the mayor seems so eager to tear down a fellow public servant,” he said.

Lander, in turn, has said he has “deep ties” to the other cities and towns in the district and would bring a fresh, younger perspective to the Senate.

“When I win, it is going to send a really loud message to all senators basically, most of whom do not have challengers or don’t have competitive elections, that there’s a cost to legislative dysfunction and inaction,” Lander said.

He has leaned heavily on Wu, too, including a mention of her endorsement in his well-oiled pitch at the door to potential supporters. At Sarah Baker’s doorstep in Watertown last week, Lander pointed to ongoing talks over legislation that would ban student cellphone use in public schools. With the school year starting, Lander tried to use it as an example of how bills “don’t move” at the State House.

“There is no urgency,” Lander said.

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Hogg targets Eighth District’s Lynch in Democratic shake-up

►**HOGG**
Continued from Page B1

races from Texas to Minnesota. The PAC is also backing Daniel Lander in his challenge to state Senator William Brownsberger in the Massachusetts Legislature, and Hogg is planning to headline an event for Lander on Monday alongside Boston Mayor Michelle Wu.

Of the candidates the PAC has backed, 34 have won a primary or general election so far, though many were uncontested, intraparty races. Hogg said many of the incumbents the group planned to target ultimately retired, in a year that has seen a staggering number of incumbents exiting Congress.

That’s put a heavier focus on the Eighth District. Hogg’s group has poured at least \$470,000 into the primary as of last week — which is among the most the group says it has spent on behalf of a candidate this cycle. That’s included nine mailers, including one that refers to Lynch as “MAGA’s favorite Democrat.”

Roath and Hogg have repeatedly criticized past votes Lynch took on immigration and health care, which the congressman has defended throughout the



On Sunday, gun control activist David Hogg (left) canvassed Roslindale with Eighth District candidate Patrick Roath.

campaign. And Lynch has dismissed many of the attacks as “ridiculous stuff that you hear in the middle of a campaign.” He has repeatedly decried the money Leaders We Deserve and other groups have spent on Roath’s behalf, and Lynch’s campaign has charged that Hogg’s group has been “lying about his record in Congress.”

Lynch has repeatedly pointed to the Trump administration dubbing him an “ICE agitator” and his enduring support from unions such as the Massachusetts AFL-CIO and groups that

back left-leaning candidates, such as the Planned Parenthood Action Fund.

“Money in politics is probably the most insidious impact and danger to our democracy right now,” Lynch said during a forum in Weymouth this month, the only one where both candidates appeared together on stage this campaign. “My opponent has had four mailings. You probably got them all, and they’re all from PACs that he’s working with.”

Lynch said on a radio program Thursday that he has done



US Representative Stephen Lynch, pictured earlier this month during a debate, has dismissed many of the attacks.

about two dozen town halls with senior centers and councils on aging and that he’s spent the last seven weeks knocking on doors. This weekend, he attended Norwood Day alongside State Senator Mike Rush, also facing a primary challenge to his left.

“It seems like we’re fighting amongst ourselves, the Democrats, rather than focusing on getting back into this government,” Lynch said during an interview with the Boston Neighborhood Network on Thursday, adding that he’s a moderate trying to keep other moderates “in

the Democratic column.”

“We don’t want to be the party of protesters,” he said.

Hogg made a name for himself nationally leading protests against gun violence. After graduating from Harvard University in 2023, he then turned his attention to the Democratic Party. He briefly served as a DNC co-chair beginning in February 2025, before stepping down that June amid criticism from Democratic leaders who disagreed with his plans to get involved in races against sitting Democrats.

Hogg said his group backs candidates under the age of 45 for Congress and those under 35 in state legislatures with certain progressive beliefs, such as supporting Medicare for All.

Jesse Lehrich, a Democratic strategist based in Washington, D.C., said that while he believes Hogg has his finger on the pulse of the change Democrats are looking for, “he has taken a pretty adversarial tone toward not just the establishment.”

“He’s not exactly pitching a big-ten version of the Democratic Party,” Lehrich said.

He pointed to Hogg’s support of some longshot candidates, such as Deja Foxx, a content creator who lost her Democratic primary in Arizona last year by nearly 40 percentage points. But Lynch, he said, is a “good target” for Hogg: “He’s a pretty centrist voice in a blue seat for a long time.”

Roath has leaned into criticisms that Lynch hasn’t been active enough for the district, which stretches from Boston south of the city. “This is a place that should be fighting above its weight,” he said.

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Boston-based LLC is lending Hampshire College \$29.5m

►**DONOR**
Continued from Page B1

and lists Artocarpus Partners LLC at the address 300 Pier 4 Blvd., prime real estate in Boston’s Seaport neighborhood.

The Globe reached Johnson, who declined to comment for this story.

The loan offers significant relief after a tumultuous spring. Hampshire announced its transition to closure April 14, taking many students and other stakeholders by surprise. It also reversed course on its teach-out plan, first saying only final-year students could return over the summer and fall to complete

their degrees, then announcing that the fall semester would be open to all current students, and then, in late May, breaking the news that the school might not have enough money for anyone to come back.

The confusion left many students, families, and faculty reeling, and struggling to get seats and jobs at other colleges, while wondering what would happen next.

The answer came in June when Chrisler emailed the Hampshire community to say the college had come to a preliminary agreement with a philanthropic partner to provide a

loan. The funds were intended to support the closure process and give the college time to plan for land sales to help meet its financial obligations, she wrote, while honoring its institutional legacy and mission.

Artocarpus is a breadfruit tree grown in tropical climates — and prominently featured on Hampshire’s college seal along with its founding year of 1965 and motto, “Non Satis Scire” (“To know is not enough”).

“The tree symbolizes knowledge as an organic process, deeply rooted in liberal arts traditions, yet subject to continual revision and growth,” according

to the college’s website.

Since Hampshire announced it would close, several entities have approached the college’s board of trustees with proposals for its land, which totals around 800 acres. In May, the Trustees of Reservations, the state’s largest land conservation and preservation nonprofit, teamed up with the Amherst-based Kestrel Land Trust to propose conserving the rural landscape around the campus’s core.

Hampshire alumni and other stakeholders have also organized as a group called Hampshire Next, which invites pledges to support buying the campus.

“It either stays with the community, or it could become the next data center or strip mall,” the group’s website says. “This is our chance to stand up, defend our campus, and collectively decide what’s next.”

A third pitch was made by a philosopher and peace negotiator from Maryland named Jerome Segal, who proposed transforming Hampshire into a new nonprofit university that specializes in training students in conflict resolution.

In her most recent letter, Chrisler acknowledged Hampshire’s final chapter would be “bittersweet,” but said it could al-

so “provide a renewed sense of community.”

Staff and faculty have been meeting throughout the summer to plan for the fall, and regular community dinners and “consolidated office locations” will give students, faculty, and staff the chance to spend more time together, she said. There will also be fewer buildings in use and limited resources. In recent days on social media, some Hampshire professors have shared photos of themselves packing up their offices.

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LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Fitchburg Mayor Samantha Squailia, pictured last year, said that Fire Chief Dante Suarez’s allegations are “false,” but declined to comment further, citing the “active investigation.”

Fitchburg’s fire chief sues city for racial bias, whistleblower retaliation

►FITCHBURG
Continued from Page B1

During her mayoral campaign in 2023, Squailia allegedly vowed to eliminate the system to save Fitchburg the \$10,000 annual cost, the complaint said.

After taking office, Squailia cut the service and later introduced a replacement, which Suarez’s complaint described as inferior.

Suarez alleges he tried another avenue to restore CodeRED, but was blocked by City Hall.

He also accused Squailia of maintaining her opposition to the system even after a shooting last October put three schools in lockdown and the city had “no reliable mechanism” for notifying students’ families.

Two months later, Suarez said he learned Squailia was restoring the service, but shifted control of the system from his agency to the city’s information technology department.

Suarez’s lawsuit also accuses Squailia of racial bias. He alleges she repeatedly ignored his requests to promote two subordi-

nates to the rank of captain, including one firefighter who is a person of color.

In another instance, Suarez accused Squailia of appointing a white man as police chief over a Hispanic candidate who scored the highest marks on an assess-

Suarez said he offered overtime pay to firefighters who had to train on their own time and regular pay to firefighters who could complete the training during their regular shifts.

The firefighters’ union filed a grievance, seeking overtime pay

‘I presented solutions to fix the public safety issue, but rather than being supported ... I was retaliated against’

CHIEF DANTE SUAREZ, *said in a phone interview.*

ment exam and was ranked first by the selection committee, the complaint said.

The lawsuit also alleged Squailia assigned menial tasks like shoveling snow and emptying city trash barrels to a senior aide who is a Hispanic man.

Suarez’s complaint further said Squailia supported the firefighters’ union in a disagreement over compensation for training sessions on 911 systems.

for all members, Suarez’s complaint said. He rejected the grievance, but was overturned by Squailia, the lawsuit said.

Suarez said he wants to return to duty as Fitchburg’s fire chief.

“I am really looking forward to getting back to work to serve my community,” he said.

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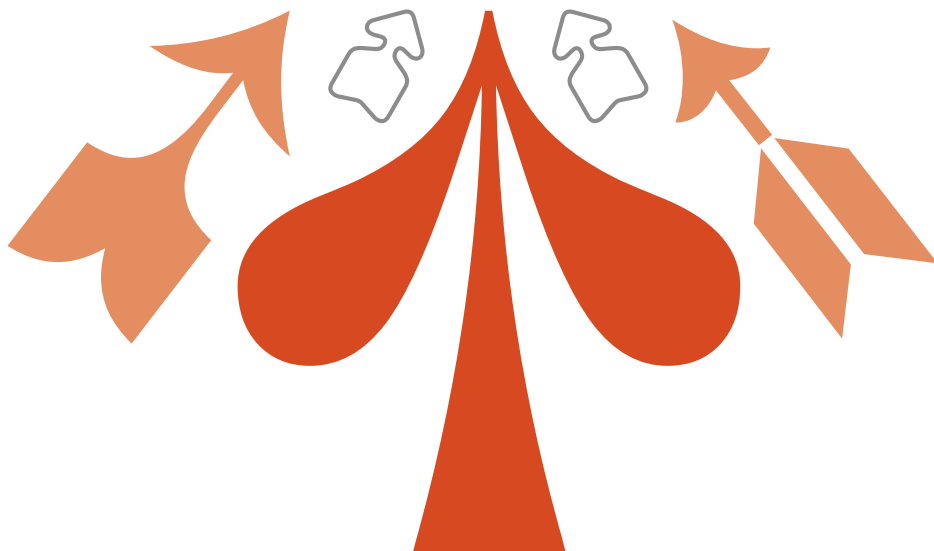
The Boston Globe

BEST OF THE BEST 2026



Your go-to source for what to do, see, and eat in and around Boston.

See the list at
Globe.com/best



LivingArts

By Megan Johnson
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Whether you're desperately clinging to the end of summer or gunning for New England foliage season to begin with a pumpkin spice latte in hand, Boston has a flurry of free events coming up in September. Check out a handful below.

You're an animal

STAY PAW-SITIVE: Show off your feline squad at this free, parade-style neighborhood walk through the streets of Lower Allston. Check out the cool cats hanging out on windows, porches, and yards in the neighborhood as you connect with your neighbors. MSPCA-Angell will also be on site with fun info about adoption, giveaways, and volunteers. If you want to bring your own cat, register on the website beforehand. But please, no dogs. This is a cat-specific event, after all. *Sept. 19, 2-5:30 p.m. Smith Playground, 235 Western Ave., Lower Allston. lowerallstoncatstroll.carrd.co*

BOW-WOW-WOW: Beacon Hill goes to the dogs at the Liberty Hotel's Yappier Hour, where you and your pup can meet other dog owners to chat it up and get a few pets. (The petting is for the dogs, by the way.) There's food and drink available for purchase, but attendance — for humans and canines — is free. *Sept. 2, 9, 23, and 30 from 4-8:30 p.m. Liberty Hotel, 215 Charles St. libertyaffairs.com/liberty-affairs/*

A PURR-FECT WEEKEND: In perhaps the most Cambridge-sounding event ever, the Cambridge 2026 Cat Tour and Meowfest welcomes cat lovers on a walking tour to meet some of the city's most established feline residents. After you meet the neighborhood's furry locals, Meowfest welcomes friends of the felines to revel together, cat hair and all. If you want to register your cat, be sure to do so on the website by Sept. 20. And no, you don't have to be a cat owner to attend. *Sept. 26, 2 p.m. Dana Park, 70 Magazine St., Cambridgecattour2026.carrd.co*

Just keep moving

GET YOUR SWEAT ON: Boston Landing Fit Fest, the annual community fitness festival, is swinging into THE TRACK at New Balance. Drop in for a free class from everyone ranging from the US Marines to BTone Fitness, or get centered with a breathwork session. Registration is required beforehand through Eventbrite. *Sept. 12, 9:30 a.m.-3:30 p.m. 91 Guest St., Brighton. eventbrite.com/e/boston-landing-community-fit-fest-2026-tickets-1984574713391*

FIGHT NIGHT: Hood Park is host-



TANNER PEARSON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE 2023

The What the Fluff? Festival returns to Somerville's Union Square Sept. 19.

Free Boston events for September: cat parades, a cappella, and cardio



IAN OLEKSIAK

Loretta's Last Call offers free line dancing classes every Wednesday and Sunday through September. Right: You and your pup can meet other dog owners at the Liberty Hotel's Yappier Hour Sept. 2, 9, 23, and 30.



THE LIBERTY HOTEL

BOSTON AT A BARGAIN

fitness-series

DANCE TO THE MUSIC: Saddle up to Loretta's Last Call in the Fenway for free line dancing classes every Wednesday and Sunday through September. Don't worry about being an unskilled dancer, little lady: It's open to all experience levels and genders. No cowboy boots required. The Sept. 2 edition honors the late, great Dolly

Parton at 7 p.m. *Wednesdays and Sundays through September, 8- 11 p.m. Loretta's Last Call, 1 Lansdowne St. lorettaslastcall.com*

Do it for the culture

EVERY BOOTH A DOORWAY: The Boston Asian American Day Festival returns to Boston Common with six hours of non-stop live performances. In addition to games and activities for all ages, you'll find more than 80 booths from nonprofit organizations

and businesses, as well as plenty of Asian street food for purchase. *Sept. 5, 10 a.m.-4 p.m., Boston Common. aadayboston.org/en*

BELT IT OUT: You don't have to be able to hold a tune to enjoy the scene at the Boston A Cappella Festival. A lineup of talented a cappella groups from high schoolers to senior citizens will take the Riverstage amphitheater and spice things up with styles ranging from barbershop to modern pop. Lie back and catch a tune in the sunshine. *Sept. 26, noon-6 p.m. Herter Park, 1175 Soldiers Field Road. herterpark.org/event-details/boston-a-cappella-festival-1*

WE LOVE A PARADE: Dance it out while celebrating the legacies of Afro-Caribbean and African American communities. Watch the Sunday parade with revelers dancing in the streets from near the Charles River to Central Square to University Park Commons, or take a seat to hear steel pan performances at Pan in the Park at Cambridge's Pacific Park on Saturday. *Sept. 12-13, various start times. University Park, Central Square, Cambridge. cambridgecarnival.org*

Kid-friendly, parent approved

EDDIE MURPHY, PG EDITION: It's not every day your child can enjoy the comedy of Eddie Murphy, but at the Coolidge at the Speedway's showing of "Shrek," everyone can enjoy the legendary comedian. No tickets are needed, and the movie starts around sunset. *Sept. 16, 8 p.m., the Upper Courtyard at 525 Western Ave., Brighton. coolidge.org/films/shrek*

MARSHMALLOW MADNESS: The What the Fluff? Festival sandwiches itself back into Somerville's Union Square for its annual display of deliciousness. Multiple stages welcome everything from live music to fluff jousting at the celebration of all things sticky and sweet. There's even a free bike valet, because this is Somerville. *Sept. 19, 10 a.m.-5 p.m. Union Square, Somerville. flufffestival.com*

WANDER THE WATERFRONT: Head to where Boston's Rose Kennedy Greenway and the Harborwalk meet for Atlantic Wharf's Fall Fest, an all-ages festival that has something for everyone in the family. Decorate a pumpkin, paint a watercolor, or check out the magic show, all with the stunning scenery of Boston's Waterfront behind you. *Sept. 27, 10 a.m.-noon. Atlantic Wharf's Waterfront Plaza. atlanticwharfboston.com/event/atlantic-wharfs-fall-fest-2026*

Details subject to change; check individual event websites for the most up-to-date information.

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This \$6.9 million ultramodern Manchester-by-the-Sea house comes with 13 acres, ocean views

By Regina Cole
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Set at the top of an isolated wooded hill, surrounded by 12.8 acres of land in the picturesque North Shore town of Manchester-by-the-Sea, a dramatic modern house is for sale. It has total privacy with wide ranging views of marshes, inlets, and the ocean, and notable contemporary architecture.

The five-bedroom, five-bathroom house's 4,925 square feet are encased in metal, clapboard, and glass. Built in 2006, the house at 370 Summer St. was designed by architect Marcus Gleysteen of Connecticut-based MGA.

It expresses modernism with projecting wings, contrasting siding materials, a steel and glass curtain wall shaded by a trapezoidal canopy, arching rooflines, angled support beams, and irregular decks. There are no right angles: The house is a livable contemporary sculpture.

In a town of handsome historic buildings, this ultramodern structure is unique. It's on the market for \$6,900,000.

A long private drive rises 150 feet to the site, which commands sweeping views of Kettle Cove and Crow Island. A large glass entry door leads to the interior. Individual elements include maple live-edge stairs, bubinga paneling, and enormous pieces of local granite that serve as room dividers and framing for a stainless-steel free-standing fireplace under a 23-



foot-high living room ceiling. As with the exterior, the interior expresses modernism with a mixture of materials, colors, and shapes, all flooded with natural light. Lena Fransioli of Zoe Design contributed detailed wall and ceiling coverings. None of the rooms are simple boxes.

The large chef's kitchen is equipped with high-end stainless-steel appliances, a large island, stone countertops, and custom-built cabinets. The dining room has a private deck and separate exterior access. There is a family room as well as a living room that could also function as a home office. The bathrooms are outfitted with stone and ceramic tile, each en-suite to one of the five bedrooms located on three levels.

In the garage, there are two parking spaces; the surrounding area provides room for another 25 vehicles. Patios, decks, and porches make for indoor-out-

door living, and there is a hot tub. The property's 12.79 acres about Hooper Trask Conservation Pasture, which provides another 2,000+ acres of protected land complete with wildlife and hiking trails.

Manchester-by-the-Sea, roughly 30 miles north of Boston, is a scenic community famous for its rocky coastline, historic architecture, a picturesque downtown, a yachting harbor, and the popular Singing Beach. Knowledgeable Bostonians ride the commuter rail from North Station to the train station in the center of Manchester-by-the-Sea, and walk to Singing Beach from there.

In fact, the town is small enough to be walkable in every way — the shops of the downtown and the beaches are within walking distance of this house.

Amanda Armstrong of Compass has the listing.



BRET OSSWALD/BRET O. PHOTOGRAPHY

In a town of historic buildings, this ultramodern five-bedroom, five-bathroom, 4,925-square-foot structure — built in 2006 — is unique.



TV HIGHLIGHTS

Tennis: US Open, 11:30 a.m., ESPN; 7 p.m., ESPN
Baseball: Mariners-Red Sox, 6:45 p.m., NESN
NWSL: Angel City-Legacy, 8 p.m., NBCSB, CBSSN
Listings, C7

Sports

C

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FM CHAMPIONSHIP

Yin returns to the winner's circle

She claims first LPGA win in nearly two years

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

NORTON — Ruoning Yin let slip a few tears before she took her final shot. It had been a frustrating 22 months since she last won on the LPGA Tour, a stretch she called one of the toughest of her career. So when she tapped in to ice her two-shot win at the 2026 FM Championship, Yin's face flooded with 672 days' worth of relief. "Finally," she said. "I think I've been waiting for this trophy for so long."

As she stood on the 18th green for the award ceremony, Yin got emotional. She thanked her mother in Mandarin, pumping the trophy over her head while her mom jumped up and down in elation.

Yin entered the day clinging to a one-shot lead, then shot a 2-under 70 in

the final round to finish at 14-under 274 and beat runner-up Hyo Joo Kim (71) at TPC Boston — Yin's first LPGA Tour win since October 2024 and the sixth of her young career.

She claimed \$660,000, her cut of the \$4.4 million purse — the second largest on the LPGA Tour for a non-major event.

It was the first appearance at New England's LPGA Tour stop for the 23-year-old from China, who became just the sixth player in the last 15 years to record six LPGA wins including a major

MORE GOLF
Khang glad to be home
Rockland native had her best finish since May at FM Championship. **C6**

No doubt who's best
Scheffler wins Tour Championship for second time with final-round 66. **C6**

before age 24. She is the first to do it since Nelly Korda.

"When I just got on the Tour . . . I just gave myself three years to get used to this environment, and then we'll see after three years," Yin said. "But I have accomplished a lot of things right now, and this is my sixth win. Five years goes by so quickly."

Yin finished second four times in the past two years, and watched from the sideline as many of her friends on Tour collected trophies. She grew harsh on herself, and at times she wondered if she should even be considered in the same conversation as her competitors at the top of the world rankings.

Her caddie told her earlier this year she didn't look happy on the course.

But some advice from a friend changed her mind-set going into the FM Championship.

"She told me second place means you're capable to win, and you're the

FM CHAMPIONSHIP, Page C6



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Ruoning Yin's round of 2-under 70 Sunday gave her a two-stroke victory.



COREY SIPKIN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The strain was showing on Red Sox starter Ranger Suarez as the Yankees battered him for six hits and five runs in the fifth inning.

Yankees secure a big break

Costly Red Sox defeat turns on disputed catch decision

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

Yankees 16
Red Sox 1

NEW YORK — In perhaps the Red Sox' biggest game of the year, the moment that mattered most was somehow equal parts practical and philosophical: Catch or no catch?

Center fielder Ceddanne Rafaela laid out in right-center field for Jazz Chisholm Jr.'s sinking line drive. First base umpire Edwin Moscoso ruled that he did not catch it, a call that stood upon review. Ranger Suarez followed by giving up five runs in that fifth inning, sending the Red Sox spiraling to a 16-1 loss to the Yankees.

"Everybody was surprised about that call," Suarez said. "The game changed because of that."

Rafaela, furious in the moment and after the game, said: "I know when a ball drops and a ball doesn't drop."

RED SOX, Page C4

PETER ABRAHAM
ON BASEBALL

Suarez fails crucial test in the Bronx

NEW YORK — Outside of his cleats, Ranger Suarez was sitting at his locker in full uniform at 11:10 a.m. Sunday, nearly 2½ hours before the Red Sox played the Yankees in the most important game of the season to date.

Suarez was sipping a cup of coffee and nodding at teammates when they walked by. He looked like a man eager for the challenge ahead.

The lefthander did not rise to that test. Suarez allowed six runs on nine hits over only 5½ innings in an ugly 16-1 loss.

Now the Red Sox trail their rivals by four games in the American League wild card, and the Yankees hold the tie-breaker, having clinched the season series on Sunday.

With only 25 games remaining in the regular season,

ON BASEBALL, Page C4

Patriots get the roster down to 53

Trade with Vikings for depth on O-line

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

The Patriots finalized their initial 53-man roster on Sunday.

After releasing 18 players (and trading for one) on Saturday, the Patriots cut another 19 on Sunday. They also placed swing tackle Marcus Bryant on injured reserve (with the designation to return) and swung another trade.

Here are six things to know from their flurry of roster moves this weekend . . .

1. Eight drafted and three undrafted rookies made the team.

Only one of New England's nine draft selections this year did not earn a roster spot.

The Patriots waived seventh-round pick Jam Miller, who flashed in the preseason opener but suffered

a minor injury in the second game and did not play in the preseason finale.

Tackles Caleb Lomu (first round) and Dametrious Crownover (sixth round), edge rushers Gabe Jacas (second round) and Quintayvious Hutchins (seventh round), tight end Eli Raridon (third round), cornerback Karon Prunty (fifth round), linebacker Namdi Obiazor (sixth round), and quarterback Behren Morton (seventh round) all made the cut.

So did a trio of undrafted rookies in tight end Tanner Arkin, cornerback Channing Canada, and linebacker Khalil Jacobs. An undrafted rookie has made New England's initial 53-man roster in 22 of the past 23 seasons, with 2023 being the exception.

► Donald rejoins the Rams, ending 2½-year retirement. C2

Of the rookies, Hutchins and Canada would be considered the biggest surprises.

The 2025 Patriots ranked third in the league in snaps by rookies, behind only the 5-12 Browns and 3-14 Jets. Across all three phases of the game, rookies were on the field for 17.7 percent of New England's snaps — a stunning proportion, given the team's success.

As things stand now, 2026 probably will not feature that same level of contributions. Lomu projects as the top swing tackle because Bryant is opening on injured reserve. Jacas, after missing the entirety of the spring, might be ready to serve only as a situational pass-rusher. Raridon is likely on track to have the biggest role, with Arkin in the mix primarily as a blocker.

The rest of the rookies will begin as depth pieces or core special teamers.

PATRIOTS, Page C2

INSIDE



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE GLOBE

Caribbean kings
Curacao captures its second Little League World Series championship. **C2**

Djokovic dismissed
Slam champion 24 times over ousted by Navone on first day of US Open. **C6**

Knockout success
Bare Knuckle Fighting Championship (above) puts on a show at Fenway. **C7**

Revolution look sharp
Gil has goal, two assists as road trip opens with victory in Columbus. **C7**

NFL NOTEBOOK

Donald returns to Rams

Star pass rusher back after multiple-year retirement

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Aaron Donald has returned to the Rams, ending his retirement after 2½ years to join **Myles Garrett** on their defensive line.

Los Angeles announced the 35-year-old Donald's decision Sunday following several weeks of discussion, preparation, and intensive workouts for the star defensive lineman.

Donald agreed to a one-year contract. ESPN reported he will make at least \$20 million in an incentive-laden deal.

Donald became one of the greatest defensive players of his era during his first 10 seasons, spent entirely with the Rams in St. Louis and Los Angeles. He won three AP NFL Defensive Player of the Year awards while earning 10 Pro Bowl selections, eight All-Pro selections, and a Super Bowl ring before he retired somewhat abruptly in March 2024.

After two seasons enjoying retirement with his family, Donald began to entertain the notion of a comeback this summer after the Rams traded for Garrett, one of Donald's few peers in contemporary defensive line play.

Donald went through nearly two months of physical preparation for his comeback, working out at the Rams' training complex and elsewhere as he tested his body for the rigors of another NFL season.

Coach **Sean McVay** has seemed confident for weeks that Donald was leaning toward a return, but the decision process stretched through the entire preseason and into the current quiet week before the Rams begin preparations for their Sept. 10 season opener against the 49ers in Australia.

Donald's 111 career sacks are the Rams' franchise record.

Giants keeping Beckham

Odell Beckham Jr. made the Giants' 53-man roster, a significant milestone in the wide receiver's comeback at age 33 with the team he started his NFL career with.

Lot of new faces on the roster

►PATRIOTS

Continued from Page C1

2. The Patriots completed two trades.

The Patriots traded for two players: Cardinals running back Corey Kiner and Vikings offensive tackle Walter Rouse. Both would have been released by their respective teams and subjected to waivers, but the Patriots, who are 31st in priority on the waiver wire, decided to part with some late-round draft capital to ensure they acquired them.

Kiner (5 feet 9 inches, 209 pounds) rounds out the running back room with Rhamondre Stevenson and TreVeyon Henderson. The Patriots explored multiple options (e.g. Hassan Haskins, Ian Larison, Miller) for the third running back spot, but ultimately decided to pursue an external candidate. Larison, who also can catch passes and return kicks, is a strong candidate for the practice squad, if he clears waivers.

Rouse (6-6, 314) provides some additional depth at tackle, with Bryant missing at least the first four games of the season on injured reserve. Rouse, drafted by the Vikings in the sixth round in 2024, has appeared in eight games over the past two seasons, playing 88 offensive snaps.

3. Edge rusher Harold Landry and special teamer Brenden Schooler are not ready to start the season.

The Patriots did not activate Landry (physically unable to perform list) or Schooler (non-football injury list), meaning both players will be required to miss at least the first four games of the season.

Landry is still recovering from a knee injury that hindered him throughout the second half of last season, while the nature of Schooler's injury is unknown. Schooler did participate in portions of the spring program, before remaining sidelined for the entirety of training camp.

It's fair to wonder what the future holds for the 30-year-old Landry, who is a favorite of coach Mike Vabel. Edge rusher remains a major area of need for the Patriots, who will be relying on veteran Dre'Mont Jones and second-year player Elijah Ponder as their starters. If Landry can return to form at some point this season, his contributions would be welcomed.



MARK J. TERRILL/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Rams could have a fearsome pass rush as Aaron Donald teams up with Myles Garrett.

Beckham got better as training camp progressed and showed in exhibition play that he could still produce. He made seven catches for 76 yards over three games, including three for 53 in the preseason finale against the Jets. His last game was Dec. 8, 2024, with the Dolphins.

Jacobs put on exempt list

Packers running back **Josh Jacobs** has been placed on the commissioner's exempt list, meaning he can't practice or play, while two misdemeanor charges for battery and criminal damage to property against him are pending. The charges arose from what police described as a physical confrontation between Jacobs and his girlfriend . . . Broncos linebacker **Jonathon Cooper**, who's facing a felony strangulation charge, will start the season on the commissioner's exempt list. Cooper faces an arraignment Monday on several charges following two domestic-violence arrests in June stemming from altercations with a woman he was dating at the time. He's expected to enter a plea unless an agreement is reached beforehand . . . Colts wide receiver **Keenan Allen** was arrested Sunday on drunken driving charges. Indianapolis announced Aug. 19 it had agreed to a one-year contract with the six-time Pro Bowl selection.

4. Two players dealing with injuries have spots on the roster.

If a team places a player on injured reserve prior to cutdown day (e.g. tight end Julian Hill), then he is set to miss the entirety of the season. If a team places a player on injured reserve on cutdown day, then it can also do so with a "designation to return" tag. Each team can use that tag on a maximum of two players.

The Patriots used one of those spots on Bryant. They still have two players dealing with notable injuries in interior offensive lineman Ben Brown and punter Bryce Baringer. That both players earned a spot on the 53-man roster could indicate their injuries are not expected to keep them out long-term.

If Brown cannot suit up for the opener, then veteran Greg Van Roten will step up as the team's top backup on the interior offensive line. If Baringer is unable to go, then the Patriots would likely have to sign a punter (potentially Matt Haack, whom they released Sunday) to the practice squad and temporarily elevate him to the game-day roster.

5. More moves are coming.

The Patriots will likely be scouring the list of players released by other teams to see if there are any reinforcements they can sign as a free agent or claim via waivers. Among the positions the team could use some additional depth at are defensive line, edge rusher, and linebacker.

6. The Patriots still turned over the majority of their roster.

After hiring Vrabel, they turned over more than half the roster last year. Coming off a trip to the Super Bowl, they once again made significant changes. Of the 53 players currently on the team, 23 are new faces. It's rare for a conference champion to engage in so much turnover, but speaks to the astonishing nature of last year's run. The Seahawks, for reference, have just seven new faces on their initial 53-man roster.

Nicole Yang can be reached at nicole.yang@globe.com. Follow her on X @nicolecyang.

NFL transactions

Arizona: T Christian Jones, CB Kalen King, DT Brodrick Martin-Rhodes, CB Quinton Newsome, LB BJ Ojulari, S Isaiah Oliver, TE Teagan Qutoriano, LB Cameron Robertson, T Valentin Senn, WR Ihmir Smith-Marsette, DT Keveion'ia Spears, RB Tre Stewart, CB Starling Thomas V, T Oli Udoh, WR Harrison Wallace, DT Damicion Williams, CB Elijah Jones, T Demontrey Jacobs, RB Evan Hull, CB Sean Murphy-Bunting, LB Owen Pappoe, T Matt Pryor, QB Kedon Slovis, S Josh Minkins, LB Eugene Asante, S Devyn Bobby, TE Shawn Bowman, LB Elliott Brown, P Jack Browning, S Hudson Clark, CB Elijah Culp, C Ka'ena De Cambra, TE Rivaldo Fairweather, DT Cam Horsley, DE Jonah Williams cut. TE Tip Reiman placed on PUPL.

Atlanta: T Wanya Morris, G Kam Dewberry, RB Nathan Carter, CB Cobee Bryant, DT Carlos Allen, LB Josh Woods, DT Chris Williams, DT Marlon Tuipulotu, LB Azeez Ojulari, CB Darnay Holmes, RB Tyler Goodson, DE Keshawn Banks, WR Vinny Anthony II, DE Cameron Sample, C James Brockermeier, TE Nick Muse, WR Dylan Drummond cut. DT Gervon Dexter Sr. traded to Atlanta. DT Antonio Thompson placed on reserve/non-football injury.

Baltimore: T Gerad Lichtenhan, DT David Olajiga, LB Adisa Isaac, DT Rayshaun Benny cut.

Buffalo: CB Kani Walker, WR Ja'Mori Maclin, CB Toriano Pride, WR Trent Sheffield Sr., S Geno Stone, WR Max Tomczak, RB Ben VanSumeren, G Da'Metrius Weatherspoon, RB Ian Wheeler, T Chase Lundt, CB Anthony Kendall, LB Andre Jones, G Nick Broeker, QB Shane Buechele, LB Jimmy Ciarlo, DT Travis Clayton, CB Te'Cory Couch, RB Frank Gore, WR Stephen Gossnell, LB Keonta Jenkins, P Mitch Wishnowsky cut. WR Tyrell Shavers placed on PUPL.

Carolina: QB Kyle Trask, LB Jeremiah Moon, T Jake Curhan, LB Maema Njongmeta, DT Parker Petersen, CB DeVonta Smith, DE Elijah Garcia, TE James Mitchell cut.

Chicago: RB Brittian Brown, CB Jaylon Jones, WR Ray-Ray McClood placed on IR. WR Scotty Miller, TE Qadir Ismail, S Anthony Johnson, WR Omari Kelly, C Jaren Kump, DE Jeremiah Martin, LB Wayne Matthews, QB Miller Moss, CB Deantre Prince, S Marlen Sewell, CB Terrell Smith, CB William Wright, CB Beanie Bishop, LB Ruben Hyppolite II, CB Dontae Manning, G Kyle Hergel, LB Antonio Grier, T Jetrick Wills, WR JP Richardson, T Mason Murphy, RB Salvon Ahmed, TE Stephen Carlson, DE Marcus Davenport, C Wesley French, DT James Lynch, LB Jon Rhattigan, LB Jack Sanborn, WR Maurice Alexander, T Kiran Amegadjie, G Caden Barnett, WR Kaden Davis, DE Dayo Odeyingbo cut. CB Clark Phillips traded to Atlanta. CB Kyler Gordon, LB Noah Sewell, DT Shemar Turner placed on PUPL.

Cincinnati: RB Gary Brightwell, DT Jordan Jefferson, WR Xavier Johnson, WR Charlie Jones, T Christian Jones, TE Josh Kattus, CB Jalen Kimber, CB Bralyn Lux, CB Matthew McDoom, RB Kendall Milton, WR Jordan Moore, DE Antwaun Powell-Ryland, WR Kendrick Pryor, G Corey Robinson II, WR Noah Thomas, DT McKinnley Jackson, LB Shaka Heyward, RB Jamal Haynes, LB Joe Giles-Harris, QB Josh Johnson, S Russ Yeast, LB Liam Anderson, S Daijahn Anthony, G Liam Brown, RB Kentrel Bullock, QB Seair Clifford, T Andrew Coker, DT Howard Cross, LB Jack Dingle, DE Isaiah Foskey, LB Eric Gentry, TE Cam Grandy, WR Mitch Tinsley cut.

Cleveland: DT Sam Kamara, LB Nathaniel Watson, S Zion Washington, LB Edefuan Olofoshio, DE Khordae Sydnor, DE Tyreek Sapp, P Wes Pahl, RB Ahmani Marshall, T KT Leveston, WR Gage Larvadain, WR Luke Floriea, DE Logan Fano, C Kingsley Eguakun, DT Elijah Chatman, RB Davon Booth, DT Travis Bell, CB D'Angelo Ross, CB Myles Bryant, WR Kole Wilson cut. TE Joe Royer placed on reserve/non football injury.

Dallas: WR Denzel Mims, TE DJ Rogers, LB Justin Barron, CB Trik-weze Bridges, RB Jashaun Corbin, DT Tommy Dunn, WR Jordan Hudson, T Marcellus Johnson, LB Isaiah Lang, TE Michael Trigg, DT DJ. Withers, S Julius Wood, WR Tyler Johnson, CB Derion Kendrick, G Nick Leverett, LB Curtis Robinson, WR Anthony Smith, RB Israel Abanikanda, G Trevor Keegan, T Shiyazh Pete, CB Reddy Steward, CB Josh Butler, G Chris Glaser, T Zack Kuntz, TE Mitch Van Vooren, LB Langston Patterson, CB Zion Childress, WR Jaden Smith, G Sebastian Gutierrez, G DJ Wingfield, RB Phil Mafah, WR Marquez Valdes-Scantling, DT Jay Toia, RB Jaydon Blue, LB Sam Williams cut. Acquired T Broderick Jones from Pittsburgh.

Denver: DT Israel Antwine, S Miles Scott, DE Ron Stone, CB Reese Taylor, LB Johnny Walker, DT Kristian Williams, LB Taurean York, LB Drew Sanders, TE Mitchell Fraboni, TE Lucas Krull, RB Adam Prentice, T Foster Sarell, C Lecitus Smith, G Calvin Throckmorton, LB Dasan McCullough, RB Jaleel McLaughlin, RB Cody Schrader, WR Kyrese Rowan, CB Brent Austin, WR Michael Latu, TE Luke Basso, CB Sean Fresco, CB Ricardo Hallman, T Reid Holskey, TE Justin Joly, WR Kolbe Katsis, WR Dane Key, WR Joseph Manjack, T Tyler Miller, LB Red Murdock, G Gavin Ortega, S Parker Robertson, WR Cameron Ross, NT Jordan Miller cut. G Nick Gargiulo placed on PUPL. LB Jonathon Cooper placed on exempt/commissioner's permission list.

Detroit: LB Troy Reeder, DE Myles Adams, TE Zach Horton, WR Greg Dortch, CB Nick Whiteside, G Mason Miller cut. S Kerby Joseph placed on PUPL.

Green Bay: CB Domani Jackson, RB Damien Martinez, DE Arron Mosby, RB Jaden Nixon, S Mark Perry, WR Kaden Prather, LB TJ Quinn, CB Jaylin Simpson, DT Nazir Stackhouse, TE Messiah Swinson, G Dillon Wade, LB Arden Walker, LB Kristian Welch, TE McCallan Castles, S Trey Dean, T Darian Kinnard, S Murvin Kenion, WR Kisean Johnson, DE Nyjalik Kelly, RB Pierre Strong, WR Will Sheppard, DT Jaden Crumedy, WR Isaiah Neyor, TE Cal Adomitis, T Brant Banks, G Dylan Barrett, CB Shemar Bartholomew, T Dalton Cooper, TE Drake Dabney, CB MJ Devonshire, G Josh Gesky, WR Chris Hilton, TE Thomas Yassinin cut. Acquired RB Ka'leb Johnson from Pittsburgh. Acquired TE Mark Redman from LA Rams. DE Micah Parsons, TE Luke Musgrave, DT Jordan Riley placed on PUPL. RB Josh Jacobs placed on exempt/commissioner's permission list.

Houston: DE Ali Gae placed on IR. DT Dominic Bailey, RB Noah Whittington, RB Owen Wright, DE Solomon Byrd, DT Kyonte Hamilton, CB Bryce Hall, LB Caleb Johnson, DT Naquan Jones, WR Zay Jones, TE Brevin Jordan, S George Odum, DE Dominique Robinson, QB Brett Rypien, WR Sterling Shepard, RB Deuce Vaughn, WR Daniel Sobkowicz, WR Sterlyon Saunders, WR Lewis Bond, CB Brandon Coddington, C Eli Cox, CB Stephen Hall, TE Louis Hansen, LB Jamal Hill, CB Elijah Huzzie, RB Jawhar Jordan, T Jarrett Kingston, S Kaevon Merrieweather, T James Neal, DE Derek Parish, TE Layne Pryor, WR Justin Watson cut. Acquired T Nate Thomas from Dallas. LB E.J. Speed, S M.J. Stewart placed on PUPL.

Indianapolis: WR D.J. Montgomery, WR Coleman Owen placed on IR. S Ben Nikkel, WR Eli Pancel, CB Mekhi Rodgers, T Nolan Rucci, S Daniel Scott, WR Raylen Sharpe, C Geno DeVonMark, LB Devin Veresuk, S Trey Washington, T Trey Wedig, DT Colby Wooden, TE Pharaoh Brown, DT Derrick Nnadi, G Josh Sills, QB Easton Stick, S Juanyeh Thomas, DE Durell Nchami, C Jimmy Morrissey, DT Cam Ball, RB Ulysses Bentley IV, S Austin Brown, CB Robert Carter, RB Anderson Castie, T Blake Freeland, TE JJ Galbreath, WR Anthony Gould, K Blake Gray, WR Sahmir Hagans, CB Kenneth Harris, C Josh Kreutz, T Roy Mbaeteka, DE Mitchell Melton, TE Tyler Moore, WR Nick Westbrook-Ikhine cut. Acquired C Sedrick Van Pran-Granger from Buffalo.

Jacksonville: Acquired 2028 sixth-round draft pick from Arizona for TE Hunter Long and 2028 Seventh-round draft pick. C Sam Mustipher placed on IR. WR Brady Boyd, WR Trebor Pena, S Cam'Ron Silmon-Craig, RB J'Mar'i Taylor, S Trevian Thomas, WR Michael Wortham, T Kilian Zierer, QB Carter Bradley, DT Keivie Rose, CB Corey Ballentine, T Geron Christian Sr., RB DeeJay Dallas, G Chuma Edoga, WR Tim Jones, QB Nick Mullens, LB Baylon Spector, T Jimto Obidegwu, S Devin Neal, CB Jabbar Muhammad, LB Yasir Abdullah, WR Joey Aquilar, DT Tommy Akingbesote, DT T.J. Bollers, WR Chandler Brayboy, LB Amari Burney, G Jerome Carvin, DE Quindarius Dunnigan, TE Patrick Herbert, CB Preston Hodge, DT Jalen Hunt, LB Jack Kiser, T Ricky Lee, LB Jalen McLeod, G Timothy McKay, WR Austin Trammell cut.

Kansas City: WR Jimmy Holiday placed on IR. LB Wesley Bis-sainthe, DT Amari McNeill, C Pete Nygra, RB Jaydn Ott, DT Damon Payne, CB Arco Perkins-McAllister, TE Mason Pline, T Esa Pole, S DeShon Singleton, CB Melvin Smith, DE Tyreke Smith, G Josh Thompson, CB Zelman Vedder, TE Tre Watson, WR Jeff Weimer, G

C.J. Hanson, QB Chris Oladokun, S Tanner McCalister, WR Xavier Loyd, DE Miles King, LB Cole Christiansen, CB Kaiir Elam, CB Kader Kohou, DE Emmanuel Ogboh, DE VJ Anthony, LB Kam Arnold, WR Andrew Armstrong, WR Jason Brownlee, DT Cole Brevard, WR Jacob De Jesus, RB Emari Demercado, DT Ethan Driskell, WR Omari Evans, T Chukwuebuka Godrick, DE Ethan Hurkett, LB Cam Jones, RB EJ Smith cut. Acquired T Diego Pounds from Baltimore. DT Omarr Norman-Lott placed on PUPL.

Las Vegas: DE Keyron Crawford placed on IR. RB Dare Ogunbowale, DE Cilan Slone, LB Xavian Sorey, DT Gary Smith, CB Greedy Vance, T Dalton Wagner, WR E.J. Williams, WR Phillip Dorsett II, WR Brandon Johnson, LB Buddy Johnson, LB Cameron McGrone, TE Chris Myarick, TE Albert Okwuegbunam, LB Segun Olubi, WR Deven Thompson, C Will Putnam, S Devyn Perkins, CB Caleb O'ford, QB Jacob Clark, DT Brandon Cleveland, G Braeden Daniels, C Tyler Duzansky, TE Patrick Gurd, DE Jahfari Harvey, RB Roman Hemby, T Niklas Henning, WR Shedrick Jackson, T Isaiah Jatta, S Devin Lafayette, DT Treven Ma'ae, K Kansei Matsuzawa, T Kamar Missouri, WR Chase Roberts cut.

LA Chargers: RB Jaret Patterson, P JK Scott, WR Sincere Brown, WR Dalevon Campbell, LB Kyle Kennard, S Noah Avinger cut. T Isaiah World placed on reserve/non football injury.

LA Rams: WR Tyler Scott, S Tanner Ingle, DT Tim Keenan, DT Jackson Moi, DE Larrell Murchison, LB Elias Neal, DT Bill Norton, LB Darryl Peterson, WR Brennan Presley, G Blake Hance, CB Nyzier Fourquran, S Nick Andersen, CB Cam Lampkin, RB Dean Connors, T AJ Arcuri, WR Alex Bachman, C Austin Blaske, P Jack Bouwmeester, T Wyatt Bowles, RB Jordan Waters cut. DT Aaron Donald signed.

Miami: T Gottlieb Ayezde, RB Carlos Washington, DT Matthew Butler, LB Tyler Dodoson, LB Cameron Goode, T Charlie Heck, S Lonnie Johnson, WR Terrace Marshall, LB David Ojabo, WR Jalen Reagor, LB Cam Riley, DT Fatomra Mulbah, CB Miles Battle, S Major Burns, TE Jeremiah Franklin, QB Mark Gronowski, RB Jarquez Hunter, WR Donaven McCulley, DE Rodney McGraw, CB Ja'Onte' McMillan, QB Cam Miller, CB Marco Wilson cut. QB Kyle McCord traded to Green Bay. CB Darrell Baker, CB Storm Duck placed on PUPL.

Minnesota: LB Tyler Batty placed on IR. S Tavierre Thomas, LB Bangally Kamara, C Delby Lemieux, T Tristan Leigh, G Vershon Lee, G Tomas Rimac, G Henry Byrd, G Joshua Gray, TE Marshall Lang, DE Smith Vilbert, DT Jahvaree Ritzie, RB Jermar Jefferson, WR Dontae Fleming, CB Marcus Allen, LB Jacob Roberts, LB Kenny Dyson, C Gavin Gerhardt, LB Josh Ross, LB Cam'Ron Stewart, DT Isaiahh Loudermilk, P Johnny Hekker, TE Marshall Lang, WR Michael Briscoe, S Kahlef Halassie, CB Bryce Phillips, WR Trayvon Rudolph, WR Marcus Sanders, CB Jarod Washington, RB Zavier Scott, CB Da'Veawn Armstead, WR Terrill Davis, CB Tre Hawkins, DE Jonathan Harris, TE Matt Lauter, TE Bryson Nesbit cut.

New England: RB Jam Miller, C Joe Michalski, DT Eric Gregory, TE Jack Westover, LB Chad Muma cut. Acquired T Walter Rouse and 2027 seventh-round draft pick from Minnesota for 2027 sixth-round draft pick.

New Orleans: CB Dalys Beanam, RB Devin Neal, DE Michael Heldman, CB David Long, T Barry Wesley placed on IR. WR Ronnie Bell, K Charlie Smyth, WR Jalen Moreno-Cropper, CB TJ Hall, CB Michael Davis, CB Isaac Yadiom, RB CJ Donaldson, K Tanner Brown, DE Myles Cole, DE Fadil Diggs, TE Cody Hardy, WR Trey Palmer, G Torricelli Simpkins, LB Jackson Sirmoon, WR Zamiir White, DT Jay'viar Suggs, S Elliott Davison, QB Hunter Dekkers, WR Bub Means, TE Zaire Mitchell-Paden, LB Garrett Nelson, DT Kahlii Saunders, DE Brian Taylor, T Xavier Truss, LB Malakai Williams, S Terrell Burgess, T Alan Herron, T Easton Kilty, WR Brock Rechsteiner, T Alex Wollschlaeger cut. WR Mason Tipton placed on PUPL.

NY Giants: RB Dante Miller, LB Khalid Kareem, S Raheem Layne, DT Josh Tupou, DT Anquin Barnes, DT Ben Barten, RB Grant Finley, WR Xavier Gipson, T Jarrod Gray, G Jake Kubas, LB Chandler Martin, LB Darius Muasau, S JT Woods, CB Art Green, DT Marlon Davidson, TE Tanner Conner, QB Brandon Allen, C Lucas Patrick, QB Jake Haener, WR Dalen Cambre, DT Zach Pickens, WR Braxton Berrios, LB Caleb Murphy, T Ryan Scherneck, RB Eric Gray, LB Trace Ford, WR Jaliri Hyatt, S Beau Brade, T Evan Neal, K Ben Sauls cut.

NY Jets: DT Jack Heflin cut. Acquired C Jordan Meredith from Las Vegas.

Philadelphia: TE Grant Calcatera placed on IR. WR Samori Toure, DT Gabe Hall, LB Keyshawn James-Newby, TE Cameron Latu, LB Deontae Lawson, S Jaylen Mahoney, C Jake Majors, RB Jordan Mims, DT Darius Muasau, S Maximus Pulley, LB Jose Ramirez, S Andre' Sam, RB Carson Steele, WR Tahj Washington, LB Joshua Weru, T Cameron Williams, DT Zion Wilson, CB Kapena Gushiken, LB Brandon George, CB Ambry Thomas, CB Shaun Wade, T Myles Hinton, RB Dameon Pierce, LB Chance Campbell, WR Britain Covey, WR Danny Gray, LB Tarron Jackson, G Michael Jordan, TE Stone Smartt, QB Quetz Watkins, DT Uar Bernard, DT David Blay, CB Isaiah Bolden, C Zeke Correll, WR Erik Ezukanma, S Cole Wisniewski cut.

Pittsburgh: LB Malik Harrison, RB Lew Nichols, CB Doneiko Slaughter, WR Brandon Smith, LB Julius Welschof, LB Jacoby Windmon, RB Travis Homer, DT Dean Lowry, LB Elandon Roberts, G Doug Nester, TE Lake McRee, TE Lance Mason, DT Ezezi Otomowe, DT Kelly Baugh, CB Devan Boykin, S Sebastian Castro, DE Anthony Goodlow, WR Max Hurlman, C D'Shawn Jamison, G Steven Jones, WR Levi Wentz cut. CB Donte Kent placed on PUPL.

San Francisco: T Brett Toth, G Nick Zakelj placed on IR. QB Adrian Martinez, WR Malik Turner, P Corliss Waitman, C Jon Weeks, DT Evan Anderson, DT Bryson Eason, DT Villami Fehoko, LB Jalen Graham, WR Wesley Gimes, DE Jah Joyner, CB Darrell Luter, RB Sincere McCormick, C Drake Nugent, CB Jakob Robinson, DT Sebastian Valdez, T Brandon Parker, DE Ogbo Okoronkwo, C Doug Kraife, DE Quinton Bell, T Isaac Alarcon, LB Deion Jones, TE Khaliil Dinwiddie, G Robert Jones, WR Will Pauling, S Patrick McMorris, S Jalen Stroman, TE Hayden Rucci, WR Kha'Darel Hodge, CB Eli Apple, S Ashtyn Davis, RB Khalil Herbert, WR Trenton Irwin, LB Larry Worth cut. Acquired C Jarrett Patterson from Houston. RB Isaac Guerendo, DE Mykel Williams placed on PUPL.

Seattle: WR Emmanuel Henderson, LB Aidan Hubbard, LB Jared Ivey, S Tysheem Johnson, RB Justin Jones, C Federico Maranges, WR Rashad Rochelle, NT Uose Seumalo, LB Jamie Sherif, NT J.R. Singleton, NT Bubba Thomas, CB Jordan Washington, RB Jacardia Wright, LB Power Echols, T Amari Kight, RB Brock Lampe, LB Aaron Smith, S Maxen Hook, WR Julian Hicks, WR Ricky White, S D'Anthony Bell, CB Michael Dansby, LB Jalan Gaines, T Kellen Diesch, S Rodney Thomas II, CB Trevon Diggs, T Bobby Hart, CB Noah Igbinoghene, RB Velus Jones, TE Nick Vannett, WR Cody White, T Logan Brown, NT Deven Eastern, S AJ Finley, CB Andre Fuller, LB Marvin Jones cut. Acquired CB Avery Smith from LA Chargers. RB Zach Charbonnet placed on PUPL. CB Terrion Arnold placed on exempt/commissioner's permission list.

Tampa Bay: QB Jake Browning, G Nash Huntmacher, T Marshall Fournier, DT Jayson Jones, DT Josiah Green, DT Travis Shaw, LB Yasir Holmes, LB John Bullock, LB Nick Jackson, S J.J. Roberts, S Rashad Wisdom, S Robert McDaniel, S Xavier Williams, K B.T. Potter, C Scott Daly, G Elijah Klein, G Ben Scott, TE Kenny Fletcher, LB Jack Pyburn, CB Roman Parodie, RB Josh Williams, LB Mohamed Kamara, CB Damarion Williams, T Paul Rubelt, G Henry Lutovsky, QB Connor Bazelak, RB Barika Kpeunu, WR Dean Patterson IV, WR Eric Rivers, WR Jha'Quan Jackson, WR Matthew Henry, TE Devin Culp, LB Chris Braswell cut.

Tennessee: QB Will Lewis cut.

Washington: LB Boogie Basham, T Daniel Brunskill, TE Lawrence Cager, CB Antonio Hamilton Sr., C Trey Hill, DT Maurice Hurst II, LB Curtis Jacobs, S Quindell Johnson, WR Jacoby Jones, LB Ale Kaho, DE T.J. Maguranyanga, TE Tre' McKitty, TE Quentin Moore, CB Fabian Moreau, WR Nick Nash, T Nicholas Petit-Frere, WR Jaden Bradley, LB Krys Barnes, CB Car'lin Vigers, G Julian Good-Jones, CB Fred Davis II, DT Byron Cowart, G Max Scharping, RB Craig Reynolds, DT Jeffrey M'ba, DE D.J. Johnson, S Joshua Bledsoe, S Qwuantrezz Knight, RB Robert Henry, T Trent Scott, QB Sam Hartman, DT Shy Tuttle, WR Van Jefferson, CB Darius Rush cut. DE Deatrice Wise placed on PUPL.

SportsLog

Curacao captures its second Little League World Series crown

Juriënsly De Windt and **Shardijon De Lanoi** combined to drive in six runs, and Curacao won its second Little League World Series title, beating Nevada, 11-2, in the championship game on Sunday in Williamsport, Pa. De Windt started and allowed two runs in three innings. **Giendry Ryan** and **Steven Felix** were nearly flawless in relief with four strikeouts over the final three innings for the tiny island nation, which previously won the tournament in 2004. Curacao had advanced to the finals by winning the international title in 2005, 2019, 2022, and 2023. This time, the group from Pariba Little League in Willemstad had enough firepower from the mound and at the plate to beat the US champion. Curacao went unbeaten in the double-elimination tourney before overcoming an early two-run deficit to the team from Henderson, Nev. Ryan fanned four in 2½ innings. Felix forced Nevada's final batter to pop out to Ryan in center field. Once the ball was safely in his glove, the celebrations began. Nevada also was the runner-up last year, falling to Taiwan in the championship game.

W N B A
Reese now double-double ace

Angel Reese broke a WNBA record with her 29th double-double this season, **Allisha Gray** made six 3-pointers and finished with 23 points and 11 rebounds, and the Atlanta Dream beat the league-leading Minnesota Lynx, 89-81, in their last game before the FIBA World Cup break. Reese, who already set records this year for rebounds in a season and a game, had 15 points and 11 rebounds to surpass **Alyssa Thomas's** 28 double-doubles from 2023 . . . **Aaliyah Edwards** had a game-high 26 points, but the Connecticut Sun lost, 97-71, to the Dallas Wings to reach 30 losses in a season for the second time in franchise history. The Sun (10-30) lost a franchise-worst 33 games last season.

S O C C E R
Martínez debuts for Chelsea

Chelsea made official the signing of Argentina keeper **Emiliano Martínez**. The English club said

the 33-year-old, who won the World Cup in 2022, has signed a three-year deal, joining from Aston Villa. Martínez immediately took over the starting goalkeeping spot in a 4-3 victory over Brighton . . . England striker **Ollie Watkins** joined the list of high-profile departures from Aston Villa when he completed a move to Saudi Arabian team Al-Hilal for a reported \$69 million. The 30-year-old Watkins has been at Villa since joining from Brentford in 2020 and reached double figures in goals every season he was at the club. Martínez and Watkins join **Morgan Rogers** (Chelsea), **Youri Tielemans** (Manchester United), and **Ezri Konsa** (Arsenal) as high-profile departures in this transfer window after Villa finished fourth in the Premier League last season . . . Former Serie A MVP **Rafael Leão** completed a \$44 million transfer from AC Milan to Galatasaray.

Dutch call for new leadership

The Dutch football federation is calling for an international summit to discuss the future of FIFA after becoming the latest nation to call for new

leadership at the global soccer governing body. In a statement, the federation said it “no longer has confidence” in FIFA president **Gianni Infantino**, and offered to host a summit to discuss ideas to reshape the organisation. The Dutch federation said there is a need for a “new FIFA,” not just a new president.

M O T O R S P O R T S
Palou takes IndyCar title

Alex Palou won his record-tying fourth consecutive IndyCar season championship with a 10th-place finish in the resumption of a rain-delayed race at the Milwaukee Mile. The 29-year-old from Barcelona, Spain, added to yet another dominating year for himself and Chip Ganassi Racing. Palou's four consecutive championships match the record set by **Sebastien Bourdais** from 2004-07. He also is the youngest driver in series history with five titles. He now only trails **A.J. Foyt** (seven) and **Scott Dixon** (six). In 17 races this season, Palou has six wins, 12 top-five finishes, and 14 top-10 results.

The Boston Globe

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Baseball

RED SOX NOTEBOOK

Gray’s start delayed to add in more rest

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

NEW YORK — Righthander **Sonny Gray**, the Red Sox’ best pitcher this season and the arm on which they have most relied over the past month, will not take his regular turn in the rotation Tuesday.

Instead, he will pitch Saturday against the Orioles in Baltimore, he said. That will be 10 days after his most recent appearance.

It is part of the Sox’ overarching aim to rest their pitchers when able and — with four weeks to go in the regular season — line up their rotation as desired, though it comes at a curious time.

Recently, the Red Sox bumped back rookie **Jake Bennett** amid what they said were workload considerations. It’s the veteran Gray’s turn.

“Take a few extra days, get your body right,” Gray said.

Gray said there isn’t anything specifically wrong physically, but he doesn’t mind the additional time.

In August, the Red Sox rearranged their rotation in part around Gray, pitching him on four days of rest in all but one turn (with one extra day off mixed in via a team off day during the second half of the month). At the time, interim manager **Chad Tracy** said that was to keep Gray on a regular routine, Gray’s preference.

Gray, 36, is fourth in the American League with a 2.82 ERA. He leads the Sox in starts (25) and innings (143⅔). His past two outings have been mediocre relative to his norm: four runs and six innings against the Giants, then two runs in five innings against the Marlins.

Giving Gray a reprieve now is interesting because the Red Sox are in the middle of a 13-day, 14-game stretch (thanks to Saturday’s doubleheader) with no offdays — and they don’t have an obvious fill-in.

Against the Mariners, the Sox will turn to lefthander **Payton Tolle** in his normal spot Monday and keep lefthander **Patrick Sandoval** in line for Wednesday.

That leaves them with an opening Tuesday in place of Gray. That also is the day active rosters expand from 26 to 28 players, so the Sox can call up an extra arm as a spot starter or for a bullpen game.

“We’re just talking through what we want to do,” Tracy said. “It’s September

Mariners-Red Sox series thumbnails

At Fenway Park Monday, 6:45 p.m. NESN, WEEI-FM (93.7)			
	W-L	ERA	
RHP George Kirby	9-10	4.02	
LHP Payton Tolle	8-6	3.09	
Tuesday, 6:45 p.m. NESN, WEEI-FM (93.7)			
	W-L	ERA	
RHP Bryan Woo	9-9	4.36	
TBD	—	—	
Wednesday, 4:10 p.m. NESN, WEEI-FM (93.7)			
	W-L	ERA	
TBD	—	—	
LHP Patrick Sandoval	1-3	4.20	

Head to head: This is the second of two series. The Red Sox won two of three games June 19-21 in Seattle.

Miscellany: Despite having the fifth-worst record in the American League, Seattle (64-73) is just five games behind the Astros (69-68) in the AL West . . . The Mariners were swept in three games at the Blue Jays this weekend by a combined 19-4, including 7-0 Sunday . . . The Mariners rank last in MLB with 3.87 runs per game . . . Seattle pitchers have walked 359, second fewest in MLB . . . Woo’s 4.73 K/BB ratio is third best in the American League.

and we’re talking through, what do we want to do and how do we want to structure this rotation? . . . We’ll get more information as we go.”

Contreras departs

Willson Contreras exited the 16-1 loss to the Yankees in the seventh inning (when it was a six-run game) because his hamstring was tight. It has bothered him for about a month and flared up again. “Just felt like at that point in the game, I don’t want to push it, so we got him out of there,” Tracy said . . . **Ceddanne Rafaela** said he was fine after he tweaked his neck on a diving catch attempt . . . The Yankees announced a crowd of 45,256 on Sunday and sold out just one of four games against the Red Sox — a Saturday matinee that was a makeup of a June rainout and included many empty seats.

Tim Healey can be reached at timothy.healey@globe.com.

Anthony, Story smack a pair of hits each in return to lineup

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

NEW YORK — When Roman Anthony and Trevor Story returned to the Red Sox on Sunday, a morning of hugs and hellos with teammates they hadn’t seen in who knows how long, they found a squad with an entirely different feel and fate relative to when they last suited up.

When Anthony sprained his right hand/wrist in early May, Chad Tracy had been interim manager for only a week-plus. When Story had sports hernia surgery later that month, the Sox were down-right toiling.

Now, they are in prime playoff position with less than a month remaining in the regular season. So when Tracy put them back in the lineup against the Yankees, Anthony as the designated hitter batting lead-off — he doubled in his first at-bat — and Story as the shortstop hitting eighth, the mission was clear.

Don’t mess this up. Just do what is needed to keep the Sox streaking the way they have for months.

“It’s not like heroes are coming back,” Story said before the series finale at the Stadium. “We’re not looking at it that way. These guys have put in the work and done the things and performed on the field to get us to where we’re at, and we’re just coming in to help that.”

Said Anthony: “I give so much credit to the guys in here who have done it along the way, and all the guys that have contributed whether they’re here or not . . . We talked about it a lot, Trevor and I. We don’t have to do anything more than just come here and be ourselves and play baseball with this group.”

Anthony went 2 for 4, while Story was 2 for 3 and scored a run in Boston’s 16-1 loss. They accounted for four of the seven Red Sox hits Sunday.

Both alluded to the batch of fill-ins who helped catapult the Sox from the bottom of the American League into the second wild-card spot.

Among those individuals: Anthony Seigler and Mickey Gasper, who were sent down to Triple-A Worcester to clear spots on the active roster.

Those decisions — and the ensuing conversations with them — were “very difficult” and “bittersweet,” Tracy said. He expresses that sentiment often when discussing demotions, but it hit harder this time because of what he called their “instru-

mental” contributions.

Seigler served as the starting second baseman — and a clutch, emotional spark-plug — for more than a month, a late-June-through-July stretch that proved to be the most important of the season. Gasper has had a few stints in the majors, most recently an 11-game run in which he hit five home runs and batted .423.

“There’s a very good chance that you might get an American League Player of the Week that we just had to send down,” Tracy said of Gasper. “I can’t think of a conversation I’ve had to have [that was] more difficult than telling that guy, [with] what he’s done over the course of the last 10 days or so, [that he’s going back to the minors].”

Still, they were the obvious answers to the roster question. Seigler’s playing time had dried up, with Nick Sogard largely taking over second base and Andruw Monasterio set to play some second and some shortstop.

Gasper had been DHing in place of the injured Masataka Yoshida, but Anthony figures to get most of those at-bats, with Jahmai Jones factoring in against lefthanders.

“You just wait and wait and wait until you get to the point where it’s like, all right, it’s upon us now, and we have to decide [what to do with the roster],” Tracy said. “I’ve been thinking about that for a while.”

Story played in 10 minor league games during his rehabilitation assignment and had poor numbers. Anthony was better in eight appearances.

They both said that they feel strong physically and ready to contribute in the majors.

“Big thing for me was just kind of getting back into baseball mode,” Anthony said. “You have an injury for so long that it almost feels like playing baseball is foreign.”

Story said: “It’s been a hard three months, but happy to be here now and fit right in with this group and keep winning games.”

Story said he has not spoken with Tracy about how often he will play. Tracy in recent days has expressed a desire to play those who are playing well — ride the hot hand. So Story may well have to earn his spot in the lineup in order to stay in it.

Tim Healey can be reached at timothy.healey@globe.com. Follow him @timbhealey.



EVAN BERNSTEIN/GETTY IMAGES

In his return to the lineup, Trevor Story had a pair of hits and tagged out Amed Rosario in the sixth inning.

After no-catch call, Sox crumble

►RED SOX Continued from Page C1

And I know I made the catch.”

This specific game was of great significance because of how it swung the standings.

In the race for the top American League wild-card spot, the Red Sox suddenly trail the Yankees by four games, double their deficit from the start of the weekend. And now, they don’t have the same-record tiebreaker, which belongs to the Yankees by virtue of their 7-6 advantage in the season series. Call it a five-game hole, with 25 to go in the regular season.

Had the Sox won Sunday, they would have been just two games back of their rivals — and owned that tiebreaker, greatly raising their chances of hosting the best-of-three first round of the playoffs at Fenway Park.

If the playoffs started this week, it would be Sox at Yankees, just like last season.

“It’s tough to lose any of them, but obviously, everybody’s aware of that [standings/tiebreaker] piece of it,” interim manager Chad Tracy said.

The game-turning sequence began with a 0-0 tie and José Caballero ripping a grounder at shortstop Trevor Story. Story couldn’t pick up the short hop, a difficult play on his first day in the lineup since May.

Chisholm followed the single with his line drive. Rafaela ranged to his left and dove. The ball ultimately was in his glove, but after a beat of hesitation, Moscoso — from near first base — signaled no catch. A confused Caballero scooted into second.

Rafaela and right fielder Wilyer Abreu gestured to the Sox dugout. Tracy challenged almost immediately.

“I did not even have to watch it,” Rafaela said. “I know I made the catch.”

Upon review, the call of no catch stood.

Replays showed that the ball landed in Rafaela’s glove, but as he slid and his glove/wrist turned, there was no evidence either way regarding whether the ball touched the grass.

It was Schrödinger’s Catch: When the ball was not visible for that fleeting moment, did it reach the ground or did it not reach the ground?

“It looks like he caught the ball,” Tracy said. “You’re kind of at the mercy of what they call on the field, which

Yankees 16, Red Sox 1

At Yankee Stadium									
BOSTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.		
Anthony dh	4	0	2	0	0	0	.239		
White 2b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.226		
Rafaela cf	4	0	0	0	0	1	.282		
Abreu rf	3	0	2	0	1	0	.257		
Contreras 1b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.274		
Monasterio 2b-p	1	0	0	0	0	0	.248		
Rutschman c	4	0	0	0	0	1	.237		
Durbin 3b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.252		
Duran lf	3	0	0	0	0	0	.207		
Story ss	3	1	2	0	0	1	.265		
Sogard 2b-1b	3	0	1	1	0	2	.214		
Totals	31	1	7	1	1	7			
NY YANKEES	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.		
Goldschmidt 1b	6	2	3	3	0	1	.248		
Bellinger lf	6	1	2	0	0	1	.257		
Ramos rf	2	1	2	3	2	0	.148		
a-SJones pr-rf	2	1	2	0	0	0	.236		
García dh	4	1	1	0	1	1	.306		
Rosario 3b	4	1	2	1	1	0	.234		
Grisham cf	3	0	0	1	1	1	.211		
Caballero ss	5	3	3	3	0	0	.241		
Chisholm 2b	3	3	2	0	0	2	.227		
Sánchez c	1	0	0	0	0	0	.242		
b-Wells ph-c	2	2	2	5	0	0	.184		
Totals	37	16	18	16	7	4			
Boston.....	000 000 010 — 1 7 0								
NY Yankees.....	000 051 19x — 16 18 0								
a-ran for Ramos in 7th, b-hit a sacrifice fly for A.Sánchez in 6th. LOB —Boston 4, NY Yankees 7. 2B —Anthony (6), Story (8). HR —Goldschmidt (18), off Morán, Ramos (1), off Suárez, Caballero (13), off Monasterio, Wells 2 (10), off Morán, off Monasterio. SB —Chisholm 2 (40). CS —Rosario (1). S —Sánchez. SF —Grisham, Wells. RISP —Boston 1 for 5, NY Yankees 5 for 9. DP —Boston 1; NY Yankees 3.									
Boston	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA	
Suarez L 5-4	5½	9	6	6	2	2	101	3.64	
Weissert	½	1	0	0	0	1	15	3.83	
Morán	1½	5	5	5	2	1	40	3.55	
Monasterio	½	3	5	5	3	3	28	67.50	
NY Yankees	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA	
Warren W 9-6	7	6	1	1	1	7	98	4.23	
Hill	2	1	0	0	0	0	17	4.08	
Warren pitched to 2 batters in 8th. Inherited runners—scored —Weissert 1-1, Monasterio 1-1, Hill 1-0. Umpires —Home, Vic Carapazza; First, Edwin Moscoso; Second, Hunter Wendelstedt; Third, Nic Lentz. T —2:46. A —45,256 (46,672).									

HOW THE RUNS SCORED												
FIFTH INNING												
YANKEES — Caballero singled to shortstop, Chisholm singled to center, Caballero to second. A.Sánchez sacrificed, third to first. Caballero to third, Chisholm to second. Goldschmidt singled to center, Caballero and Chisholm scored. Bellinger singled to center, Goldschmidt to second. Ramos homered to left, Goldschmidt and Bellinger scored. Garcia lined to center, Rosario singled to shortstop. Rosario was caught stealing, catcher to shortstop.												
SIXTH INNING												
YANKEES — Grisham filed to right, Caballero singled to center, Weissert pitching, Chisholm singled to center, Caballero to third, Chisholm advanced to second, Wells, hitting for A.Sánchez, hit sacrifice fly to center, Caballero scored. Goldschmidt struck out.												
SEVENTH INNING												
YANKEES — Bellinger fouled to third, Ramos walked. Jones running for Ramos. Garcia singled to center, Jones to third. Rosario singled to center, Jones scored, Garcia to second. Grisham struck out. Caballero filed to left.												
EIGHTH INNING												
RED SOX — Story doubled to right, Sogard singled to right, Story scored, Hill pitching. Anthony grounded into a double play, third to shortstop to first, Sogard out. Rafaela grounded to second.												
YANKEES — Chisholm walked. Chisholm stole second. Chisholm stole third. Wells homered to right, Chisholm scored. Goldschmidt homered to right, Bellinger filed to left. Jones singled to center, White in as second baseman. Team loses designated hitter. Monasterio pitching. Garcia walked, Jones to second. Rosario walked, Jones to third, Garcia to second. Grisham hit sacrifice fly to right, Jones scored. Caballero homered to left, Garcia and Rosario scored. Chisholm walked. Wells homered to right, Chisholm scored. Goldschmidt singled to right, Bellinger popped to third.												

stinks.”

Officials could not definitively determine that Rafaela prevented the ball from touching the ground prior to gaining complete control. In the absence of certainty, umpires stuck with the initial call, which is standard procedure.

The call was not confirmed, but it

Suarez comes up short in crucial game

►ON BASEBALL Continued from Page C1

the most likely path to the postseason has the Sox returning to Yankee Stadium on Sept. 29 for the best-of-three Wild Card Series. Every game would be in the Bronx — and it’s likely the Yankees will have Aaron Judge back in their lineup by then.

It didn’t have to be that way. But in a taut, scoreless game, Suarez allowed five runs on six hits in the fifth inning.

“Everything was going well. They took advantage of a few mistakes I made,” Suarez said via a translator. “That was it.”

Well, not really.

With José Caballero on first after a single on a hard-hit ball that got by Trevor Story, Jazz Chisholm Jr. sent a sinking line drive to center field. Ceddanne Rafaela chased the ball down and appeared to make his latest fantastic catch.

Umpire Edwin Moscoso ruled it a hit, a call that withstood a replay challenge. The Yankees then sacrificed the runners to second and third.

“Everybody was surprised by that call,” Suarez said. “That was a game-changing play.”

did stand. Had the original call been catch, it may also have stood.

“When you hear ‘call stands,’ not ‘call confirmed,’ that’s a pretty good indicator that they’re saying it’s very difficult to see anything on video for us to overturn the call in the field,” Tracy said. “We in the dugout feel like our center fielder caught the ball, but if they don’t have anything that they can definitively overturn, that’s usually where you end up. And obviously, it’s frustrating.”

With two on and none out, the Yankees (78-59) capitalized. Ali Sánchez’s sacrifice bunt moved both runners over. Paul Goldschmidt sneaked a weak ground ball up the middle — through a drawn-in infield — for a two-run single.

After Cody Bellinger singled, Heliot Ramos crushed a three-run homer to left field.

FM CHAMPIONSHIP NOTEBOOK

Khang happy for home game

By Cam Kerry
GLOBE STAFF

NORTON — **Megan Khang's** commute to work differed from the typical tournament.

Driving to TPC Boston from her residence in Braintree, the Rockland native made herself right at home back in Massachusetts, finishing tied for 27th at 3-under 285 in the FM Championship.

"It's probably my favorite event outside of the majors," said Khang, who enjoyed a sizable crowd all week and is an FM ambassador.

"Any time you get to stay in your own bed for a tournament week, it's a win in itself."

Entering the week No. 85 in the world rankings, Khang made just her 10th cut in 18 starts this season. She had missed out on the weekend in her four prior events and seven of the last eight.

Sure, there's a bit of pressure playing in front of family and friends, but Khang's familiarity with the course — and the region — took the 2015 Rockland High grad out of "tournament mode."

A bogey, double-bogey finish for a final-round 73 left a sour taste in her mouth for what was a successful week. She hit 48 of 56 fairways, consistently setting herself up for success off the tee.

"Yeah, I had a bad finish, but at the end of the day, I'm playing golf for a living, and FM is making it even more possible for me to live out my dream," said Khang. "It's sour for the moment, but it's not sour for too long."

Khang will look to build off her strong week when she represents the United States at the Solheim Cup in two weeks.

"There's a lot more that you're representing and I think it's super cool," she said. "I think it's an honor to wear the red, white, and blue."

Nordqvist wraps up

Moments after walking off the 18th green for the final time, **Anna Nordqvist** attempted to reflect on a pro career that began in 2009. She admitted that a proper reflection wouldn't hit her for several weeks.

The 39-year-old from Sweden announced her retirement earlier this week, with one of the reasons being the dream of starting a family. She won nine times on the LPGA Tour.



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Rockland's Megan Khang had a 73 at TPC Boston to finish the FM Championship tied for 27th, her best result since May.

"Just a lot of emotions. The tears are really close but it's obviously happy tears, too," she said.

Nordqvist will captain Europe at the Solheim Cup in the Netherlands after bidding adieu to her playing career.

"I'm not really sure how to feel," said Nordqvist. "Nothing ever prepares you for this moment. I'm definitely going to miss it. Part of me feels like it's not really — probably feels like it's — I still have so much more left in me."

Nordqvist carded a 72 Sunday to tie for 38th at 1 under. She was steady all day, posting 16 pars, a birdie, and a bogey.

"I think part of me just feels like I didn't want to count down the days because I just felt like I just want to keep playing."

Zhang back on track

Rose Zhang graduated from Stanford this year, a starlet on the collegiate scene by being the first player to win consecutive NCAA Division 1 individual titles. She played in the 2019 US Women's Open and joined the LPGA Tour in 2023, winning her professional debut.

The exceptional start to her career slowed as she juggled her studies and her profession. Since her initial victory, she has won just once more.

On Sunday, she shot a final-round 68, vaulting eight spots to a season-best tie for fourth at 10 under.

"This feels incredible. I feel like it's been a long time coming," said Zhang. "I've been working a lot on my game with my team, and just personally, I think it's a great confidence booster, especially heading into Solheim."

Zhang, who will represent the United States at the Solheim Cup, gained confidence from finishing inside the top 10 for the fourth time this season. She averaged 271 yards with her driver, well above her season average of 258.6.

"It's just nice to know that I can play under pressure," Zhang said. "I feel like it's been a while since I gave myself an opportunity to be in the last couple groups, and so to have people watching and to be playing well, especially on top of that, I think it all brings really good energy, especially into the next two weeks."

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Ruoning Yin took home \$660,000 and the trophy after her sixth LPGA win.

PGA TOUR CHAMPIONSHIP

Cup victory tastes good for Scheffler

World No. 1 races from behind to take the title

By Doug Ferguson
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ATLANTA — **Scottie Scheffler's** second FedEx Cup title and his 22nd victory on the PGA Tour during this astonishing five-year run was different from all the others, even if it looked all too familiar.

Scheffler celebrated with a beer. He had just closed with a 4-under par 66 Sunday in the Tour Championship — no one else from the leading six players broke par — and Scheffler had to wait for the last two groups to finish to make it official.

"There was an open bar inside and I'm like, 'All right, I'm grabbing a beer.' It tasted great," Scheffler said. "I don't really drink often. My wife and manager were like, 'Wow, I haven't seen you have a beer in a long time.' Well, season's over now. I'm going to have a beer. Well-earned beer."

There was no arguing that, and there's no longer a debate who had the best season in golf.

Scheffler took care of that at East Lake when he made up a three-shot deficit in four holes and pulled away to win the Tour Championship, claim a second FedEx Cup title, and move past Tiger Woods for most PGA Tour earnings.

Scheffler signaled his rally with a 5-iron to within 2 inches of the cup on the 211-yard second hole. He caught Viktor Hovland with a 25-foot birdie on the fourth, pulled ahead for the first time on the 13th, and wound up with a three-shot victory.

It was his first time with the low 72-hole score at the Tour Championship.

When he won in 2024, he had a two-shot lead before the tournament began given to the No. 1 seed under the "starting strokes" format. He won by four shots, even though two other players had a lower actual score. That still bugs him.

"I think having a real tournament to finish the year, where I am the winner and the lowest score at East Lake, feels like a bit more of an accomplishment," he said.

Scheffler won for the third time this year — twice in the last three weeks during the PGA Tour's postseason — to match Chris Gotterup, Matt Fitzpatrick, and US Open



KEVIN C. COX/GETTY IMAGES

The FedEx Cup trophy is again a member of **Scottie Scheffler's** family. The world No. 1 posed with wife, Meredith, and sons, Bennett and Remy, after his latest win.

champion Wyndham Clark for most titles in 2026.

Players vote on the Jack Nicklaus Award for PGA Tour player of the year. Scheffler has won the last four years; another would tie him with Woods for most consecutive awards.

Taking over the top spot in career earnings was inevitable. The \$40 million purse at the Tour Championship now counts as official money. Scheffler won \$10 million, pushing his career total to \$130,390,661. Woods, who never played for more than a \$10 million purse during his peak years from 1997 through 2009, had been at the top of the career money list for nearly 26 years.

It was a small slice of redemption for Scheffler, who lost in a playoff to Hovland at the Travelers Championship in Connecticut, one of his five runner-up finishes this year.

Hovland made only one birdie and closed

with a 72 to finish alone in second, worth \$5 million. Most aggravating for the Norwegian was having three putts hit the lip in a four-hole stretch on the back nine, two of them for birdie and one for par.

Scheffler had two bogeys — one an aggressive miss with a wedge from the fairway on No. 7, the other from a gnarly lie in the rough on the 14th — and otherwise felt he didn't miss much over a tough day of wind and firm turf that made the landing spots feel smaller.

Ryan Gerard, one shot behind Hovland starting out, made double bogey on the opening hole, followed with 13 straight pars and shot 72 to finish alone in third.

"They made it as difficult as they could today, and that's kind of what we were looking for," Gerard said. "I just wasn't on enough to execute shots to really tucked hole locations."

US OPEN

Sick, strained Djokovic goes out, perhaps for good, in shocker

ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — **Novak Djokovic** grinded through physical and internal ailments, made one mistake after another, and could not find what it took to beat a feisty, younger opponent who was not intimidated under the lights against tennis's most decorated player.

The 39-year-old is out of the US Open after a first-round defeat to Mariano Navone on Sunday night, losing 7-6 (5), 5-7, 4-6, 6-2, 6-1 in a five-set marathon that lasted four hours and 36 minutes. It was the longest

opening match of a Grand Slam in Djokovic's career and became his earliest exit in two decades, dating to the 2006 Australian Open. He had never lost in the first round at the US Open.

With this defeat, 21 years to the day of his debut at the event, the question lingers as to whether this was Djokovic's final match at this or any Grand Slam.

Djokovic made 70 unforced errors in a painful performance that ended shortly before midnight.

The record holder with 24 major titles threw up at least once and later appeared to be cramping when he grabbed at his left foot. Djokovic swallowed pills brought to him by a doctor and had his lower back massaged during a medical timeout between the fourth and fifth sets, and he grimaced after several shots.

Throughout his time on court, it was clear Djokovic was not himself, and the wear and tear of sickness and soreness took its toll. The No. 4 seed from Serbia cruised to early 3-0

and 4-1 leads before blowing them and losing the first set — the first time that happened to him in the first round of the US Open since '06.

With his wife, Jelena, watching from the stands with worried looks on her face, Djokovic had moments where he looked like one of the best to play the sport. His fist pump was reserved after winning the second set, and he put his hand to his ear and gestured to the crowd for applause on the way to taking the third.

But Navone — a 25-year-old

from Argentina who earlier this year won his first ATP singles title — did not go away. After firing a shot wide in the fourth set, Djokovic landed awkwardly and dropped his racket.

Djokovic all but conceded the fourth set, and was unable to muster enough for what would have been his 43rd five-set victory as Navone picked up his first.

On the first day of play, No. 3 seed Jessica Pegula beat Elena-Gabriela Ruse, 6-3, 6-2. Pegula leads the women's tour with 46

wins this season and can become No. 1 in the rankings if she wins her first major title and No. 2 Elena Rybakina loses before the semifinals.

No. 11-seeded Marta Kostyuk beat Storm Hunter, 6-4, 6-1, for a strong start to the year's final major after reaching the semifinals at the French Open and Wimbledon.

No. 27 seed Barbora Krejckova, a two-time Grand Slam singles champion, lost 7-6 (4), 6-2 to Kamilla Rakhimova.

Seven matches couldn't be completed because of rain.

Remembered

SHARE YOUR MEMORIES ON OUR GUEST BOOK AT [BOSTON.COM/OBITUARIES](https://boston.com/obituaries)

BY CITY AND TOWN

BELLINGHAM SCANZIO, Henry John	NORWOOD SCANZIO, Henry John
BOSTON STAHL, Dr. Matthew Sherin	ROYALSTON STAHL, Dr. Matthew Sherin
HAVERHILL LINGLEY, Patricia A.	WALPOLE SCANZIO, Henry John
METHUEN LINGLEY, Patricia A.	OUT OF STATE
NORTH ATTLEBOROUGH SCANZIO, Henry John	CALIFORNIA SCANZIO, Henry John

LINGLEY, Patricia A.



Patricia Ann Lingley, 79, was born on St. Patrick's Day March 17, 1947. A fitting beginning for a woman whose life brought so much warmth, love, and joy to those around her. Patricia passed away on August 25, 2026. She had an enormous heart and loved her family and friends deeply. She cherished the time she spent with the people she loved and will be remembered for her kindness, generosity, and the love she so freely gave.

Patricia enjoyed the simple pleasures in life. She loved shopping for a good deal, exploring flea markets, listening to country music, and especially anything Elvis Presley. These were the things that brought her happiness and gave her many wonderful memories throughout her life. Patricia leaves behind her beloved son, Christopher Lingley, and her cherished grandchildren, Mackenzie Sylvester, Victoria Sylvester, Krysta Lingley, and Alexiah Lingley.

She is also survived by her sisters, Eileen Palombo and Jean Mills, and her brother, Raymond Travers and his wife Shirley, as well as her nieces and nephews, Kathleen M. Daly, Anthony M. Palombo, Richard DiNublia, Susan Mills, Holly Yadisernia, and Raymond Travers Jr. Patricia's passing leaves a tremendous emptiness in the hearts of all who knew and loved her. Her beautiful heart, her love for her family and friends, and the memories she created will remain with them forever. She will be deeply missed, lovingly remembered, and forever cherished.

Visiting Hours: Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to attend Calling Hours on Thursday, September 3, 2026, from 9:00 AM to 11:00 AM, at Cataudella Funeral Home, 126 Pleasant Valley Street, METHUEN, MA. A Funeral Service will follow at the funeral home chapel at 11:00 AM. Burial will immediately follow to Mount Auburn Cemetery, 580 Mount Auburn Street, Cambridge, MA 02138.

SCANZIO, Henry John



Of Walpole, age 102, on Tuesday, August 25, 2026. Beloved husband of the late Agnes M. (Hayes) Scanzio. Loving father of Deborah A. Scanzio of Bellingham, Kenneth J. Scanzio and his wife Carol of North Attleborough, the late Henry J. Scanzio, Jr. and his surviving wife Carla of Camarillo, CA, and the late Robert Scanzio. Cherished grandfather of Andrea, Andrew, Deborah, Robert, Eric, Thomas, Michele, Carrie, and Kenneth; and great-grandfather to many loving great-grandchildren. Brother of the late John Scanzio. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to attend Henry's Visitation on Thursday, September 3, 2026, from 4:00 pm - 7:00 pm, in the James H. Delaney & Son Funeral Home, 48 Common Street, WALPOLE. A Mass of Christian Burial will be celebrated on Friday, September 4, 2026, at 10:00 am in Blessed Sacrament Church, 10 Diamond Street, Walpole. Interment will follow at Saint Francis Cemetery in Walpole. In lieu of flowers, memorial donations in Henry's name may be made to DAV Dept. of MA Service Fund, Inc., 3 Victory Lane, Gardner, MA 01440. For full obituary, please visit <https://www.delaneyfuneral.com/obituaries/henry-scanzio>

**James H. Delaney & Son
Funeral Home**
www.DelaneyFuneral.com

STAHL, Dr. Matthew Sherin



Dr. Matthew Sherin Stahl, 47, passed away, surrounded by his loved ones, on August 29, 2026, after a 7-year battle with cancer.

Matt was born and raised in Back Bay Boston, the son of Paula and the late Jeffrey Stahl. He attended The Park School, Concord Academy, Franklin & Marshall College and earned a doctorate from the Ferkauf Graduate School of Psychology at Yeshiva University.

Matt started his career in television in New York, eventually discovering his passion lay in clinical psychology. He went back to school, and began his 2nd career in family and adolescent therapy. It's what he was meant to do and he was damn good at it.

Matt married children's clothing designer Mahalia Siegel, in 2014, in her hometown of Salisbury, NC. It really was love at first sight. She was his partner and the center of his life. Matt and Mahalia had two wonderful boys, Jeffrey and Dorian, whom he doted on. He was so deeply proud to be their father and marveled at them as they grew. Matt and the family moved from Boston to Royalston, MA (population 1,200) in 2024, where their sons could have a childhood rooted in nature.

In addition to his wife and two children, Matt leaves behind his mother Dr. Paula Stahl; his sister Elizabeth Stahl, with whom he shared a close and enduring bond; his aunts, Patty Liebman and Lesley Stahl; and his uncle Peter Sherin. He is also survived by his beloved cousins, Joe Liebman, Ben Liebman, Andy Liebman, Taylor Latham, Amy Snyder, Laurie Sobler, David Sherin, and Michael Adams. We will remember and cherish our Matthew's beautiful heart, deep empathy, and wonderful, joyous laugh.

A Funeral Service will be held on Tuesday, September 1, at 12:00PM, at Temple Reyim, 1860 Washington St., NEWTON, MA 02466, followed by a Private Burial.

In lieu of flowers, the family asks that donations be made to Dr. John Koreth's stem cell transplant research at the Dana-Farber Cancer Institute: <https://bit.ly/DonationsToStemCellResearch>

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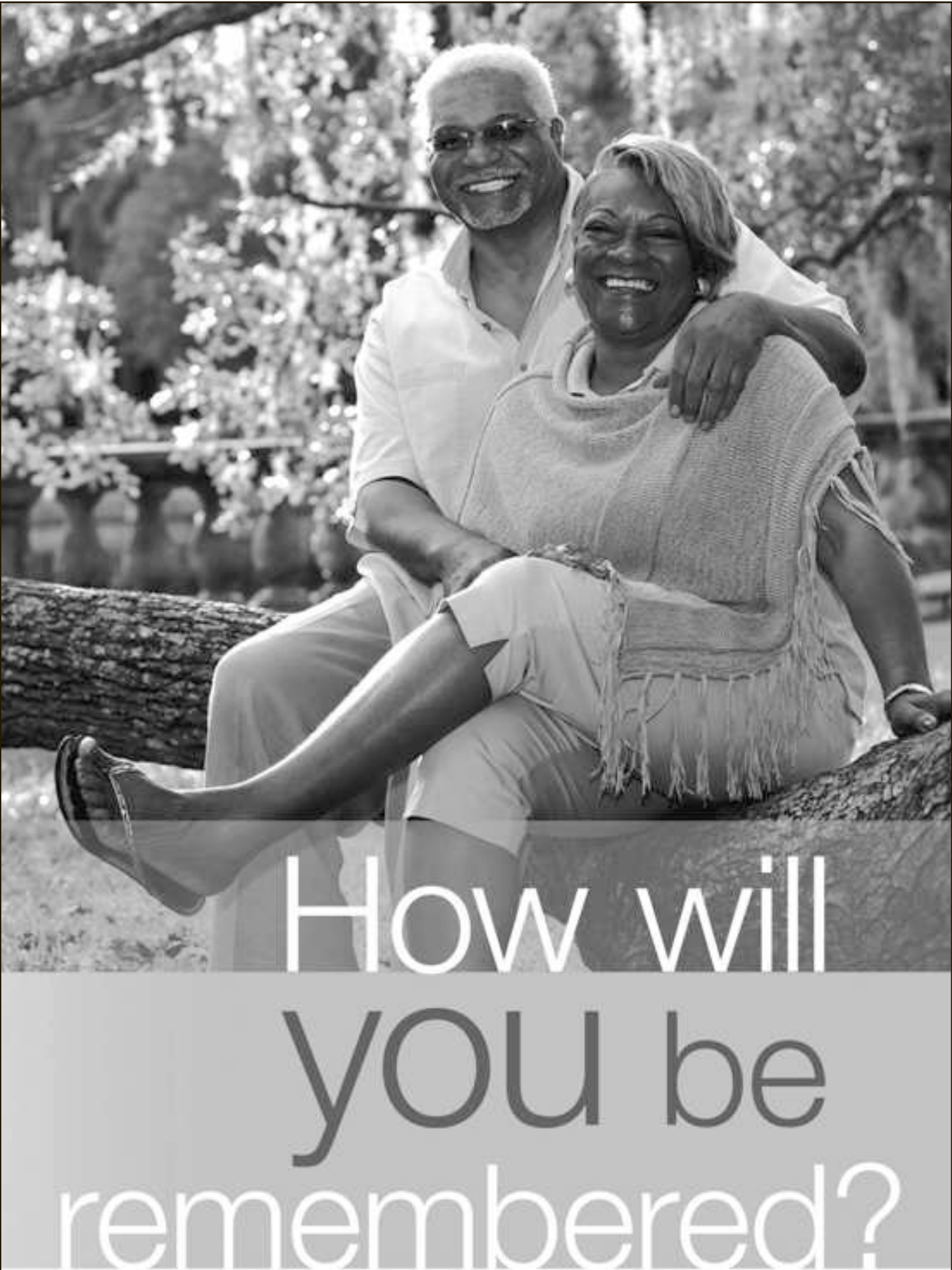
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Obituaries

Benjamin Alire Sáenz, 71, Latino novelist who captured the fluidity of borders

By Jeré Longman
NEW YORK TIMES

Benjamin Alire Sáenz, the first Latino novelist to win the PEN/Faulkner Award, and who examined — in poetry and prose — identity, belonging, and sexuality along the physical, psychic, and cultural border between the United States and Mexico, died July 28 in El Paso, Texas. He was 71.

The death, in a hospital, was of complications from a lung disorder, his sister, Gloria Woods, said.

Mr. Sáenz experienced the fluidity of borders in all aspects of his life: in his travels between El Paso and Ciudad Juárez, Mexico, its sister city across the Rio Grande; in the duality of the English and Spanish languages; in the themes he explored as a writer of children’s, young adult, and literary fiction; and in his complicated life as a one-time Catholic priest who, upon leaving the clergy, married and divorced, then publicly acknowledged at age 54 that he was gay.

Mr. Sáenz occupied “that liminal space; I would call it living in between,” his friend Daniel Chacón, the chair of the creative writing department at the University of Texas at El Paso, said in an interview.

Writing, Mr. Sáenz often said, provided him with healing salvation from the double trauma of sexual abuse as a boy and substance abuse as an adult. It also brought him clarity, direction, and hope during his journey toward self-discovery.

“I write all my books to save my life, I think,” he told Texas Monthly in 2013.

Born on a small farm in New Mexico, he lived most of his professional life roughly 50 miles to the south, in El Paso, where he completed his education and found his voice and a sense of acceptance.

In El Paso, he witnessed and

experienced the discrimination and racism directed at Mexican Americans, who make up more than 80 percent of the city’s population. It was also a community, he described in a 2023 TEDx talk, that was “too hardworking, too forgiving, and too generous to live in anger and rage.”

“I believe that a writer’s job is to bear witness, and I want to bear witness that the border is not just a [expletive] metaphor, that we are people,” he told Con Safos magazine in 2017.

Most of his two-dozen plus books took place along the US-Mexican border. The two most highly regarded were published in 2012: “Everything Begins and Ends at the Kentucky Club,” a story collection that won the 2013 PEN/Faulkner Award, and “Aristotle and Dante Discover the Secrets of the Universe,” which Time magazine in 2021 named one of the 100 best young adult novels ever written. A film version was released in 2022.

The Kentucky Club is a real-life, Prohibition-era bar in Juárez, a few blocks south of the border. Mr. Sáenz’s story collection illuminated the lives of marginalized people trapped in the pain of violence and the self-destructiveness of drugs, and those who were searching for grace amid their despair.

“We, on the border, want to live,” he told the Los Angeles Review of Books in 2013. “I write stories of survival. The teller has survived to tell the tale. I am one of those survivors.”

In one story, “The Hurting Game,” Michael, the narrator, discusses his inability to form an intimate bond with a friend, an anxiety that Mr. Sáenz said he himself experienced after being abused. “Some people knew how to love and some people didn’t,” Michael says. “Tom was the former. I was the latter. I didn’t know which one of us had it



MONICA ALMEIDA/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Mr. Sáenz in El Paso, Texas, in 2010. He was the first Latino novelist to win the Pen/Faulkner Award. His writing explored borders, physical, psychic, and cultural.

worse.”

In its first week of publication, “Aristotle and Dante” sold a disappointing 11 copies, Mr. Sáenz said in 2022 on the “Latino USA” public radio show.

Thanks to strong reviews and an audiobook narrated by “Hamilton” playwright and songwriter Lin-Manuel Miranda, sales of “Aristotle and Dante” eventually surged past 1 million copies. The book was translated into at least two dozen languages, becoming his best-known and most commercially successful work.

“Aristotle and Dante” unfurls with Ari realizing that he is in love with his friend, Dante, and eventually overcoming his fear of acknowledging his feelings, a catharsis that Mr. Sáenz said he, too, needed to experience in order to write both “Kentucky Club” and “Aristotle and Dante.”

In 1994, he married Patricia

Macias, a family court judge in El Paso. The marriage ended in divorce in 2008 during a turbulent and decisive period in which he entered treatment for drug and alcohol abuse, resolved while in therapy that he was gay, and stopped blaming himself for being sexually abused.

“We feel like we’re always a fraud,” Mr. Sáenz said of abuse victims, on “Latino USA.” His therapist guided him toward restoration, he said, in part by asking who wrote his books. He said he did, of course — to which his therapist responded reassuringly, “You’re not an impostor.”

Benjamin Alire Sáenz was born Aug. 16, 1954, in the agricultural community of Old Pícaro, New Mexico, and grew up on a farm in Mesilla, near Las Cruces, to Juan and Eloisa (Alire) Sáenz. The fourth of seven children, he said on “Latino USA” that the only thing he had

of his own was a toothbrush.

At the age of 5 or 6, he began experiencing sexual abuse from a family member. He never publicly identified the perpetrator and did not comment on how long the abuse continued.

The violence, he said in the TEDx talk, left him “afraid and confused” and searching for “a world that was kinder” than the one he knew. It led him to discover that better world in books. He said he would subsequently lie in the cotton fields outside his home, seeing the shapes of elephants and palm trees in the clouds, and concocting stories in his mind.

He grew up in a Catholic family, and his first calling was the priesthood. He received a bachelor’s degree in 1977 from St. Thomas Seminary in Denver, studied theology at the University of Louvain in Belgium and was ordained in 1981.

He left the clergy after three years, explaining in interviews years later that he found it lacking in what he hoped would be its mission of championing social justice and the poor. He also sensed both his sexual awakening and a desire to become a writer, and cited his inability to remain a spokesperson for a Catholic Church amid sexual-abuse scandals.

“Too painful,” he told El Paso Inc. magazine in 2021.

He entered the University of Texas El Paso, received a master’s degree in creative writing in 1987, then wrote his first book of poetry, “Calendar of Dust,” while on a fellowship at Stanford University. It won an American Book Award in 1992. But El Paso beckoned and, against the advice of his Stanford colleagues, he returned to the border city.

“I have never felt truly American, but I have always felt home in El Paso,” Mr. Sáenz said in his TEDx talk.

In addition to his sister, he leaves two brothers, Ricardo and Joe Sáenz.

In 2010, Poets & Writers, a nonprofit literary organization, named Mr. Sáenz one of the world’s 50 most inspiring authors. In 2021, he published “Aristotle and Dante Dive Into the Waters of the World,” a best-selling sequel to his original book and that addressed the AIDS epidemic.

Mr. Sáenz completed a final novel before his death, “When the World Was Happy,” which is scheduled to publish in September and is loosely based on the death in 1990 of his 13-year-old niece, Amy Hauser, during a mass shooting at a bowling alley in Las Cruces.

“Our roots of love are deep. Our pain is deep,” Woods, the sister of Mr. Sáenz and mother of Hauser, said of the family in a text message. “Our love for one another is deeper than our pain.”

Laura Spector, who turned vines into art, 71

By Penelope Green
NEW YORK TIMES

Laura Spector, an artist who coaxed bittersweet vines into alluring and whimsical furniture, lighting, and objects, including crowns fit for a druid, before Lyme disease curtailed her practice, died Tuesday at her home in Fairfield, Conn. She was 71.

Her husband, Mark, announced her death but did not provide a cause.

Asian bittersweet is a much-loathed invasive species that was brought to the United States from Japan as an ornamental plant in the 19th century. It has run riot along the Eastern Seaboard, choking everything it can wrap its lethal tendrils around.

The vine, which can kill a tree in as little as three years, is an obnoxious menace and a scourge to gardeners and arborists. To Ms. Spector, it was an irresistible medium.

Throughout the nature preserves, forests, and backyards of Connecticut, she hurled her tiny dancer’s frame into the tangled brush, harvesting her chosen crop with a pole saw. A local land trust and the water company gave her permission to hack through their woods. They were happy, she told The New York Times in 2008, to have her pruning services, as long as she indemnified them in case of injury. (As it happened, she never fell, and the only limbs she severed were the creepers.)

Once the vines were harvested, she piled them into her truck, unloading them on her driveway, where they would remain until inspiration struck. The whorls and snarls dictated the kinds of objects she might create.

She would use her entire body to bend the material into rustic benches, arches, beds, tables, and mirrors, anchoring the pieces with a nail gun. (She shot herself only a few times, in the hand.)

Her work recalls the romantic rustic furniture of 18th-century English gardens — benches, nooks, and arches that look as if



THOMAS MCDONALD/NEW YORK TIMES/FILE

Ms. Spector had a talent for taking much-loathed invasive vines and turning them into whimsical furniture.

they sprouted from the landscape or were made by fairies — but when Ms. Spector began, she was self-taught and worked intuitively.

“She had the stamina to get right in there and wrestle the vines,” Daniel Mack, an author and rustic furniture artist whose workshops Ms. Spector attended, said in an interview. “She had a kind of bravery that was a model for the rest of us. It was almost like theater.”

The practice of making rustic furniture “attracts outliers and misbehavers,” Mack added. “It’s not logical stuff. It’s fantasy furniture, props for different storylines.”

Ms. Spector had trained as a dancer and worked in the music business and as a marketing consultant before she began her art practice, which she described as “a conversation between a person and nature” in an interview with The Westport News in 1999.

She made pieces for designers and musicians such as Joan Baez and Sting and created installations for botanical gardens, hotels, and department stores, including Macy’s. For a client in Pound Ridge, N.Y., she created a 30-foot winding staircase.

Laura Fay Reitman was born July 28, 1954, in New Hyde Park, N.Y., on Long Island, the middle of three sisters. Her mother, Georgeette (Lieberman) Reitman, was a Holocaust survi-

vor who arrived in the United States speaking only French; she became a nurse and then, after earning a degree, a professor of comparative literature at Hofstra University in Nassau County. Her father, Morton Reitman, was a textile executive.

Laura grew up in Merrick, also on Long Island, and studied dance at Bennington College in Vermont and New York University.

She met Mark Spector in the mid-1980s, when both were working in the music industry. He manages artists such as Baez, Suzanne Vega, and Graham Nash; she worked in marketing and video. They married in 1987.

In addition to her husband and mother, Ms. Spector leaves their son, Nicholas, and daughter, Jordan Spector Buchla; a grandchild; and her sisters, Lisa Reitman Dobi and Judith Texier.

The choicest vines, Ms. Spector said of her medium, were those that grew deep in the forest. She made sure to stand on the toughest, largest vines while wielding her pole saw overhead. With her dancer’s sense of balance, she never wiped out. Poison ivy was an issue, however, and twice she climbed into a beehive by mistake.

“I had to strip naked out there because they were stuck in my clothes,” she told the Times in 2008, referring to the bees. “You can’t imagine the pain.”

Her real adversaries, though, were ticks. Ms. Spector contracted Lyme disease two decades ago and suffered frequent, powerful recurrences that sapped her strength.

Eventually, she gave up her furniture practice and began making Photoshop collages, 8-inch-by-10-inch pieces in what she described as her Identity Series, featuring characters that she called Laura dolls, stylized stand-ins for her that looked like paper dolls with a distinctive mop of red hair. She deployed them in different settings — armed with, variously, a snowblower, a chain saw, an umbrella, a pickleball paddle, or a vacuum cleaner. In one piece, she floated a Laura doll above a highway at night; in another, Laura dolls hung in the air like Rene Magritte’s bowler-hatted men.

“My reliance on imagination to construct identity was very much tied to my collaboration with nature,” she wrote in an artist’s statement on her website. “If an individual is informed by purpose and occupation, then I had retreated to a place of uncertainty and disenfranchised grief.”

The Laura dolls were a way to experience the world through play, she said, and “also a reminder that we are all in some way addressing universal feelings of isolation as we search for connection.”

Benjamin M. Rosen, at 93; analyst, venture capitalist

By Clay Risen
NEW YORK TIMES

Benjamin M. Rosen, a Wall Street analyst and venture capitalist whose early efforts to rally investors behind companies including Apple, Lotus, and Compaq — where he served as chair for almost 20 years — made the revolutionary promises of personal computing a reality, died Aug. 23 in New York City. He was 93.

His wife, Donna Perret Rosen, confirmed the death, at a nursing facility.

There are many gods in the pantheon of the personal computer: Bill Gates for software, Andy Grove for processors, and Steve Jobs for design. Mr. Rosen is often mentioned, too, for marshaling the financial resources necessary to help the industry take off.

Decades before the term “venture capital” became inextricably tied to the tech world, Mr. Rosen was among the first in the field to connect its deep pools of private money with risky but promising startups such as Apple.

He met Jobs, Apple’s co-founder, in 1977, soon after the release of the Apple II. Mr. Rosen, then an analyst at the financial services company Morgan Stanley, became an early and eager apostle for Apple — and for personal computers in general — at a time when Wall Street was steeped in analog conservatism.

“I used to take my Apple II on visits to clients, trying to demonstrate that this playful-looking product had a potential far greater than its then perception as a toy for hobbyists and gamers,” he wrote on his blog in 2011.

After much effort — including a demonstration of an early spreadsheet program that caused jaws to drop in the Morgan Stanley boardroom — he persuaded the company’s partners to underwrite Apple’s initial public offering in 1980.

By then, he was already making his exit from Morgan Stanley, where he had started a successful tech-industry newsletter and conference division.

In 1981, Mr. Rosen joined an engineer in Texas named L.J. Sevin to form Sevin Rosen, one

of the first tech-centric venture capital firms. After an unsuccessful run at building a semiconductor company, they threw their weight behind Compaq, a Texas startup intent on creating lightweight, inexpensive computers that could run the same operating system as the bulkier, pricier IBM models. Mr. Rosen became chair of the company.

Compaq’s earliest “portable” computers weighed nearly 30 pounds and cost the equivalent of about \$12,000 in today’s dollars, but they were revolutionary. Within a few years, the company was struggling to keep up with demand.

By its 10th anniversary, it was the world’s leading PC maker, outpacing even IBM.

Sevin Rosen provided initial funding for dozens of other tech companies in the early 1980s, including Lotus, the developer of Lotus 1-2-3, a spreadsheet program and the first easy-to-use application for the IBM operating system.

As chair of Compaq, Mr. Rosen never involved himself in the daily workings of the company, but there was no doubt about who was in charge. He twice ousted the CEO, in 1991 and 1999, to make way for someone who better fit his vision for the company and the industry.

For four months, he served as interim CEO. After taking the post, he announced a new direction for the computer maker, anticipating how much the internet was changing the tech industry.

“In 1991, we were just a PC company,” he told The New York Times in 1999. “Now we’re a broad information technology company.”

Benjamin Maurice Rosen was born March 11, 1933, in New Orleans, one of three children of Jewish immigrants who met in Canada before moving to the United States: His father, Isadore, a dentist, came from Germany, and his mother, Anna (Leibof) Rosen, came from Latvia.

His first marriage, to Alexandra Ebere, ended in divorce. He married Donna Perret in 2002. In addition to her, he leaves two sons from his first marriage, Jeffrey and Eric; a stepdaughter, Melanie Perret; and six grandchildren.

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Healey’s job should be in reach for the GOP. Why isn’t it?

If there ever was a moment for a Republican businessman to catch fire in Massachusetts politics, it should be now.

Nearly two-thirds of voters think the state economy is in fair or poor shape, according to a recent UMass Amherst/WCVB Poll, and 45 percent say the state is on the wrong track.

Yet in that same poll, voters gave Governor Maura Healey a 56 percent job approval rating — among the highest of our elected officials. And in a general election against the Republican candidate — be it Mike Minogue or Brian Shortsleeve — Healey would trounce either by about 20 points.

“In theory, the economic environment would be right for voters to consider a Republican to run the state,” said Will Keyser, a veteran political operative and Healey supporter who crafted Republican Charlie Baker’s successful gubernatorial campaigns in 2014 and in 2018. “These are not normal times.”

Why not? Well, President Trump, of course.

Any Republican will have a tough time gaining traction in Massachusetts right now because the Trump administration seems intent on knocking the state down a notch: targeting Harvard, gutting federal research grants, deporting international students.

All that is hurting our economy, and turning off the unenrolled, independent voters who have typically powered Republicans to victory in statewide elections in the past — and who today, according to The Scrum’s Kelly Garrity, represent a record high two-thirds of registered voters.

And unlike successful predecessors such as Baker and Mitt Romney, both Minogue and Shortsleeve did in fact vote for Trump in 2024. Now, as Republican candidates, they can’t afford to distance themselves too much from the president, lest they alienate his many supporters in the state’s GOP.

Throw in the usual challenge of unseating an incumbent, and it’s a tough road for either of them to reach the governor’s office.

Minogue, of course, sees it differently. His campaign is confident about Tuesday’s primary, and says that Republicans and others who’ve been un-

LEUNG, Page D3



Zachary Bos (bottom left) is opening two bookstores this fall in Fitchburg. Bonfire Bookshop, shown here, will sell used books.

PHOTOS BY PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Betting on books

Entrepreneur hopes bookstore can help spark a turnaround in downtown Fitchburg

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

FITCHBURG — As bulldozers screeched and clanked away in this city’s downtown one recent afternoon, Zachary Bos unpacked used books inside his soon-to-open shop off Main Street and placed them on shelves.

Nearby storefronts were vacant, tucked behind construction tape and traffic cones, but his store was lively, with one staffer hanging decor and another placing books into a rainbow-patterned arch over a window.

Bos’s two upcoming stores — Bonfire Bookshop, which will sell used books, and Goldfinch Mercantile, which will sell new books — are slated to become Fitchburg’s first independent bookstores since the last one shuttered

over a decade ago. The old mill city has long battled a shaky economy and business closures. Now, city officials say, it is undergoing its largest makeover yet in the hopes of becoming a destination.

Bos, a former higher education administrator who moved to Fitchburg from Boston six years ago to kick off his bookselling career, is determined to make the shop a cornerstone of the city’s revival through meeting with city officials, collaborating with neighboring businesses, and establishing a community-oriented space.

“We represent a new chapter in Fitchburg’s downtown — a destination for arts and culture, experiences and dining,” he said. “If [the bookshop] succeeds, it’s because Fitchburg succeeds.”

Fitchburg, the state, and private companies have poured millions of dollars in grants and investments into a slew of projects aimed at revitalization. They range from massive stormwater system upgrades, to replacing two major bridges and downtown sidewalk and pavement repairs.

The local public library is undergoing a \$40 million renovation and expansion project. Last year, the city completed a \$45 million project transforming a former school into affordable housing aimed at artists. The city also introduced a mandatory public registry of vacant properties, along with fees, to prod property owners to find tenants or bring in developers.

“If someone passes through our downtown

FITCHBURG, Page D2

‘Honk if you hate ChatGPT’: Why more locals are protesting AI



COURTESY OF QUITGPT

Protesters rallied outside the office of US Representative Lori Trahan in Lowell on Aug. 20. The protesters said Trahan’s AI legislation doesn’t go far enough to rein in the technology.

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

It was just a small protest outside US Representative Lori Trahan’s Lowell office recently, with about two-dozen people holding signs calling for more regulation of AI companies and opposing data centers.

“Honk if you hate ChatGPT,” “More tech oversight not less,” and “Data centers out of Lowell,” were some of the hand-drawn messages for Trahan, who is crafting legislation to regulate AI companies’ models at the national level. The protesters argued Trahan’s bill doesn’t go far enough and would wipe out stronger protections that states like Massachusetts may enact.

While Attorney General Andrea Campbell and other state AGs on Wednesday won a settlement from Meta restricting use of the company’s apps by young people, growing unease with Big Tech and artificial intelligence is proving to be a very broad concern and one of the few political issues cutting across party lines. Against that backdrop, the demonstration at Trahan’s office looks like the tip of a growing political iceberg.

Trahan has said her bill imposes transparency, safety, and audit requirements to prevent compa-

nies from unleashing untested, dangerous AI software on the public. “This is the first serious bipartisan attempt to put real guardrails on frontier AI,” Trahan told the Globe earlier this summer. “States keep their authority to protect their own residents from AI harms at the deployment and the use stage. Nothing in this bill stops that.”

But the protesters argued that Trahan’s bill leaves too much responsibility with the companies and blocks states from imposing their own AI testing and safety laws. They favor state bills, like one under consideration in the Massachusetts legislature, with more comprehensive standards.

“The big problem is she’s basically preempting the main structure that we have to protect people from dangerous AI,” protester and Tufts junior Grant Pinsley said. Different states should “experiment with a relatively new technology,” Pinsley added, in order to “build regulations that will protect the people of Massachusetts.”

As OpenAI and Anthropic have been lobbying local lawmakers behind the scenes over the summer, the Aug. 20 demonstration showed that a grass-roots movement is emerging to push back against the California AI giants.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, Page D2

INNOVATION BEAT

TALKING POINTS

GEOGRAPHY

GOOGLE MAPS CHANGES LAKE ONTARIO TO LAKE AMERICA

Google has updated its maps application, labeling Lake Ontario as Lake America for users in the United States, following an executive order signed by President Trump last week amid an escalating trade war with Canada. The decision of the tech giant reflects what it did when Trump renamed the Gulf of Mexico as the Gulf of America last year. The change has started to be rolled out, Google said in a blog post, adding that it was following its practice of using the name given by the US Geographic Names Information System. “People using Maps in the US will see ‘Lake America,’ those in Canada will continue to see ‘Lake Ontario,’ and those outside of the US and Canada will see both names,” Google said in its statement. Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney walked away from fraught US trade talks on Aug. 21, over what he called a “bad deal” that would harm Canada’s economy and sovereignty. He has since responded to the renaming of the lake with a statement about its history, noting that Ontario is a historical Indigenous name for the lake that pre-dates the creation of Canada and the United States.

— NEW YORK TIMES

ENERGY

TRUMP SAYS VENEZUELAN OIL WILL REFILL US STOCKPILES, BUT IT’S NOT SO SIMPLE

In a social media post Sunday, President Trump said he would use the oil from his deal in Venezuela to refill the United States’ stockpile of oil, but that’s something of a pipe dream. The agreement covers some 65 billion barrels of reserves in the oil-rich country, and amounts to a highly unusual foray involving a partnership with a private company. But many of its details remain unknown, and that’s just one complication for a process that Trump said would “begin very shortly.” For one, the world is short on oil because of the war with Iran, and the United States has been withdrawing oil from its inventory for months to keep prices from rising even higher. That stockpile, called the Strategic Petroleum Reserve, now sits at its lowest level since 1982. New projects can take years to get off the ground and produce meaningful amounts of oil. And any decision to buy oil for the Strategic Petroleum Reserve would require approval, including from Congress, which would have to authorize the spending.

— NEW YORK TIMES

JOBS

US JOBS REPORT SEEN BACKING WARSH VIEW OF LABOR MARKET

US payrolls growth got back on track in August, consistent with general steadiness in the labor market that’s helping the Federal Reserve focus more intently on its battle with inflation. Economists estimate the monthly jobs report from the Bureau of Labor Statistics on Friday will show a 55,000 increase in payrolls after an unexpected dip in July employment. Such a result would be broadly in line with average job growth this year. The unemployment rate is seen holding at 4.1 percent. Steady labor demand combined with limited layoffs are “consistent with full employment,” Fed Chair Kevin Warsh said Friday. The stable job market has fueled consumer spending and allowed the broader economy to forge ahead. With employment growth continuing, Fed officials are zeroing in on price stability. Inflation has been holding well above the Fed’s 2 percent goal for years. The jobs report will cap a busy week, including the BLS’s July job openings and labor turnover survey on Tuesday.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

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Grass-roots effort to rein in AI, data centers growing

►ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE *Continued from Page D1*

The multi-faceted movement is building on mounting public distrust of big tech companies, AI tech, and data center construction. Surveys show a growing number of Americans are concerned about AI harming relationships, creative thinking, and the job market. And more than 70 percent oppose construction of a nearby data center, according to Gallup.

Groups that helped organize the Lowell protest included mostly left-of-center efforts such as QuitGPT, College Democrats of Massachusetts, and the Young People’s Alliance Massachusetts. But tech opposition spans the political spectrum, with Republicans running for statewide offices in Texas, Florida, and Michigan expressing concerns about data centers and AI.

Pinsley, a political science major, organizes for the Gen Z-oriented group Voters of Tomorrow, which is also supporting bills to expand youth voting rights, encourage clean energy, and create more housing. On AI, Pinsley said he was concerned

the software is eroding employment opportunities for young people and harming their ability to think critically.

“I try to use it as little as possible,” he said. “I tend to believe that it’s detrimental to my education.”

Michael Baick, one of the founders of QuitGPT, said he’s worried about massive job losses, concentration of economic power, and the Orwellian surveillance capabilities of AI.

“Imagine if Nixon didn’t need some weird henchman to break into the Watergate,” Baick, a Harvard grad who grew up in Longmeadow, said. “He just needs to tell an instance of ChatGPT to slice its way into someone’s hard drive.”

Wednesday’s Meta settlement shows that big tech companies are willing to compromise (and offer large amounts of money) to assuage their opponents. But it may not be enough to cool the anger rising in Massachusetts and across the country.

Aaron Pressman can be reached at aaron.pressman@globe.com. Follow him @ampressman.

Entrepreneur seeks to create ‘book culture business’

►FITCHBURG *Continued from Page D1*

today, they go, ‘Oh my goodness,’” said Mary Jo Bohart, Fitchburg’s economic development director. “It’s a mess, but I think of every single one of those projects as a form of investment.”

Still, the city of roughly 40,000 has hovered around an unemployment rate of 6 percent, two points higher than the state average. Median household income is about \$73,000. A pub that closed this summer after eight years cited “more than a few challenges” of running a restaurant in Fitchburg.

But Bos, 44, is adamant that such challenges won’t derail Bonfire, slated to officially open this fall.

The former departmental administrator and staff union president at Boston University spent years traveling to more than 100 estate sales, academic scholars, and libraries to construct his collection of roughly 60,000 used books.

He first started a website, and then experimented with a pop-up in 2021 and 2022. The positive community reaction prompted him, with the financial support of investors and relatives, to permanently move the bookshop into an 1800s commercial building just off Main Street.

As with many independent bookstores tapping into the local business renaissance, Bonfire seeks to be more than a store. While the first floor offers a selection of used books categorized by genre, the building’s second floor houses Jade Vine Rare Books, where customers can view ancient pieces of literature by appointment. It also functions as an office space for Bos’s nonprofit publishing company, Pen and Anvil Press. Bonfire will host community events and poetry reading nights in collaboration with nearby Christ Church.

“It’s not a bookstore; it’s a book place,” Bos said. “I describe it as a book culture business.”

He is simultaneously working to open Goldfinch Mercantile, a more traditional bookstore on Main Street that will sell new books, stationery items, and locally made merchandise.

While an outsider to Fitchburg, Bos has made himself a fixture in the business community. Drawing inspiration from Boston’s Downtown Business Association and similar business



PHOTOS BY PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Assistant bookseller Aly Suzzi (above) arranged a window arch of unsellable books, while Mike Amadeo browsed the shelves at Bonfire Books.



groups, Bos is now forming Main Street Fitchburg, a nonprofit that will pool funds for joint marketing and physical improvements downtown.

Bos said the organization will also attempt to defuse tensions between renters and property owners on Main Street and reduce high turnover and churn. The idea, he said, is to reinforce the notion of a shared goal.

“Zach has been very active with local businesses,” Fitchburg City Councilor Andrew Van Hazinga said. “If you have determined people who are willing to put in the time, effort, money, and the collaborations to work with others to get it done, it can be a very healthy downtown.”

According to bookstore owners and industry experts, an independent bookstore could be vital in Fitchburg’s reinvention. The last bookstore on Main Street shuttered in 2012, after only four years in business.

And yet, bookstores have found vitality post-COVID, despite the rise of online booksellers including Amazon. Many bookshops now offer community events, gift shopping, and what Harvard Business School profes-

sor Ryan Raffaelli described as a “third space” — a location where people can gather besides their homes or workplaces.

“A bookstore helps create social capital,” Raffaelli said. “It al-

so sits at the core fabric of most cities or communities, so it’s hard to imagine not having one.”

Raffaelli, who wrote a white paper in 2020 on independent bookstores, labeled them as “an-

chor tenants” that are unique to a community and whose presence helps neighboring businesses to thrive.

Liz Whitelam, president of the New England Independent

Bookstore Association, echoed that sentiment, adding that a bookstore signals a town is worth investing in.

“[A bookstore] would draw both new commercial ventures to town and new residents,” she said.

Many bookstores operate on extremely thin margins, but Bos said his diversification of revenue from his publishing company and selling both used and new books will allow the business to stay afloat. Bos emphasized he intends to invest in the community and his workers, paying them “livable wages” and offering them a stake in the company.

Recently, Bos discovered he had unwittingly sold some of his books to AI companies, which had used numbers instead of names and fulfillment centers as addresses. AI companies this year ramped up efforts to purchase, scan, and destroy millions of books to train their models while evading copyright laws.

“It does feed the beast of the AI bubble, and it does nurture a technology that I think is fundamentally inhumane and odious. But it’s not a threat to books themselves,” Bos said.

In his view, the bookshop never competed with Amazon or AI companies in the first place.

“We’re competing with staying home,” he said. “People want to come down. They want to go on a safari. They want to go hunt and peck and go through all of these disordered shelves and see what they can find. Find a treasure that’s a treasure just in their eyes.”

In recent weeks, Bos invited residents to come by Bonfire for a soft launch. The musky smell of used books and fresh coats of paint clashed with the pungent scent of construction outside. A handful of visitors popped in. Bos knew everyone by name.

One was 69-year-old Fitchburg resident Mike Amadeo, who perused the semistocked shelves for a Stephen King book for his daughter.

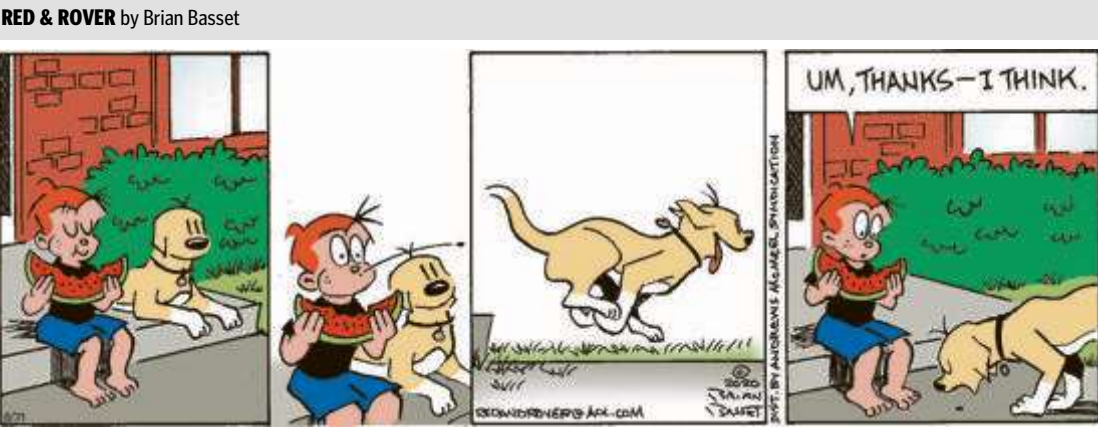
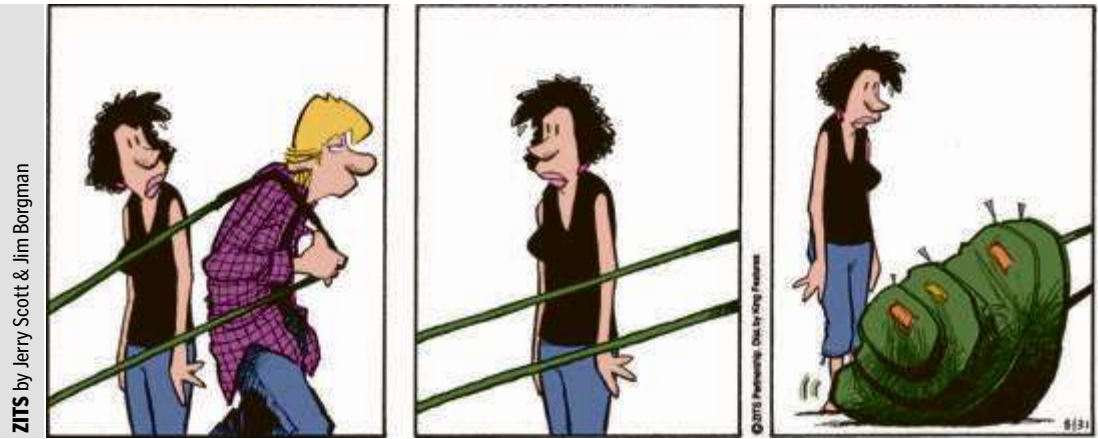
“We’re happy to see everything [Bos] is doing here,” he said. “There’s nothing like it around here.”

On his way out, Amadeo stopped to say goodbye to Bos.

“This is great,” he said.

“Right?” Bos responded. “It’s beginning to look like a bookstore.”

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UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

ISLAND HOPPING BY JOE MARQUEZ | EDITED BY TARUN KRISHNAMURTHY

ACROSS

1 "No more for me!"

6 Play group?

10 Drive—

14 "Neon" fish

15 Seized auto

16 Spoil

17 Desserts with streusel toppings (Caribbean Sea, starts hopping to the right at square 1)

19 Preschool lesson

20 Brooding animal

21 Online gamer's annoyance

22 Eggy breakfast dish

24 Attraction with a statue of the god Oceanus (Atlantic Ocean, square 5)

28 Center of power

30 Body with a tail it can't wag

31 Furry friend

32 Bahraini, e.g.

33 Desert haven

35 Font flourish

37 Four-term pres.

38 Doesn't get gold

42 "Bam!"

44 Bowling reservation

45 Anti-smoking ad, maybe

48 Maguire who portrayed Peter Parker

50 Olivia of "The Invite"

51 Quasi-judicial reviewers of governmental decisions (Tyrrhenian Sea, square 4)

54 Like many Sherpas

DOWN

1 Something to scratch

2 "A ___ coincidence!"

3 Vehicle used in some chase scenes

4 "Uhh ..."

5 Postpones discussing

6 Like some heroes in Greek mythology

7 Apt rhyme for "shriek"

8 Copy

9 Muslim places of worship

10 Genetic characteristic

11 Wheel cover

12 Singer Lionel

13 Like emails in your Drafts folder

18 Ohio NBAer

23 Up to

25 Puzzle cube creator

26 What-eats-what network

27 Michael's role on "The Wire"

28 ___ Vegas

29 Metallic rock

34 Favor, in slang

36 Like a major flaw

37 Modern car openers

39 Mexican restaurant array

40 Wrap up

41 "Make sense?"

43 Prelaw major, for short

45 "You Pick Two" bakery-cafe chain

46 Gushed

47 Tack on

49 "I'll allow it"

50 Severely damages

52 Makes simpler

53 Letters between names

57 Sci-fi series named for a desert mound

58 Like firm cheeses

61 Trucker's weight unit

62 Peculiar

63 Chuckle sound

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 8-31-26

CLUE

1. Breathe in

5. Legitimate

6. ___ place

7. Czech capital

ANSWER

NHIALE

DAVLI

IHDTR

UEGRPA

CLUE

1. Ask to attend

2. Sheath

3. Accommodation

4. Miniature ___

ANSWER

ETNIIV

HSRELTO

LNOIGDG

PDOELO

CLUE: The ___ is the largest tributary of the Mississippi River by volume.

BONUS

How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

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Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

Boston's forecast

TODAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 73-78
LOW 64-69

Sunny to partly cloudy and not as warm but pleasant. Winds E 7-14 mph. Becoming cloudy tonight with a couple of showers late. Winds SSE 7-14 mph.

TUESDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 70-75
LOW 62-67

Mostly cloudy and humid with a couple of showers and a thunderstorm. Winds E 8-16 mph. Mostly cloudy at night. Winds E 7-14 mph.

WEDNESDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 70-75
LOW 65-70

Cloudy with occasional rain and a thunderstorm. Winds E 7-14 mph. A thunderstorm around Wednesday evening; otherwise, cloudy. Winds S 4-8 mph.

THURSDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 72-77
LOW 61-66

Rather cloudy and humid with a couple of thunderstorms. Winds ESE 6-12 mph. Mainly clear at night. Winds NNW 6-12 mph.

FRIDAY

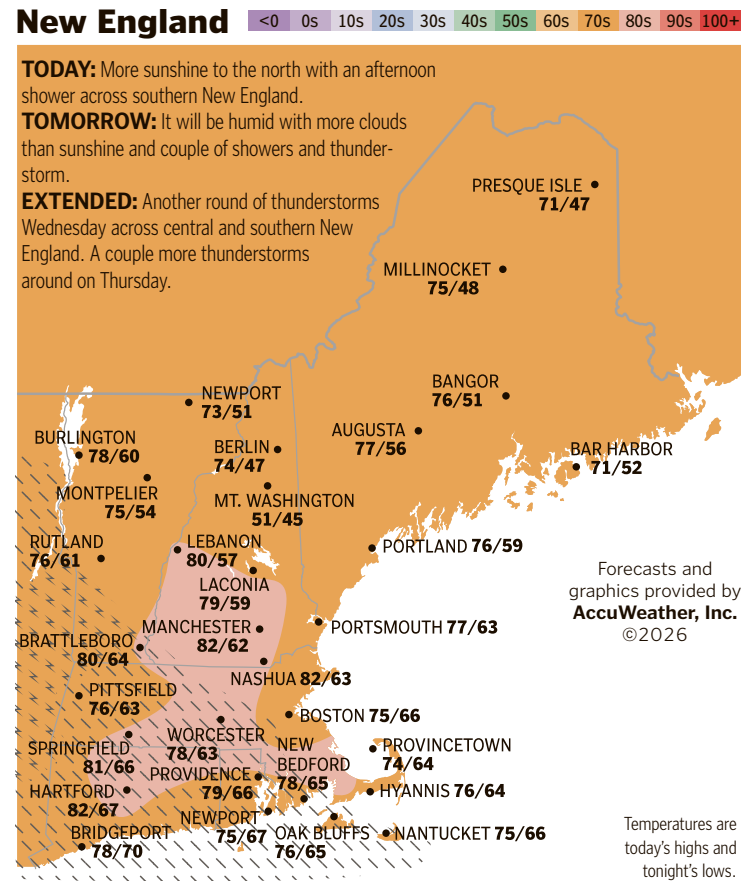
6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 70-75
LOW 59-64

Mainly cloudy with occasional rain. Winds NNE 8-16 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds N 6-12 mph.

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Almanac

Yesterday's high/low 86°/65°

Sunrise today 6:08 a.m.

Sunset today 7:20 p.m.

Moonrise today 8:40 p.m.

Mount Washington (5 p.m. yesterday)

Weather Rain showers

Visibility 0 miles

Wind west at 58 m.p.h.

High/low temperature 47/42

Snow depth at 5 p.m. 0.0"

24 Hr. Precipitation (valid at 5 p.m. yesterday)

Yesterday 0.00" Month to date 0.98" Year to date 17.59"

Precip days in August 9 Norm. month to date 3.13" Norm. year to date 27.94"

Climate data are compiled from National Weather Service records and are subject to change or correction.

Tides

A.M. P.M.

Boston high 1:45 2:05

Height 10.2 10.4

Boston low 7:55 8:20

Height 0.1 0.0

High tides

Old Orchard ME 1:31 1:50

Hampton Beach NH 1:45 2:04

Plum Island 2:00 2:21

Ipswich 1:31 1:52

High tides

A.M. P.M.

Gloucester 1:41 2:00

Marblehead 1:45 2:05

Lynn 1:44 2:03

Scituate 1:46 2:05

Plymouth 1:56 2:16

Cape Cod Canal East 1:34 1:54

Cape Cod Canal West 12:32

Falmouth 1:29 1:49

New England marine forecast

Wind Seas Temp

Boston Harbor E 5-10 kts. 1 ft. 75/66

East Cape NE 5-10 kts. 1 ft. 75/66

Cod Canal SE 5-10 kts. 1 ft. 76/66

Small craft advisory

Gale warning Storm warning

Wind Seas Temp

Martha's Vineyard SE 5-10 kts. 1 ft. 76/62

Nantucket NE 8-16 kts. 1-2 ft. 74/63

Provincetown NE 5-10 kts. 1 ft. 74/64

For current Charles River Basin water quality, call (781) 788-0007 or go to <http://www.charlesriver.org>.

Cities	Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions			
	● Travel delays possible, C Clouds, F Fog, H Haze, I Ice, Pc Partly Cloudy, R Rain, Sh Showers, S Sun, Sn Snow, Fl Flurries, T Thunderstorms, W Windy			
	Today	Tomorrow	Today	Tomorrow
Atlanta	92/72 Pc	96/74 S	Los Angeles	86/65 Pc 84/64 S
● Atlantic City	83/72 Sh	91/73 C	● Miami	92/79 T 92/81 T
Charlotte	94/71 Pc	96/74 S	● New Orleans	89/78 T 89/77 T
Chicago	90/74 Pc	91/75 T	● New York City	79/71 Sh 85/70 T
Dallas	100/80 S	99/80 S	Philadelphia	85/74 Pc 92/75 T
● Denver	85/60 T	84/61 S	● Phoenix	97/80 T 101/85 T
Detroit	89/72 C	88/72 T	● Salt Lake City	83/63 T 85/67 T
● Fort Myers	92/76 T	92/77 T	San Francisco	69/60 Pc 71/59 Sh

	Today	Tomorrow	Today	Tomorrow
Seattle	75/54 Pc	74/57 Pc	Jerusalem	83/66 S 86/69 S
● Washington	92/76 S	98/79 S	London	72/53 Pc 73/57 Pc
Beijing	88/64 S	87/62 S	Moscow	73/56 Pc 77/61 C
● Cancun	94/76 T	95/75 R	Paris	74/57 R 75/54 Pc
● Mexico City	75/57 Sh	75/58 R	Rome	91/68 S 92/67 S
Montreal	75/57 S	74/63 R	San Juan	90/79 R 90/78 R
● Toronto	73/69 Sh	84/70 T	Stockholm	67/51 Pc 68/52 Pc
Vancouver	70/57 C	71/57 Pc	Tokyo	85/76 C 88/77 Pc

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Monday, Aug. 31, 2026: You're charismatic, focused, and motivated. You're also charming, efficient, and committed to your goals. This is a year of work and construction. Create foundations in your life, both externally and internally. Simplicity is key. Take charge of your health, perhaps through martial arts or yoga. Stay grounded and levelheaded.

ARIES (March 21-April 19) This is a powerful day for you because the Moon is in your sign, and there is a lovely trine between Jupiter and Saturn happening today. This will encourage you to make plans — cautiously. Meanwhile, you're ready to roll up your sleeves and work! Tonight: You're strong. **TAURUS** (April 20-May 20) Today is a mixture of work and play for you. Opportunities to enjoy sports events, fun times with children, the arts, the theater, and the entertainment world are at hand. However, you might see ways to secure something related to home and family. Tonight: Enjoy your privacy.

GEMINI (May 21-June 20) Even though your strong focus now is on home, family, and perhaps home repairs, Venus wants you to play! In addition to this, today is a good day to think about long-range future goals, especially in practical terms. Be aware of the Moon Alert. Jot down your ideas for future reference. Tonight: Be friendly. **CANCER** (June 21-July 22) You have lots of energy this week with fiery Mars in your sign. In addition to which, both the Sun and Mercury will keep you busy with short trips, appointments, errands, and chatting to everyone. You'll enjoy entertaining at home as well. Today is a good day for solid financial plans. Tonight: Respect someone in authority. **LEO** (July 23-Aug. 22) Money, cash flow, and earnings have been on your mind. However, today Jupiter in your sign is dancing favorably with Saturn (for the first time since 2014). Trust your ability to make plans about future travel, publishing, medicine, the law, and higher education. Tentative, but a beginning. Tonight: Explore and learn. **VIRGO** (Aug. 23-Sept. 22) The Sun and Mercury are in your

sign, which makes you chatty and eager to talk to others. You might want to buy beautiful things, if so, check the restrictions of the Moon Alert. Take a moment to do some serious thinking about shared property and your debt. Tonight: Check your finances. **LIBRA** (Sept. 23-Oct. 22) If you're involved with a friend, group, or organization today, you might help others make a mission statement or come up with a group goal. This is an excellent day to explore this, but don't settle on anything. Don't agree, just yet. Tonight: Listen and cooperate. **SCORPIO** (Oct. 23-Nov. 21) Today you might make some plans about your future, especially your profession, your career and your name in the community. Nevertheless, commit to nothing. (See what happens after tomorrow.) Tonight: Get better organized. **SAGITTARIUS** (Nov. 22-Dec. 21) You make an excellent impression on others now, which is why it's a great time to talk to bosses, parents, and VIPs. Meanwhile, you might discuss travel plans and issues related to children, the arts or social outings. Wait until later in the week to agree to any-

thing. Tonight: Be creative and playful. **CAPRICORN** (Dec. 22-Jan. 19) Family discussions might have profitable suggestions for home and family or dealing with shared property. Nevertheless, don't agree to anything today because things might change, especially after tomorrow. Just put things in your databank. Tonight: Relax at home. **AQUARIUS** (Jan. 20-Feb. 18) A discussion with a partner, spouse or close friend will be enthusiastic, practical, and productive today. You might even want to jump on the bandwagon to get things rolling. Don't be too eager. Tomorrow will have some obstacles. Wait to see how things pan out. Tonight: Discussions. **PISCES** (Feb. 19-March 20) Today you have increasing optimism about your job and ability to earn money. You might listen to the advice of someone who is enthusiastic and encouraging. Nevertheless, get your data, but wait until later in the week to act because tomorrow could be a game-changer. Tonight: Check your possessions.

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SUDOKU

		8				9	5		
			4	6					3
6				5				9	
9			4		7	6	1		
				1					
	7	5	2		8				4
	6				5				8
4					6	7			
		7	1				5		

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART

South dealer — N-S vulnerable

North

♠ 10 9 4
♥ 6 4 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ 8 7 4 3

West

♠ 6 2
♥ Q J 10 8
♦ J 10 6 2
♣ K J 5

East

♠ A 5
♥ 9 7 3
♦ K 9 5 4
♣ Q 9 6 2

South

♠ K Q J 8 7 3
♥ A K 5
♦ Q 8
♣ A 10

South

2 ♣(!)
2 ♠
3 ♠

West

Pass
Pass
Pass

North

2 ♦
2 NT
4 ♠

East

Pass
Pass
All Pass

Opening lead — ♥ Q

Cy the Cynic is way overweight. He got on a drugstore scale, and a voice said, "One at a time, please." "Take better care of yourself," I pleaded. "Think of your body as a temple." "It's more an amusement-park funhouse," the Cynic said. Cy was unamused after today's deal. He was North. At four spades South took the king of hearts and led the king of trumps, winning. East won the next trump and led another heart, and South lost a trick in each suit. "We are not amused," Cy growled. South needs two diamond tricks, so two dummy entries to lead toward his queen and to take the ace. At Trick Two South leads the eight of trumps to dummy's nine. If East ducks, dummy leads a diamond. East takes the king and leads a second heart. South wins, unblocks his queen of diamonds and leads the seven of trumps: six, ten, ace. The defense cashes a heart, but South wins a club shift, leads his three of trumps to the four and pitches his club loser on the ace of diamonds.

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ A 5 ♥ 9 7 3 ♦ K 9 5 4 ♣ Q 9 6 2. Your partner opens one diamond, you raise to two diamonds and he next bids two hearts. What do you say?

ANSWER: Partner thinks you may have a game; he is looking for the best spot. Since you have a maximum hand for your single raise, you must not only cooperate but make sure game is reached. Bid three clubs. If partner bids 3NT next, fine; if he returns to three diamonds, bid three spades or 3NT.

ZIPPY "Sect Neglect" by Bill Griffith

BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro

MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters

ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell

ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer

Today's Crossword Solution

D	E	R	H	S		A	D	N	I		S	D	D	V
E	N	V	E	K		V	D	O	C		E	N	E	R
G	U	B	H	C		A	M	O	L	S		S	E	M
V	D					E	K	U			I	T	V	E
	S	D	R	V	O	B	S	I	T	V	E	P	D	V
E	D	T	I	M		A	E	B	O	T		A	S	P
E	N	V	T			M	O	P	V	K				
S	E	S	O	T		R	D	F		F	I	R	E	S
			S	I		S	A	V	O		B	A	R	V
T	E	D				I	E	M	O	C		S	N	O
N	I	V	T	N	O	F	I	L	E	R	T			
E	H	C	I	U	O		G	V	T		N	E	H	
S	C	B	A			S	E	K	V	C	B	U	R	C
N	I	U	R		O	P	E	R		V	R	T	E	T
U	R	H	T		M	E	A	T		T	E	S	M	I

Today's Sudoku Solution

9	5	8	4	6	1	7	2	8
6	2	7	9	3	8	1	5	4
8	4	1	5	2	7	6	9	3
4	3	6	8	9	2	5	7	1
5	7	8	3	1	6	9	4	2
2	1	9	7	5	4	8	3	6
7	6	4	2	8	9	3	1	9
3	8	2	1	7	9	4	6	5
1	9	5	6	4	3	2	8	7

TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY LISA WEIDENFELD



CHRISTOPHER RAPHAEL/NETFLIX

Kaya Scodelario and Theo James in "The Gentlemen."

New and streaming TV: 'Chad Powers,' 'The Gentlemen,' Ryan Reynolds in 'Mayday,' and more

The second season of Hulu's ... secret identity football dramedy? Unexpected Glen Powell TV show based on an Eli Manning commercial? Anyway, "**Chad Powers**" is back for season 2 on Hulu Thursday, with Powell returning, uncanny prosthetics in tow, as the disgraced former football star Russ Holliday, who disguises himself as the titular Chad so he can play college ball again. Can he keep the secret going?

Guy Ritchie's Netflix actioner "**The Gentlemen**" made headlines recently when Meghan Markle was rumored to be considering a role in the third season. Alas, the casting didn't work out, or at least not yet. But the second, definitely Markle-less, season drops Thursday. The series stars Theo James as Eddie, a man who inherits his family estate only to realize there's a marijuana empire running on it, alongside Kaya Scodelario. This season also features an appearance from "Downton Abbey" regular Hugh Bonneville, which is an extra bit of fun if you also always remember James as the man who died in bed with Lady Mary in the first season.

Ryan Reynolds and Kenneth Branagh star in "**Mayday**," out Friday on Apple TV, about an American airman (Reynolds) who accidentally crash lands in Russia in 1987. There, he has to depend

upon the kindness of the Russian man (Branagh) who rescues him to get him safely out of the country. The movie was written and directed by John Francis Daley and Jonathan Goldstein, who were also behind 2023's "Dungeons & Dragons: Honor Among Thieves," which is a pretty cute movie if you haven't gotten to it yet. Daley doesn't act as often anymore, but if you recognize his name, you might know him from his stint as Sweets on "Bones," or his role as Sam Weir on "Freaks and Geeks."

It was the best of times, it was the peak of adapting complex books into miniseries times. By which I mean, hey, there's an adaptation of Charles Dickens's "**A Tale of Two Cities**" out Sunday on MGM+. The famously well-coiffed Kit Harington of "Game of Thrones" stars as Sydney Carton in a wig that will make you question who got mad at him. Francois Civil is Charles Darnay and Mirren Mack is Lucie Manette in the four-episode series.

Lisa Weidenfeld can be reached at lisa.weidenfeld@globe.com. Follow her on X @LisaWeidenfeld and Instagram @lisaweidenfeld.

ASKING ERIC

Overeager relatives mar family visit

Q. We recently hosted a relative and his wife for a few days. They are longtime friends and their children are our children's contemporaries.

During their visit, the wife talked incessantly, sharing stories about their family members in great detail. In our efforts to reciprocate with some updates about our family, the wife would interject within a sentence or two of our contribution to hijack the conversation back to talking about her family.

These folks are good-natured and well-intentioned, but don't seem to have a clue as to how their conduct left us exhausted and feeling ignored. There was absolutely no interest or curiosity in what we might be doing, thinking, or experiencing.

We welcome your advice as to how or whether to say something or just let it go and limit future contacts.

SO DISAPPOINTED

A. Try to split the difference.

A conversation about what went wrong may not get you far, since none of you can go back and redo the visit. But you don't have to just let it or the friendship go or limit your time with them, if you don't really want to.

The next time they want to visit, suggest a different way of interacting. You can even mention that the last time they came, you got a lot of great updates about their family and their lives, but that you'd love to be able to share back and forth more.

This problem may be an issue of the relatives being overeager or proud or not having conversational skills that align well with yours. It may be useful, then, to set yourselves up for success with talking prompts, like a get-to-know you card game, or even a more structured conversation during which you agree that each person will get to speak in turn. It's also fine to say, in the midst of conversation, "I'm getting information overload. Can we pause for a second?"

Q. Donation etiquette triggered a pet peeve of mine and perhaps you have a solution.

My wife and I make it a habit to do the bulk of our donations in December, as I'm sure others do. We give a nice donation to a dozen or more what I call "mail-in charities" that solicit us by mail.

The problem is for the next year on a daily basis I am dealing with a full mailbox of these same organizations asking for more money. I'm sure some are spending more than we gave in December.

How do I give once a year and stop the never-ending request for more? If nothing else, it helps the post office.

DON'T ASK

A. A simple solution may be to make a one-time call to these so-called "mail-in charities." Request that you be connected to their donations office, noting that you're a current donor. Once connected, explain that you are happy to continue giving but that you need to be removed from their mailing list.

You might want to ask how soon you can expect the change to go into effect and if they share their list with any other charities. It's possible that your name may have ended up on other organizations' solicitation lists and so you might have to call them, too. Ask if you can expect the change to be permanent or if you'll need to call every year.

Ideally, these organizations use a donor management system that has an easy "do not mail" function and they can quickly comply. This isn't an unusual request; they have to go through the same process when a donor moves or passes away.

But they'll surely be grateful to know that you still intend to contribute.

Q. I had similar concerns as Ready to Lock the Door, who was inundated with houseguests and feeling overwhelmed.

Knowing hotel costs are a major issue, my husband and I offer our home and kitchen so out-of-town friends are free to buy groceries and make their own meals. We offer a list of things to do and then arrange for one day to join them with the understanding that the rest of the time we will be doing our own thing.

They are welcome to the house as if it was their own, but I will not be cooking or entertaining them.

We usually offer the use of one of our cars, so they are free to go wherever they wish without having to rent one.

It's all about how it is presented. This offer has been graciously accepted every time.

HAPPY HOST

A. This is very conscientious.

Communicating about what you can and can't offer surely saves a lot of headaches all around. And out-of-towners likely appreciate the tips and suggestions from someone in the know.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Monday August 31, 2026

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News	R. Steves	Antiques "New York City Hour 2"	Antiques "New York City Hour 3"	POV "Arrest the Midwife" (N)	Aman-pour (N)			
4	WBZ CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	Neighbor	Neighbor	FBI "Lone Wolf"	CIA "Orbital"	News (N)	(:35) Comics	
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	Dancing With-Stars (N) (SF)	Million Brad Paisley, Clayton Kershaw	Celebrity Family Feud	NewsCenter 5	(:35) J. Kimmel		
6	WLNE ABC	Videos	Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live		
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N) (SP)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)	7 News at 10PM (N)	7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside	
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	Debate: 2nd	Who Wants to Be	Celebrity Fam.	News (N)	J.Kimmel		
10	NBC Boston	The Kelly Clarkson Show (N) (F)	News (N)	American Ninja Warrior National Finals 4 (N)	American Ninja Warrior National Finals 4 (N)	The Wall "Cydney and Jordan" (N)	Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon		
10	WJAR NBC	News (Live)	Extra (N) (SP)	American Ninja Warrior National Finals 4 (N)	The Wall "Cydney and Jordan" (N)	News (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon			
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	Rosendo	Antiques "New York City Hour 2"	Antiques "New York City Hour 3"	POV "Arrest the Midwife" (N)	Aman-pour (N)			
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	Neighbor	Neighbor	FBI "Lone Wolf"	CIA "Orbital"	12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics	
25	WFXT FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	Beat Shazam "Battle of the Best Friends!; College Night!" (N)	Beat Shazam "Battle of the Best Friends!; College Night!" (N)	Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)	News (Live)	(:35) News (N)		
27	WUNI	Rosa "La Jauría" (N)	Tan cerca de ti, nace el amor (N)	Guardián de mi vida (N)	Corazón de oro (N)	Noticias Univisión	(:35) Noticiero			
36	WSBE PBS	R. Steves	Week-ends	Nature "Patrick and the Whale"	Women of World War II: The Untold Stories	PBS News Hour				
38	WSBK	Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)	48 Hours	Perfect	Perfect	Flip Side	Flip Side	
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques "D-Day"	Midsomer "Birds of Prey: Part 2"	Inspector George Gently "Son of a Gun"	Antiques "D-Day"	PBS News Hour (N)			
50	WWJE	48 Hours	Heartland Homicide	Killer Cases	Crime Stories	Unusual Suspects				
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	All American "Feel"	Penn "Four Fools and Counting..."	7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)	Modern Family	Modern Family		
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud	Family Feud	Beat Shazam "Battle of the Best Friends!; College Night!" (N)	Beat Shazam "Battle of the Best Friends!; College Night!" (N)	12 News on Fox Pr (N)	Seinfeld	Seinfeld		
68	WBXP ION	Blue Bloods	Blue Bloods	Blue Bloods	Blue Bloods	Blue Bloods	Blue Bloods			
PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax	★★★ Atomic Blonde ('17) Charlize Theron.	(:55) ★★★ The Terminator ('84) Linda Hamilton, Arnold Schwarzenegger.	(:40) ★★★ Room ('15) Jacob Tremblay, Brie Larson.							
Flix	(5:30) Grease 2	★★★★ Almost Famous Frances McDormand, Kate Hudson, Billy Crudup.	(:35) ★★ Nine ('09) Marion Cotillard, Penélope Cruz, Daniel Day-Lewis.	(:35) Dead Man Wa...						
HBO	(6:00) Stranger...	(:35) Lanterns	Conan O'Brien	(:20) Knock Knock ('15) Ana de Armas, Lorenza Izzo, Keanu Reeves.	Monsters of God	(:55) Lanterns				
HBO 2	(6:00) Knock K...	(:40) Monsters of God	(:35) ★★★ The Drama ('26) Robert Pattinson, Zendaya.	(:20) Lanterns	(:15) Conan O'Brien					
Paramount-Sho	(5:30) ★★★ Clear and Present Danger	Lioness "The Idiot Army" (N)	★★ The Mechanic ('11) Ben Foster, Jason Statham.	(:35) ★★ Machine Gun Preacher ('11) Gerard Butler.						
Showtime 2	(6:00) Daniela Forever ('24)	★★ The Time Traveler's Wife ('09) Eric Bana, Arliss Howard, Rachel McAdams.	★★★ Blue Valentine ('10) Michelle Williams, Faith Wladyska, Ryan Gosling.							
Starz!	(:05) ★★★ Hustle & Flow ('05) Anthony Anderson, Terrence Howard.	(:05) Fightland	★★ Shelter ('26) Bodhi Rae Breathnach, Jason Statham.	(:50) Sicario: ...						
TMC	(6:15) ★★ The Running Man ('87)	★ Sliver ('93) William Baldwin, Tom Berenger, Sharon Stone.	(:50) ★★★ The Talented Mr. Ripley ('99) Gwyneth Paltrow, Jude Law, Matt Damon.							
SPORTS										
CBSSN	(4:00) TOUR Champ. Final Round (N)	NWSL Soccer Angel City FC at Boston Legacy (N) (Live)	Poker Night in America (N)	PGA C'sic 2015: FedEx Cup Playoffs						
ESPN	2026 US Open Tennis Men's & Women's First Round From the USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center in Flushing, N.Y. (N) (Live)				SportCtr (Live)					
ESPN2	2026 US Open Tennis Men's & Women's First Round From the USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center in Flushing, N.Y. (N) (Live)				NFL Live Marcus Spears					
Fox Sports 1	(6:30) MLB Baseball Miami Marlins at Washington Nationals (N) (Live)	IndyCar Racing Milwaukee Mile 250	SPEED With (N)							
Golf	(6:00) Big... PGA (N)	PGA TOUR	TOUR Champ. Final Round From East Lake Golf Club in Atlanta.							
NBA	NBA Basketball	Center Court	NBA Basketball							
NBC Sports	Early Edition	NWSL Soccer Angel City FC at Boston Legacy (N) (Live)	Boston Sports (N) (Live)	Boston Sports						
NESN	(6:30) Baseball Seattle Mariners at Boston Red Sox	Extra (N)	Red Sox	Chat (N)						
FAMILY										
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty
Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Vampi-rina	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug
Encore Family	Movie	(:35) Young & Prodigious T.S. S...	(:25) My Dog the Champion	(:50) ★★ Running Free ('94)						
Nickelodeon	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14;

TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

	News		Specials								
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
BASIC CABLE											
A&E	Live PD: Greatest Shifts "Episode 33"		Live PD: Greatest Shifts "Episode 29"		Live PD: Great. "Episode 34" (N)		Live PD: Great. "Episode 35" (N)		(:05) Live PD: Great. "Episode 32"		
AMC	(6:00) ★★ Bad Boys ('95)		★★ Bad Boys II ('03) Will Smith, Jordí Mollà, Martin Lawrence.				True Lies				
Animal Planet	Alaskan "Bush Heart"		Alaskan "The Wolf Pack Returns"		Alaskan "Driving Miss Rainy"		Alaskan "Winter Watch"		Alaskan "Growing the Wolfpack"		
BBC America	★★★ The Blues Brothers ('80) Dan Aykroyd, John Belushi.				★★ Weird Science ('85) Kelly LeBrock.						
BET	Celebrity Family Feud		Celebrity Family Feud Snoop Dogg		Celebrity Fam. Joely Fisher, Tony Hawk		Martin	Martin	Martin	Martin	
Bravo	Below Deck "Blasts From the Past"		Below Deck "Deck Daddy's Home" (N)		Next Gen NYC		Below Deck "Deck Daddy's Home"		Housewives/OC		
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	(:35) Reba	(:10) Reba	(:40) Reba	(:15) Reba	(:50) Reba	GoldGirls		
CNN	OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360		The Source With		CNN NewsNight		Laura	(Live)	
Comedy Central	The Office	(:35) The Office	(:10) The Office	(:45) The Office	(:20) The Office		(:55) The Office	The Office	Family Guy	Family Guy	
CSPAN	(6:00) U.S. House		C-SPAN Primetime				C-SPAN Primetime				
CSPAN2	(6:00) Public Affairs		Public Affairs Events				Public Affairs Events				
Dest. America	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	Lakefront	
Discovery	Contraband: Seized		Contraband (N)		120 Hours Be. (N)		120 Hours Be.		120 Hours Be.		
Discovery Life	Dr. Pimple Popper		Dr. Pimple Popper		Dr. Pimple Popper		Dr. Pimple Popper		Dr. Pimple Popper		
E!	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	
Encore	(6:00) Get On Up				(:20) ★★ Daddy's Home ('15) Will Ferrell.		Anchorman: Legend of Ron Bur...				Movie
Food	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Pitmasters "The Whole Hog"		Pitmasters "The Final Burn" (N)		Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld!		Fox News (Live)		
Freeform	★★ It Ends With Us ('24) Justin Baldoni, Blake Lively. (P)				Somebody Knows		The 700 Club				
FUSE	Blondie: Glass Heart		Willie Nelson		Bob Dylan: Le		Cheaters	Cheaters	Cheaters	Cheaters	
FX	(:6:30) Captain America: First Avenger				Sunny		Adults		Captain America: The Winter Soldier		
FXM	(:10) ★★ Where the Crawdads Sing ('22)				(:50) ★★		Where the Crawdads Sing ('22)				
Hallmark	(6:00) Harvest Love		Fourth Down and Love ('23)				Gold Girls		Gold Girls	Gold Girls	
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) True Justice		Justice "True Justice: Eye for an Eye"				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote		
HGTV	Roast My Rental	Roast My Rental	Roast My Rental	Roast My Rental	Totally '90s House "The Nineties Are Back"		The House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	
History	Mysteries "Captain Kidd's Treasure"		Mysteries "Lost Civil War Gold"		History's Greatest Mysteries (N)		(:05) History's Greatest Mysteries		(:05) History's Greatest Mysteries		
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	
HSN	Ready, Set,	Chaco (N) (Live)		The Real Deal (N)		The Real Deal		The Real Deal			
ID	Neighbor "Full Frontal Attack"		Fear Thy Neighbor "Philly Fallout"		A Deadly Deal (N)		Game Day Murders (N)		Murder in the "Branches of Evil"		
IFC	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	
Lifetime	NCIS "Jeopardy"		NCIS "Hiatus"		NCIS "Hiatus"		(:05) NCIS "Shalom"		(:05) NCIS		
LMN	(6:00) Murdaugh		Husband, Father, Killer: Alyssa Pladi Story				Would You Kill for Me? Mary Bailey Story				
MAGN	Maine		Maine		Maine (N)		Maine		Maine		
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		The Rachel		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)		
MTV	Ridiculous		Ridiculous		Ridiculous		Ridiculous		Ridiculous		
National Geographic	David Blaine Do Not Attempt "SE Asia"		David Blaine Do Not Attempt "India"		(:55) David		(:45) David "South Africa"		(:40) David Blaine Do Not "Japan"		
NatGeoWild	Dr. Oakley, Vet		Primal Survivor		Primal Survivor		Primal Survivor (N)		Primal Survivor (N)		
NECN	News		News		Dateline		Rescue		OpenHou...		
NewsNation	Vargas Report		Cuomo		On Balance		Katie Pavlich		Jesse Web		
Ovation	Murdoch Mysteries		Hope Street		Murdoch Mysteries		Murdoch Mysteries		Murdoch Mysteries		
OWN	Videos		Videos		Videos		Videos		Videos		
Oxygen	Snapped		Snapped		Dateline: Unforgettable				Snapped		
Paramount	(6:00) ★★ Vacation ('15) (P)		★★ Couples Retreat ('09) Jason Bateman, Vince Vaughn.				Vacation				
QVC	(6:00) PM Style (N)		Belle by Kim Gravel -- Fashion (N) (Live)				Dennis Basso & Friends (N) (Live)				
Science	Secret Nazi Ruins		Secret Nazi Ruins		Secret Nazi Ruins		Secret Nazi Ruins		Secret Nazi Ruins		
Sundance	NCIS "Identity Crisis"		NCIS "Leap of Faith"		NCIS "Chimera"		NCIS "Requiem"		NCIS "Designated Target"		
SyFy	Movie	★★ Underworld: Rise of the Lycans ('09)				★★ Underworld: Evolution ('06)				Predator	
TBS	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Office	Office	
TCM	(:5:45) Life & Times ...		★★★ Mogambo ('53) Clark Gable.				(:15) ★★★ The Night of the Iguana ('64)				
TLC	Last Resort		Last Resort (N)		Last Resort (N)		1000-lb Roomies		Double Lives		
TNT	(:5:30) ★★★ The Dark Knight Rises ('12)				The Librarians (N)		The Librarians		Dark Knight Rises		
Travel	(6:00) Mysteries		Mysteries of the Unknown				Mysteries of the Unknown				
TruTV	Super Bowl XLII		Super Bowl XLIII				Super Bowl XLIV		SuperBo...		
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:10) King	(:50) King	
TV One	CosbySh...	CosbySh...	Fatal Attraction		Fatal Attraction (N)		For My Man (N)		For My Man		
USA	Law & Order: SVU "Choreographed"		Law & Order: SVU "Scheherezade"		Law & Order: SVU "Burned"		Law & Order: SVU "Outsider"		Law & Order: SVU "Loophole"		
VH-1	Movie	★★★ The Social Network ('10)				Jesse Eisenberg.		★★★ Friends With Benefits			
WE	Criminal Minds		Criminal "Alchemy"		Criminal Minds		Criminal "No. 6"		Criminal Minds		